

MACKEYFICATION OF EQUIVARIANT CATEGORIES I

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ABSTRACT. Colloquially speaking, ‘equivariant categories’ refer to families of additive categories $\mathcal{A}(G)$ depending 2-functorially on a finite group G . We construct approximations of equivariant categories by Mackey 2-functors, both on the left and on the right. The idea is to enlarge $\mathcal{A}$ in a minimal way to make induction appear. These ‘mackeyfications’ are inspired by Boltje’s work with ordinary Mackey 1-functors. We also relate our left and right mackeyfications via a mark transformation. Finally we discuss examples.

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PREAMBLE

In the context of ordinary Mackey functors of abelian groups [Gre71, Dre73], building on work of Deligne [Del73], Dress [Dre71] and Thévenaz [Thé88], Robert Boltje [Bol98] proposed two constructions of Mackey functors A_+ and B^+ associated respectively to ‘restriction’ functors A and to ‘conjugation’ functors B .

In this paper, we propose a categorification of these ideas using Mackey 2-functors of additive categories, in the sense of [BD20]. While we focus exclusively on the 2-categorical story, the reader familiar with Boltje [Bol98] will easily see the parallels. A precise comparison, under K -theoretic decategorification and under Hom-decategorification à la [BD24], will appear in the upcoming [BM26].

Expertise in 2-category theory is not necessary for this paper. All our 2-categories are close cousins of **CAT**, the domestic 2-category of categories, functors and natural transformations, for instance the 2-subcategory $\mathbf{ADD} \subseteq \mathbf{CAT}$ of additive categories and additive functors, or the full 2-subcategory $\mathbf{gpd} \subseteq \mathbf{CAT}$ of finite groupoids.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Let $\mathbb{G}$ be a category of finite groups of interest, e.g. all finite groups (for a ‘global’ theory), or only the subgroups of a fixed group Γ (for a ‘local’ theory). We view $\mathbb{G}$ as a 2-category whose 2-cells encode conjugation (Example 2.8). The term ‘equivariant category’ refers broadly to categories $\mathcal{A}(G)$ varying 2-functorially with G in $\mathbb{G}$. More precisely, we use three species of equivariant categories.

First, we have *restriction 2-functors*, i.e. the plain 2-functors $\mathcal{A}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$. They consist of an additive category $\mathcal{A}(G)$ for every group G in $\mathbb{G}$, a restriction $u^*: \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(H)$ for every morphism $u: H \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$, and a natural isomorphism $\alpha^*: u^* \xrightarrow{\sim} v^*$ for every 2-cell $\alpha: u \xrightarrow{\sim} v$, with the usual functoriality conditions.

Second and most beloved, we have the *Mackey 2-functors* $\mathcal{M}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$, namely the restriction 2-functors that admit induction: For every injective morphism $i: H \hookrightarrow G$, we require functors $i_*: \mathcal{M}(H) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(G)$ that are two-sided adjoint to restriction i^* and that satisfy base-change Mackey formulas. The axiomatization introduced with Dell’Ambrogio in [BD20] is recalled in Section 3. An entire chapter of [BD20] is dedicated to the many standard examples of Mackey 2-functors.

The third species, called *conjugation 2-functors*, will be discussed shortly.

Consider the 2-category $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) := 2\text{-Fun}(\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}}, \text{ADD})$ of restriction 2-functors on $\mathbb{G}$, with transformations compatible with restriction as morphisms, and modifications as 2-cells (Recollection 2.4). Its 2-subcategory $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$ of Mackey 2-functors has the same 2-cells but fewer morphisms: only those that preserve induction (Recollection 3.19). The 2-functor $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$, which forgets induction, admits a left biadjoint that is our first mackeyfication $(-)_\oplus$. As usual, the unit $\eta: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus$ goes out to the right. Left adjoint but *right* mackeyfication.

1.1. Theorem (Theorem 6.10). *Let $\mathcal{A}$ be a restriction 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}$. There exists a Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{A}_\oplus$ and a morphism $\eta: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus$ of restriction 2-functors such that every such morphism $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ into a Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{M}$ factors uniquely⁽¹⁾ as $t \cong \hat{t} \circ \eta$ for a morphism of Mackey 2-functors $\hat{t}: \mathcal{A}_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \boxed{\mathcal{A}} & \xrightarrow{\eta} & \mathcal{A}_\oplus \\ & \searrow \forall t & \swarrow \exists! \hat{t} \\ & \mathcal{M} & \end{array}$$

As with Boltje’s $(-)^+$, our second construction $(-)_\oplus$ is more delicate to state. Here enter the ‘conjugation 2-functors’, those equivariant categories without induction but also without restriction. To formalize this, let $\mathbb{G}_\simeq$ be the 2-full subcategory of $\mathbb{G}$ with only isomorphisms as morphisms. We call $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) := 2\text{-Fun}(\mathbb{G}_\simeq^{\text{op}}, \text{ADD})$ the 2-category of *conjugation 2-functors* on $\mathbb{G}$. Precomposing with the inclusion $\mathbb{G}_\simeq \hookrightarrow \mathbb{G}$ yields a faithful 2-functor $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$ that forgets restrictions. Its right biadjoint yields our second mackeyfication $(-)_\oplus$.

1.2. Theorem (Theorem 7.17). *Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a conjugation 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}$. There exists a restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{B}^\oplus$ and a morphism $\varepsilon: \mathcal{B}^\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ of conjugation 2-functors, such that every such morphism $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ from a restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$ factors uniquely⁽¹⁾ as $t \cong \varepsilon \circ \tilde{t}$ for a morphism $\tilde{t}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus$ of restriction 2-functors:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{B}^\oplus & \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} & \boxed{\mathcal{B}} \\ \swarrow \exists! \tilde{t} & & \searrow \forall t \\ & \mathcal{A} & \end{array}$$

¹ Uniqueness is ‘up to unique invertible modification’ in a sense made precise in the text.

As the word ‘Mackey’ does not appear in Theorem 1.2, we seem to encounter a tongue-twisting ‘left restrictification’ of $\mathcal{B}$. By chance, $\mathcal{B}^\oplus$ is always *Mackey*:

1.3. Theorem (Theorem 8.24). *The above construction $\mathcal{B} \mapsto \mathcal{B}^\oplus$ yields a 2-functor $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$ from conjugation 2-functors to Mackey 2-functors.*

Hence we call this right biadjoint $(-)^{\oplus}$ the *left mackeyfication* but emphasize that it is *not* right biadjoint to $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$, nor to the composite $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$. See Remark 7.18. We did warn the reader that $(-)^{\oplus}$ would be more delicate! In summary, we have the following picture:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}: \mathcal{M}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M} & \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} & \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) & \mathcal{B}^{\oplus} & \\
 (\text{Thm 1.1}) & \uparrow & (-)_{\oplus} \uparrow \dashv \downarrow \text{forget} & \uparrow (\text{Thm 1.3}) & \\
 (1.4) \quad \eta = {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} & \mathcal{A} & \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) & & {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus} \\
 & & \text{forget} \downarrow \dashv \uparrow (-)^{\oplus} & & (\text{Thm 1.2}) \\
 & & \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) & \mathcal{B} & \varepsilon = {}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}: \mathcal{B}^{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}
 \end{array}$$

In the center we displayed vertically the two forgetful functors, from Mackey 2-functors to restriction 2-functors, and from restriction 2-functors to conjugation 2-functors. These forgetful 2-functors have biadjoints, $(-)_{\oplus}$ and $(-)^{\oplus}$ respectively. Hence we have units and counits, decorated with $^{\oplus}$ and $_{\oplus}$ to distinguish the two cases. The unit ${}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ is the η of Theorem 1.1, and the counit ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}$ is ε in Theorem 1.2. The unit ${}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ will play a role below. For completeness, we mention the counit $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}: \mathcal{M}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$ for every Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{M}$.

The *existence* of our biadjoints may surely be obtained by general theory: Kan extensions of bicategories [Str74, Kel05] and ‘swallowtail equations’ in tricategories [GPS95]. Instead of unpacking all this machinery in our setting, we give the *explicit* Constructions 5.1 and 7.1, for $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}$ and $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ respectively. We pay the price by having to prove the biadjunctions, mostly by constructing the (co)units. Having explicit formulas turns out to be useful for computations anyway.

Another thing that is not provided by the abstract machinery is the little miracle of Theorem 1.3: The right biadjoint $(-)^{\oplus}$ lands in Mackey 2-functors. We use this fact to construct a comparison between the two mackeyfications $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}$ and $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$, when they both make sense, i.e. for $\mathcal{A}$ a restriction 2-functor. Indeed, we already mentioned in (1.4) the unit for the second adjunction ${}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$. Since the 2-functor $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ is kind enough to be Mackey, we can apply Theorem 1.1 to $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ and $t = {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ to get a $\hat{t}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M} = \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$.

1.5. Theorem (Section 9). *For every restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$, there exists a canonical morphism $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ of Mackey 2-functors:*

$$\mu_{\mathcal{A}} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \widehat{({}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}})}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$$

such that the following composite in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$ is the identity of $\mathcal{A}$:

$$\mathcal{A} \xrightarrow{{}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}} \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \xrightarrow{\mu_{\mathcal{A}}} \mathcal{A}^{\oplus} \xrightarrow{{}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}}} \mathcal{A}.$$

We give an explicit formula for $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}$ in Theorem 9.8. Since that formula resembles the classical ‘mark homomorphism’ of [Bol98, Section 2] we call $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ the *mark transformation*. It is usually not an equivalence (Remark 10.17).

To appreciate these results, let us pick the simplest restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$ we can think of, namely a constant one. Even with this rather dull input, the output is quite interesting. The following statement is a summary of Section 10.

1.6. Theorem. *Let $\mathbb{G}$ be the 2-category of finite groups, faithful homomorphisms, and conjugations as 2-cells. Let $\mathbb{k}$ be a field and $\mathcal{A}(G)$ the additive category of finite-dimensional $\mathbb{k}$ -vector spaces, independently of G in $\mathbb{G}$, with identity restrictions.*

- (a) *The category $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G)$ is equivalent to the ordinary $\mathbb{k}$ -linear Burnside category $\Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G)$ of G , whose objects are finite G -sets X , and whose morphisms from X to Y are $\mathbb{k}$ -linear combinations of spans $X \leftarrow Z \rightarrow Y$; see Recollection 10.3.*
- (b) *The category $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus}(G)$ is equivalent to the sum $\bigoplus_{(H)} \mathbb{k}(N_G(H)/H)\text{-mod}$, over any choice of representatives H of subgroups of G up to conjugation, of the categories of $\mathbb{k}$ -linear representations of the Weyl group of H in G .*
- (c) *The mark transformation $\mu_{\mathcal{A},G}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}(G)$ sends a G -set X to the tuple of $\mathbb{k}(N_G(H)/H)$ -modules, whose H -th entry is the permutation module $\mathbb{k}(X^H)$.*

It is remarkable that our abstract Theorems 1.1 and 1.2 turn a trivial $\mathcal{A}$ into two beautiful equivariant categories $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}$ and $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ and that Theorem 1.5 recovers arguably the most interesting connection $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ between them.

Our long-term project is to categorify Boltje’s canonical induction. So far, we present in this paper the two Mackeyfications and the mark transformation. We prove universal properties that justify the constructions conceptually. Our answers are not some tricategorical abstractions but are described explicitly. And they recover interesting categories in examples. In view of the current page-length, we make a cut at this point and defer further investigation to subsequent work.

The published literature closest to our theme seems to be the works of Boltje, Raggi-Cárdenas and Valero-Elizondo [BRCVE19] and of Calderón [Cal25]. These papers generalize [Bol98] to (fibered) biset functors. Yet, they do not invoke Mackey 2-functors and remain mostly 1-categorical, treating linear functors from specific biset categories to categories of modules.

The outline of this article is now easy to read off the table of contents. Let us only add a few comments. As in [BD20], we use the language of finite groupoids to streamline Mackey formulas; see Section 2. Two notions will play an important role in the construction of $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}$. First we have ‘local equivalences’ of groupoids, the smallest class of morphisms that is compatible with additivity and contains group isomorphisms; see Subsection 2.C. Secondly, we have ‘traces’ in the context of Frobenius adjunctions; see Section 4.

Statement about use of A.I. None of the creative work in this paper involved artificial intelligence. Most proofs consist in guessing appropriate constructions, very often units and counits of adjunctions and biadjunctions. Such guesses create a lot of drudge work: The constructions must be well-defined, functorial, natural, and compatible with the relevant 2-categorical structures, including comma categories and span categories. Those verifications are proverbially ‘left to the reader’. Nowadays they can be replicated by generative artificial intelligence. We did test ChatGPT on such verifications, with great success.

In any case, the authors retain full responsibility for mathematical correctness.

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2. RECOLLECTIONS AND PREPARATIONS

2.A. Basics on 2-categories.

2.1. *Convention.* We refer to 0-cells as ‘objects’, we refer to 1-cells as ‘morphisms’, and we let 2-cells be 2-cells. As already said, the only 2-categories that we employ here are variations on the basic example of the 2-category **CAT** of categories, whose objects are categories, whose morphisms are functors and whose 2-cells are natural transformations. For instance:

- (1) We denote by **gpd** the 2-category of finite groupoids (with finitely many objects and finitely many morphisms), functors and natural transformations. As every 2-cell is invertible, **gpd** is a so-called (2,1)-category.
- (2) We already used in the Introduction the 2-category **ADD** of (large) additive categories, additive functors and natural transformations.

2.2. *Convention.* We denote isomorphisms by $\cong$, be they invertible morphisms or invertible 2-cells. We denote (1-cell) equivalences by $\simeq$. To lighten notation, we follow standard practice and parsimoniously denote by $=$ a few canonical isomorphisms that can safely be treated as identities.

2.3. *Notation.* In a 2-category, it is common to write only α for the 2-cell α suitably whiskered, when the whiskering is clear from context. When composing 2-cells that only match after whiskering, we shall write $\beta \otimes \alpha$ instead of $\beta \circ \alpha$, to indicate that α and β are adjusted and then composed. For instance, in the diagram

$$\beta \otimes \alpha: \quad \begin{array}{ccccccc} & & & r & & & \\ & & & \searrow & & & \\ \bullet & \xrightarrow{q} & \bullet & \xrightarrow{s} & \bullet & \xrightarrow{t} & \bullet \\ & & & \downarrow \alpha & & & \\ & & & \downarrow \beta & & & \\ & & & v & & & \\ & & & \nearrow & & & \\ & & & u & & & \\ & & & \nearrow & & & \\ & & & w & & & \\ & & & \nearrow & & & \\ & & & \bullet & & & \end{array}$$

the 2-cells $\alpha: r \Rightarrow ts$ and $\beta: ut \Rightarrow v$ cannot be composed but $\beta \otimes \alpha$ has the obvious meaning $(\beta s) \circ (u\alpha): ur \Rightarrow vs$. Going the full length, we shall often denote by $\beta \otimes \alpha$ the obvious 2-cell $(w\beta sq) \circ (wu\alpha q): wurq \Rightarrow wvsq$ in the above picture.

2.4. *Recollection.* For every 2-category $\mathbb{G}$ (for instance $\mathbb{G} = \mathbf{gpd}$) we denote by

$$\mathbf{2-Fun}(\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}}, \mathbf{ADD})$$

the 2-category of all contravariant 2-functors from $\mathbb{G}$ to **ADD**. Details can be found in [BD20, Appendix A.1]. An object $\mathcal{A}$ in $\mathbf{2-Fun}(\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}}, \mathbf{ADD})$ consists of an additive category $\mathcal{A}(G)$ for every object G in $\mathbb{G}$, an additive restriction functor $u^* = \mathcal{A}(u): \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(H)$ for every morphism $u: H \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$, and a natural transformation $\alpha^* = \mathcal{A}(\alpha): u^* \Rightarrow (u')^*$ for every 2-cell $\alpha: u \Rightarrow u'$. This data is required to be strictly compatible with identities and compositions. (There is a somewhat cumbersome extension of the theory to *pseudo*-functors $\mathcal{A}$. Note that pseudo-functors can be strictified, by [Pow89, Section 4.2].)

The morphisms in $\mathbf{2-Fun}(\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}}, \mathbf{ADD})$ are always *pseudo-natural transformations* $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'$; they consist of an additive functor $t_G: \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'(G)$ for every object G in $\mathbb{G}$ and a natural isomorphism $t_u: \mathcal{A}'(u) \circ t_G \xrightarrow{\cong} t_H \circ \mathcal{A}(u): \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'(H)$ for every morphism $u: H \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$, expressing the compatibility of t with the two restrictions in $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{A}'$, these are subject to ‘obvious’ axioms, see [BD20, A.1.15]. We call such a morphism t *strictly 2-natural* if the compatibility isomorphisms t_u are identities.

The 2-cells $m: t \Rightarrow t': \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'$ are the *modifications*; they consist of 2-cells in ADD (natural transformations) $m_G: t_G \Rightarrow t'_G: \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'(G)$ for every object G in $\mathbb{G}$ compatible with the isomorphisms t_u in the ‘obvious’ sense, see *loc. cit.*

2.5. Recollection. Let $\Phi: \mathcal{K} \rightarrow \mathcal{L}$ and $\Psi: \mathcal{L} \rightarrow \mathcal{K}$ be two 2-functors between 2-categories, or more generally pseudo-functors between bicategories. A *biadjunction* $\Phi \dashv \Psi$ consists of an equivalence of categories

$$(2.6) \quad \mathcal{L}(\Phi X, Y) \simeq \mathcal{K}(X, \Psi Y)$$

that is pseudo-natural in both variables. We shall construct such biadjunctions by giving a pair of pseudo-natural transformations, the unit $\eta: \text{Id}_{\mathcal{K}} \Rightarrow \Psi\Phi$ and the counit $\varepsilon: \Phi\Psi \Rightarrow \text{Id}_{\mathcal{L}}$, and two invertible modifications $\alpha: \text{Id}_{\Phi} \Rightarrow (\varepsilon\Phi) \circ (\Phi\eta)$ and $\beta: \text{Id}_{\Psi} \Rightarrow (\Psi\varepsilon) \circ (\eta\Psi)$. These must satisfy coherence conditions, called the ‘swallowtail equations’, see [GPS95]. In our applications, the two triangle composites will be equal to the identity, as pseudo-natural transformations, and therefore the modifications α and β may be chosen to be identities. Furthermore, in both applications (Propositions 6.7 and 7.14), one of the unit and counit is strictly 2-natural. In such a case, the swallowtail equations are automatic.

2.B. Basics on groupoids and isocommas.

2.7. Notation. We denote finite groupoids by letters such as $G, H, K, \dots$. We use the symbol $\twoheadrightarrow$ to indicate faithfulness. We reserve $\hookrightarrow$ to emphasize inclusion. We write $\pi_0(G)$ for the finite set of connected components of G . We have a decomposition $G = \sqcup_{H \in \pi_0(G)} H$ and denote the fully faithful inclusions by $\text{incl}_H: H \hookrightarrow G$.

2.8. Example. Groups are viewed as one-object groupoids. Functors between them are group homomorphisms. Given two group homomorphisms $f_1, f_2: H \rightarrow G$, the 2-cells $f_1 \Rightarrow f_2$ are the conjugations $\gamma_g: f_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} f_2$, where $g \in G$ satisfies $f_2 = {}^g f_1$. A homomorphism is an equivalence in $\mathbf{gpd}$ if and only if it is an isomorphism.

Conjugation by an element $g \in G$ provides both the morphisms $c_g := {}^g(-)$, say, from $H \leq G$ to $K \leq G$ when ${}^g H \leq K$, as well as the above 2-cells γ_g . Note that even when $f_1 = f_2$ and ${}^g f_1 = f_1$ the 2-cell is trivial $\gamma_g = \text{id}_{f_1}$ only for $g = 1$.

For instance, suppose that $g \in N_G(H)$ normalizes H . Then we have an automorphism $c_g: H \xrightarrow{\sim} H$, which is trivial $c_g = \text{id}_H$ only if $g \in C_G(H)$ centralizes H . This c_g is related to the identity by the 2-cell $\gamma_g: \text{id}_H \xrightarrow{\sim} c_g$ only when $g \in H$, and even when $g \in Z(H)$ is central, the 2-cell $\gamma_g: \text{id}_H \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{id}_H$ is non-trivial unless $g = 1$.

2.9. Remark. Let us make a heuristic comment on the role that 2-cells play in 2-functors $\mathcal{A}: \mathbf{gpd}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$, in particular over the 2-subcategory of groups, as in Example 2.8. Functoriality yields restrictions $u^* = \mathcal{A}(u): \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(H)$ for all group homomorphisms $u: H \rightarrow G$, so that $(u_1 u_2)^* = u_2^* u_1^*$. For 2-cells $\gamma_g: u \xrightarrow{\sim} v$, we obtain isomorphisms $\gamma_g^* = \mathcal{A}(\gamma_g): u^* \xrightarrow{\sim} v^*$. Formally, these γ_g^* can be thought of as more variance (‘higher restrictions’) but they are perhaps better understood as *relations*. For instance $\gamma_g: \text{id}_G \xrightarrow{\sim} c_g: G \rightarrow G$ provides an isomorphism $c_g^* \cong \text{id}_{\mathcal{A}(G)}$, thus trivializing the conjugation action c_g^* of G on $\mathcal{A}(G)$. If we stripped $\mathbf{gpd}$ from all non-identity 2-cells, we could still consider 1-functors from group(oid)s to additive categories, with no imposed relations between u^* and v^* when $u \neq v$. Remembering 2-cells forces G -conjugate homomorphisms $H \rightarrow G$ to yield isomorphic restrictions $\mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(H)$.

2.10. *Recollection.* Let $i: H \rightarrow G$ and $u: K \rightarrow G$ be morphisms in $\mathbf{gpd}$ with common target, also known as a *cospan* $H \xrightarrow{i} G \xleftarrow{u} K$. The *isocomma groupoid* (i/u)

$$(2.11) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & (i/u) & \\ \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 \\ H & \xrightarrow[\gamma_{i/u}]{\cong} & K \\ i \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array}$$

has for objects the triples (a, b, g) , where $a \in \text{Obj}(H)$ and $b \in \text{Obj}(K)$, and $g: i(a) \xrightarrow{\sim} u(b)$ is an isomorphism in G . Its morphisms $(a_1, b_1, g_1) \rightarrow (a_2, b_2, g_2)$ are pairs of morphisms $(h: a_1 \rightarrow a_2, k: b_1 \rightarrow b_2)$ such that $g_2 i(h) = u(k) g_1$ in G . The functors $\text{pr}_1: (i/u) \rightarrow H$ and $\text{pr}_2: (i/u) \rightarrow K$ are the obvious projections, and the natural isomorphism $\gamma_{i/u}: i \text{pr}_1 \Rightarrow u \text{pr}_2$ is given by g at each object (a, b, g) . Sometimes the emphasis is on H and K and we shall write

$$H \times_G K := (i/u)$$

when the ‘structure morphisms’ $i: H \rightarrow G$ and $u: K \rightarrow G$ are clear from context.

2.12. *Remark.* The main reason for using groupoids in [BD20] is that the above groupoid $H \times_G K = (i/u)$ is usually not a group even if G is, and if H and K are subgroups. Indeed, in that case, $\pi_0((i/u))$ is in canonical bijection with $K \backslash G / H$. For each double coset $C \in K \backslash G / H$, the component of (i/u) corresponding to C is non-canonically equivalent to $H \cap K^g$ for any choice of $g \in C$.

Mackey formulas relate on one side induction from H to G followed by restriction to K , and on the other side the sum of the restrictions to the various $H \cap K^g$ followed by induction along ${}^g(-): H \cap K^g \rightarrow K$. With the isocomma (2.11) in hand, this Mackey relation becomes the much simpler $u^* \circ i_* \cong (\text{pr}_2)_* \circ \text{pr}_1^*$. The language of groupoids avoids unhealthy choices of coset representatives.

The small price to pay for using finite groupoids instead of finite groups is to make sure that all (contravariant) 2-functors $\mathcal{A}: \mathbf{gpd}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{ADD}$ that we use are *additive*. See Remark 2.31. In the above situation, the composite $(\text{pr}_2)_* \circ \text{pr}_1^*$ then becomes a sum of $(\text{pr}_{2,C})_* \circ (\text{pr}_{1,C})^*$ indexed by $C \in K \backslash G / H$, as one expects.

2.13. *Notation.* Consider an isocomma (2.11). For a groupoid T , every morphism $w: T \rightarrow (i/u)$ yields two morphisms $w_1 := \text{pr}_1 w: T \rightarrow H$, $w_2 := \text{pr}_2 w: T \rightarrow K$ and a 2-cell $\alpha := \gamma_{i/u} w: i w_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} u w_2$. Conversely, every such triple (w_1, w_2, α) defines a unique morphism $w: T \rightarrow (i/u)$ given by $w(a) = (w_1(a), w_2(a), \alpha_a)$ for every object $a \in T$ and $w(f) = (w_1(f), w_2(f))$ on morphisms. We denote it by

$$\langle w_1, w_2, \alpha \rangle: T \rightarrow (i/u).$$

For 2-cells, given two morphisms $w, w': T \rightarrow (i/u)$, say $w = \langle w_1, w_2, \alpha \rangle$ and $w' = \langle w'_1, w'_2, \alpha' \rangle$ and a pair of transformations $\theta_i: w_i \Rightarrow w'_i$ for $i = 1, 2$, such that $\theta_2 \circ \alpha = \alpha' \circ \theta_1: i w_1 \Rightarrow u w'_2$, there exists a unique natural transformation

$$\langle \theta_1, \theta_2 \rangle: w \Rightarrow w'$$

such that $\text{pr}_i \langle \theta_1, \theta_2 \rangle = \theta_i: w_i \Rightarrow w'_i$ for $i = 1, 2$. In summary, we get an isomorphism of groupoids

$$(2.14) \quad \mathbf{gpd}(T, (i/u)) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mathbf{gpd}(T, i) / \mathbf{gpd}(T, u))$$

where $\mathbf{gpd}(G_1, G_2)$ is the groupoid of functors from G_1 to G_2 and natural transformations and $\mathbf{gpd}(G_1, f)$ is post-composition by f as usual.

2.C. Local equivalences.

We now highlight an elementary but important class of morphisms in $\mathbf{gpd}$.

2.15. Definition. A morphism $s: H \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbf{gpd}$ is called a *local equivalence* if for every component $L \in \pi_0(H)$ the composite $L \hookrightarrow H \xrightarrow{s} G$ is fully faithful. In other words, every connected component of H is equivalent via s to some connected component of G . We write $s: H \xrightarrow{\sim} G$ to say that s is a local equivalence. Local equivalences are closed under composition and 2-isomorphism.

2.16. Remark. In $\mathbf{gpd}$, a functor $s: P \rightarrow Q$ is a local equivalence if and only if $\mathrm{End}_P(a) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{End}_Q(s(a))$ is an isomorphism for every object $a \in P$. In particular, the only local equivalences between groups (one-object groupoids) are isomorphisms.

Let us give a more abstract description, that shall work beyond $\mathbf{gpd}$.

2.17. Example. Let $K \in \mathbf{gpd}$ and $n \geq 0$. Then the canonical *folding* functor $\nabla_K^{(n)} = (\mathrm{id}_K, \dots, \mathrm{id}_K): K^{\sqcup n} = K \sqcup \dots \sqcup K \rightarrow K$ is a local equivalence. For $K \neq \emptyset$, the morphism $\nabla_K^{(n)}$ is only fully faithful for $n \leq 1$ and an equivalence for $n = 1$.

These foldings are essentially the only examples of local equivalences:

2.18. Lemma. Let $s: H \xrightarrow{\sim} G$ be a local equivalence in $\mathbf{gpd}$. Then there exists a unique function $n: \pi_0(G) \rightarrow \mathbb{N} = \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ and a (strict) factorization of s as

$$(2.19) \quad H \xrightarrow[\simeq]{\tilde{s}} \bigsqcup_{K \in \pi_0(G)} K^{\sqcup n(K)} \xrightarrow[\simeq]{\bigsqcup_K \nabla_K^{(n(K))}} \bigsqcup_{K \in \pi_0(G)} K = G$$

where $\tilde{s}$ is an equivalence and each $\nabla_K^{(n)}: K^{\sqcup n} \xrightarrow{\sim} K$ is a folding (Example 2.17), and this factorization is unique up to permutation of the factors $K^{\sqcup n}$.

Proof. Let $n(K) = |\pi_0(s)^{-1}(K)|$ be the number of components L of H for which s factors via $\mathrm{incl}_K: K \hookrightarrow G$ (in $\mathbf{gpd}$ this simply means $s(L) \subseteq K$ on objects), in which case s restricts to an equivalence between L and K . These equivalences define $\tilde{s}$. The numbering of $\{1, \dots, n(K)\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \pi_0(s)^{-1}(K)$ is unique up to permutation. $\square$

2.20. Remark. When s is not essentially surjective, one could separate the components K in the essential image of s , for which $n(K) > 0$, from those with $n(K) = 0$.

Local equivalences (Definition 2.15) are closed under pull-back:

2.21. Lemma. Consider an isocomma in $\mathbf{gpd}$ as in (2.11). If u is a local equivalence then pr_1 is a local equivalence.

Proof. For any $(a, b, g) \in (i/u)$, the following diagram of sets is a pullback

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{End}_{(i/u)}(a, b, g) & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{pr}_2} & \mathrm{End}_K(b) \\ \mathrm{pr}_1 \downarrow & & \downarrow u \\ \mathrm{End}_H(a) & \xrightarrow{i} \mathrm{End}_G(i(a)) \xrightarrow[\simeq]{g(-)g^{-1}} & \mathrm{End}_G(u(b)) \end{array}$$

by the definition of isocomma. The claim follows from Remark 2.16. $\square$

Every morphism has a part that is a local equivalence. Let us isolate it.

2.22. *Definition.* For every morphism $p: X \rightarrow Y$ in $\mathbf{gpd}$, we denote by

$$(2.23) \quad X = X^{p^\approx} \sqcup X^{p^\not\approx} \xrightarrow{\begin{pmatrix} p^\approx & p^\not\approx \end{pmatrix}} Y$$

the canonical decomposition of X where $X^{p^\approx}$ is the coproduct of those components of X on which p is fully faithful and $X^{p^\not\approx}$ is the coproduct of all remaining components of X . By construction, $p^\approx$ is a local equivalence $X^{p^\approx} \xrightarrow{\approx} Y$. It is convenient to refer to $X^{p^\approx}$ as the $\approx$ -locus of p .

2.24. *Remark.* Consider two composable morphisms $X \xrightarrow{p} Y \xrightarrow{q} Z$ in $\mathbf{gpd}$. It is unfortunately not true that $(q \circ p)^\approx = q^\approx \circ p^\approx$ in general. For instance, it fails if q is a non-invertible group homomorphism that admits a section and p is one of those sections, for then $X^{(qp)^\approx} = X$ but $X^{p^\approx} = \emptyset$. Yet, if q is *faithful* then $X^{(qp)^\approx} \subseteq X^{p^\approx}$ and $p^\approx(X^{(qp)^\approx}) \subseteq Y^{q^\approx}$ and therefore $(q \circ p)^\approx = q^\approx \circ p^\approx$. (These relations are easy from Remark 2.16.) Consequently, it is preferable to only use faithful morphisms when dealing with $(-)^\approx$ to avoid non-functoriality.

2.D. The (2,1)-category $\mathbb{G}$.

Although the reader can focus attention on $\mathbf{gpd}$ for the rest of the paper, our results actually hold more generally, as in [BD20] and Dell’Ambrogio [Del22].

2.25. *Convention.* We reset the notation of the introduction and denote by

$$\mathbb{G}$$

a (2,1)-category of ‘finite groupoids of interest’, from the following list.

- (1) We can take $\mathbb{G} = \mathbf{gpd}$, all finite groupoids, as in Notation 2.7.
- (2) We can take $\mathbb{G} = \mathbf{gpd}^f$ the 2-full subcategory of $\mathbf{gpd}$ with only faithful morphisms. This context is useful with equivariant categories $\mathcal{A}(G)$ that only have restrictions to subgroups, but no restriction along general group homomorphisms, like $\mathcal{A}(G) = \mathbf{stmod}(kG)$ the stable module category of kG -modules.
- (3) We can take $\mathbb{G} = \mathbf{gpd}_{/\Gamma}^f$ the 2-category of groupoids faithfully embedded into a fixed ‘ambient group’ Γ as in [BD20, Definition B.0.6]. This allows a ‘local’ theory, only involving the subgroups of Γ and conjugation-inclusions, whereas the more ‘global’ examples (1) and (2) involve all finite groups.

We believe that our results extend to *spannable* (2,1)-categories $\mathbb{G}$ in the sense of Dell’Ambrogio [Del22, Definition 3.11], possibly adding the hypothesis that every $\pi_0(G)$ is finite, but we have not verified the details.

2.26. *Remark.* Everything we said in this section about $\mathbf{gpd}$, namely connected components (including finiteness of π_0), faithfulness, isocommas, local equivalences, and the decomposition (2.23), also makes sense in any (2,1)-category $\mathbb{G}$ as in Convention 2.25, via the forgetful functor to $\mathbf{gpd}$. For instance, our $\mathbb{G}$ contains all local equivalences of its underlying groupoids. For isocommas one can use that every object T defines a 2-functor $\mathbb{G}(T, -): \mathbb{G} \rightarrow \mathbf{gpd}$, to translate statements between $\mathbf{gpd}$ and $\mathbb{G}$ via the analogue of (2.14); this is explained in [BD20, Remark 2.1.6].

If we need to restrict to local equivalences, we shall use the following notation.

2.27. *Definition.* We denote by $\mathbb{G}_\approx$ the 2-full subcategory with the same objects as $\mathbb{G}$ but with only local equivalences (Definition 2.15) as morphisms.

2.28. *Remark.* In fact, $\mathbb{G}_\approx$ could be added to the list of Convention 2.25, as an admissible input (2,1)-category $\mathbb{G}$, although a somewhat dull one. It is in some sense a minimal (2,1)-category containing all group isomorphisms (as the $\mathbb{G}_\simeq$ of the Introduction) as well as the inclusions $\text{incl}_{H_i}: H_i \rightarrow H_1 \sqcup H_2$ necessary to formulate additivity as in Remark 2.12. See also Definition 2.29 below.

2.E. Restriction and conjugation 2-functors.

2.29. *Definition.* A *restriction 2-functor* $\mathcal{A}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ is a 2-functor that is *additive*, meaning that the canonical functor of additive categories

$$(\text{incl}_1^* \quad \text{incl}_2^*): \mathcal{A}(G_1 \sqcup G_2) \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}(G_1) \oplus \mathcal{A}(G_2)$$

is an equivalence for every $G_1, G_2 \in \mathbb{G}$, where $\text{incl}_j: G_j \rightarrow G_1 \sqcup G_2$ denotes the inclusion. This definition implies $\mathcal{A}(\emptyset) \simeq 0$. We denote by

$$\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$$

the full 2-subcategory of $2\text{-Fun}(\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}}, \text{ADD})$ of restriction 2-functors $\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$, pseudo-natural transformations and modifications as in Recollection 2.4. In [BD20] this $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ was denoted $2\text{Fun}_{\sqcup}(\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}}, \text{ADD})$.

2.30. *Definition.* A *conjugation 2-functor* $\mathcal{B}$ on $\mathbb{G}$ is an additive 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}_\approx$, that is, a 2-functor $\mathcal{B}: \mathbb{G}_\approx^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ such that the canonical functor

$$(\text{incl}_1^* \quad \text{incl}_2^*): \mathcal{B}(G_1 \sqcup G_2) \longrightarrow \mathcal{B}(G_1) \oplus \mathcal{B}(G_2)$$

is an equivalence for all $G_1, G_2 \in \mathbb{G}$ as above. We denote by

$$\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$$

the 2-subcategory of $2\text{-Fun}(\mathbb{G}_\approx^{\text{op}}, \text{ADD})$ of conjugation 2-functors (Recollection 2.4) with the same morphisms and 2-cells.

2.31. *Remark.* Additivity of $\mathcal{A}$ means that $\mathcal{A}(G) \simeq \bigoplus_{H \in \pi_0(G)} \mathcal{A}(H)$ via the functors $\mathcal{A}(\text{incl}_H): \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(H)$ given by the inclusion of components $H \in \pi_0(G)$. Hence additive 2-functors $\mathcal{A}$ on groupoids are essentially characterized by their values on groups (see [BD20, Lemma 4.3.2]). And the same holds for conjugation 2-functors since the $\text{incl}_H: H \xrightarrow{\sim} G$ are local equivalences, hence belong to $\mathbb{G}_\approx$. This explains the simplified language used in the Introduction, where $\mathbb{G}$ only consisted of finite groups and where $\mathbb{G}_\simeq$ meant ‘isomorphism-only’ (see Remark 2.16).

We do unpack some of our constructions $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ and $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$, for G a group, when we discuss examples in Section 10. This is fine for one G at a time but the 2-functors $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(-)$ and $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(-)$ will be much cleaner when we allow all finite groupoids as input, instead of insisting on finite groups only, especially when we study induction and Mackey formulas (see Remark 2.12).

2.F. Comma 2-categories.

We recall a classical construction for the (2,1)-category $\mathbb{G}$ of Convention 2.25. See [BD20, Definition A.1.21] if necessary.

2.32. *Definition.* Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$ be a fixed object. The *comma 2-category*

$$\mathbb{G}/G$$

consists of objects of $\mathbb{G}$ *over* G , that is, morphisms $(H \rightarrow G)$ in $\mathbb{G}$ with target G . We shall often just write H and call the tacit morphism $H \rightarrow G$ the *structure*

morphism of $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$. To invoke the structure morphism of H , we write it

$$\S_H: H \rightarrow G.$$

A 1-morphism $f: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ consists of a morphism $f: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}$ together with a given compatibility isomorphism with the structure morphisms, namely a 2-cell $\S_H \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_K f: H \rightarrow G$, called the *structure 2-cell* of f . Again, we usually keep it tacit and just write $f: H \rightarrow K$. When needed, the structure 2-cell is denoted

$$\S_f: \S_H \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_K f.$$

The 2-cells $f \Rightarrow f': H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ are simply given by 2-cells $\alpha: f \Rightarrow f'$ in $\mathbb{G}$ compatible with the structure 2-cells, meaning $\alpha \otimes \S_f = \S_{f'}$ as 2-cells $\S_H \Rightarrow \S_K f'$. (Recall Notation 2.3 for $\otimes$.) There is no tacit information in 2-cells.

The compositions in $\mathbb{G}/G$ are the evident ones and make $\mathbb{G}/G$ a $(2,1)$ -category.

2.33. *Example.* We already encountered an example in our Convention 2.25, with the 2-category $\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma$ of groupoids faithfully embedded in a fixed ‘ambient group’ Γ , which is the $\mathbb{G}/G$ of Definition 2.32, for $\mathbb{G} = \mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma$ and G the one-object groupoid Γ .

2.34. *Example.* Let G be a finite group and $H, K \leq G$ be subgroups, viewed as objects of $\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma/G$ with $\S_H = \text{incl}_H: H \rightarrow G$ and similarly for K . A morphism from H to K in $\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma/G$ is a group homomorphism $f: H \rightarrow K$ with structure 2-cell $\S_f: \text{incl}_H \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{incl}_K \circ f: H \rightarrow G$. The latter must be of the form $\S_f = \gamma_g$ for some $g \in G$ such that $\text{incl}_K \circ f = {}^g \text{incl}_H: H \rightarrow G$ (Example 2.8) which forces $f = c_g = {}^g(-): H \rightarrow K$ and therefore $g \in N_G(H, K)$. In particular, the only (local) equivalences $H \xrightarrow{\sim} K$ are the conjugations and all endomorphisms are automorphisms. In particular, we have an isomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} N_G(H) &\xrightarrow{\cong} \text{End}_{\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma/G}(H) = \text{Aut}_{\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma/G}(H) \\ g &\longmapsto c_g: H \xrightarrow{\sim} H \quad \text{with} \quad \S_{c_g} = \gamma_g. \end{aligned}$$

Note that for $g \in N_G(H)$ the condition $c_g = \text{id}_H$ in $\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma$ alone would mean that g belongs to the centralizer of H in G but here we are considering c_g with its structure 2-cell $\S_{c_g} = \gamma_g$ and this pair (c_g, γ_g) is only equal to $\text{id}_{H \rightarrow G}$ in $\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma/G$ if $g = 1$.

Furthermore, given two such endomorphisms $c_g, c_{g'}: H \rightarrow H$ in $\mathbf{gpd}^\Gamma/G$, a 2-cell between them corresponds to some $\gamma_h: c_g \xrightarrow{\sim} c_{g'}$ for $h \in H$ such that $c_{g'} = {}^h c_g = c_{hg}$ and $\gamma_{g'} = \gamma_{hg}: \text{incl}_H \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{incl}_H: H \rightarrow G$, which forces $g' = hg$. In short, such a 2-cell exists if and only if $[g] = [g']$ in $N_G(H)/H$.

2.35. *Convention.* The 2-category $\mathbb{G}/G$ inherits isocommas from $\mathbb{G}$, with a small subtlety. Indeed, given a cospan $H \xrightarrow{i} L \xleftarrow{u} K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$, one can form $H \times_L K = (i/u)$ in $\mathbb{G}$ and this object is clearly ‘over’ G , actually in at least four (isomorphic) ways, via $\S_H \circ \text{pr}_1$, or via $\S_L \circ i \circ \text{pr}_1$, or via $\S_L \circ u \circ \text{pr}_2$, or via $\S_K \circ \text{pr}_2$:

$$(2.36) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & H \times_L K = (i/u) & & \\ & \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ H & & \xrightarrow{\S_{i/u}} & & K \\ & i \searrow & \gamma_{i/u} & \swarrow u & \\ & & L & & \\ & \S_H \searrow & \S_L & \swarrow \S_K & \\ & & G & & \end{array}$$

We choose the structure morphism for $H \times_L K$ to be the leftmost path: $\S_{H \times_L K} := \S_H \circ \text{pr}_1$. This choice minimizes the inverses $(-)^{-1}$ in the structure 2-cells for the projections pr_i , which are $\S_{\text{pr}_1} = \text{id}_{\S_H \text{pr}_1}$ and $\S_{\text{pr}_2} = \S_u^{-1} \otimes \gamma_{i/u} \otimes \S_i$ the obvious composite ‘across’ (2.36). In this way, $\gamma_{i/u}$ becomes an actual 2-cell in $\mathbb{G}/G$.

Let us say a word about how the comma 2-category $\mathbb{G}/G$ varies with G .

2.37. *Construction.* Fix a 1-morphism $j: G' \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$. We have two 2-functors

$$j_!: \mathbb{G}/G' \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G \quad \text{and} \quad j^*: \mathbb{G}/G \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G'$$

on the comma 2-categories. On objects, they are given by

$$j_! H' = H' \quad \text{and} \quad j^* H = G' \times_G H = (j/\S_H)$$

with the obvious structure morphisms $\S_{j_! H'} = j \S_{H'}: H' \rightarrow G' \rightarrow G$ and $\S_{j^* H} = \text{pr}_1: G' \times_G H \rightarrow G'$ the first projection. On morphisms, they are given by

$$j_! f' = f' \quad \text{and} \quad j^* f = G' \times_G f = \langle \text{pr}_1, f \text{pr}_2, \S_f \otimes \gamma_{j/\S_H} \rangle$$

with structure 2-cell $\S_{j_! f'} = j \S_{f'}$ and $\S_{j^* f}$ the identity of $\text{pr}_1 = \text{pr}_1 \circ j^* f$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \begin{array}{ccccc} H' & \xrightarrow{f'} & K' & & \\ \S_{H'} \downarrow & \S_{f'} \searrow & \S_{K'} \searrow & & \\ G' & \xrightarrow{j_! f'} & j_! K' & & \\ \S_{j_! H'} \downarrow & \S_{j_! f'} \searrow & \S_{j_! K'} \searrow & & \\ G & & & & \end{array} & \text{and} & \begin{array}{ccccc} j^* H = G' \times_G H & \xrightarrow{j^* f} & j^* K = G' \times_G K & & \\ \S_{j^* H} = \text{pr}_1 \downarrow & \S_{j^* f} \searrow & \S_{j^* K} \searrow & & \\ G' & \xrightarrow{j^* f} & H & \xrightarrow{f} & K \\ \S_{j^* H} \downarrow & \S_{j^* f} \searrow & \S_H \downarrow & \S_f \searrow & \S_K \searrow \\ G & & G & & G \end{array} \end{array}$$

In this picture, we grayed out all structure morphisms and 2-cells. Note that the top square on the right-hand side commutes on the nose: $\text{pr}_2 j^* f = f \text{pr}_2$. Finally, on 2-cells the 2-functors $j_!$ and j^* are given as follows (recall Notation 2.13):

$$j_!(\alpha) = \alpha \quad \text{and} \quad j^*(\alpha) = G' \times_G \alpha = \langle \text{id}_{\text{pr}_1}, \alpha \text{pr}_2 \rangle.$$

These 2-functors are biadjoints $j_! \dashv j^*$. The unit $\eta: \text{Id} \Rightarrow j^* j_!$ is the pseudo-natural transformation of 2-functors $\mathbb{G}/G' \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G'$ given on every object $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$ by

$$(2.38) \quad \eta_{H'} = \langle \S_{H'}, \text{id}_{H'}, \text{id}_{j \S_{H'}} \rangle: H' \rightarrow (j/\S_{H'}) \quad \text{with structure cell } \text{id}_{\S_{H'}}$$

and compatibility 2-isomorphism $j^* j_!(f') \circ \eta_{H'} \xrightarrow{\sim} \eta_{K'} \circ f'$ for every $f': H' \rightarrow K'$ in $\mathbb{G}/G'$ given by $\langle \S_{f'}, \text{id} \rangle$. The counit $\varepsilon: j_! j^* \Rightarrow \text{Id}$ is the pseudo-natural transformation of 2-functors $\mathbb{G}/G \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G$ given on every object $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ by

$$(2.39) \quad \varepsilon_H = \text{pr}_2: (j/\S_H) \rightarrow H \quad \text{with structure cell } \gamma_{j/\S_H}$$

and strict compatibility $f \circ \varepsilon_H = \varepsilon_K \circ j_! j^* f$ for every $f: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$. Direct computation gives the equalities $(\varepsilon j_!) \circ (j_! \eta) = \text{id}_{j_!}$ and $(j^* \varepsilon) \circ (\eta j^*) = \text{id}_{j^*}$.

2.40. *Remark.* Observe for later use that if j is faithful then $\eta_{H'}: H' \rightarrow G' \times_G H'$ in (2.38) is fully faithful (see [BD20, Example 3.1.15]). Indeed, in that case, pr_2 is faithful and $\text{pr}_2 \circ \eta_{H'} = \text{id}_{H'}$ gives the result.

2.41. *Remark.* The construction $\mathbb{G}/-$ is strictly functorial covariantly, since $(jk)_! = j_!k_!$ for all composable morphisms $G'' \xrightarrow{k} G' \xrightarrow{j} G$. It follows that we get pseudofunctorial right adjoints, i.e. $\mathbb{G}/-$ is contravariantly *pseudofunctorial*, meaning that the composite $\mathbb{G}/G \xrightarrow{j^*} \mathbb{G}/G' \xrightarrow{k^*} \mathbb{G}/G''$ only agrees with $(jk)^*$ up to a coherent natural isomorphism $k^* \circ j^* \cong (jk)^*$. In telegraphic style this reads $G'' \times_{G'} (G' \times_G -) \cong G'' \times_G -$. This canonical isomorphism is close enough to an identity and we treat it as such.

2.42. *Construction.* The covariant and contravariant functors of Construction 2.37 are 2-functorial in $\mathbb{G}$. Let $\alpha: j \xrightarrow{\sim} k: G' \rightarrow G$ be a 2-cell. We have a natural transformation $\alpha_!: j_! \xrightarrow{\sim} k_!$ given by $(\alpha_!)_{H'} = \text{id}_{H'}: j_!H' \rightarrow k_!H'$ with α hiding in the structure 2-cell as $\alpha \S_{H'}$. We also have a natural transformation $\alpha^*: j^* \xrightarrow{\sim} k^*$ given by $(\alpha^*)_H = \langle \text{pr}_1, \text{pr}_2, \gamma_{j/\S_H} \otimes \alpha^{-1} \rangle: j^*(H) = (j/\S_H) \rightarrow (k/\S_H) = k^*(H)$, with identity (of pr_1) as structure 2-cell. (Amusingly, $(-/\S_H)$ tends more naturally to be *contravariant* in the 2-cells. To stick with overall convention in the field, we have applied the harmless involution $\alpha \mapsto \alpha^{-1}$ on 2-cells.)

2.43. *Definition.* We denote by $\mathbb{G}^f/G$ the variant of the comma 2-category of $\mathbb{G}$ over G , where all structure morphisms $\S_H$ are required to be faithful. This forces all morphisms $f: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}^f/G$ to be faithful too, since $\S_K \circ f \cong \S_H$ is faithful. The functor j^* of Construction 2.37 restricts to this setting for any j but the functor $j_!$ only makes sense if $j: G' \rightarrow G$ is faithful. In that case, we still have $j_! \dashv j^*$.

2.G. Span 2-categories.

We can now consider spans inside the comma 2-category $\mathbb{G}/G$. This resembles, but should not be confused with, the bicategory of spans $\text{Span}(\mathbb{G})$ considered in [BD20, Chapter 5]. (For the specialists, we are going to consider a 2-category $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(H, K)$ whose 1-truncation is the 1-category of morphisms from H to K in the bicategory $\text{Span}(\mathbb{G}/G)$ of [BD20]. So we go up one level in the cell tree.)

2.44. *Construction.* Fix $G \in \mathbb{G}$ and two objects $H, K \in \mathbb{G}/G$ in the comma 2-category. So H and K are objects of $\mathbb{G}$ with tacit structure morphisms $\S_H: H \rightarrow G$ and $\S_K: K \rightarrow G$. We define the *span 2-category* $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(H, K)$ as follows.

An object $P = (P, p_1, p_2)$ in $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(H, K)$ is an object $P \in \mathbb{G}/G$ in the comma 2-category together with two morphisms $p_1: P \rightarrow H$ and $p_2: P \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$, that we shall call the left and right *wing morphisms* of the span:

$$(2.45) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & P & & \\ & p_1 \swarrow & & \searrow p_2 & \\ H & & & & K \\ & \S_{p_1} \swarrow & \S_P \downarrow & \searrow \S_{p_2} & \\ & \S_H \swarrow & & \searrow \S_K & \\ & & G & & \end{array}$$

By definition of the comma 2-category $\mathbb{G}/G$, the data of (P, p_1, p_2) comes with tacit information $(\S)$, namely the structure morphism $\S_P: P \rightarrow G$ and the two structure 2-cells $\S_{p_1}: \S_P \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_H p_1$ and $\S_{p_2}: \S_P \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_K p_2$ as pictured above, in gray. These structure 2-cells $\S_{p_i}$ of the wings will be referred to as the *structure 2-cells* of P .

A morphism $s = (s, \sigma_1, \sigma_2)$ between objects $P = (P, p_1, p_2)$ and $Q = (Q, q_1, q_2)$ in $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(H, K)$ consists of a morphism $s: P \rightarrow Q$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ (with its structure 2-cell $\S_s: \S_P \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_Q s$) together with two *wing cells* $\sigma_i: p_i \xrightarrow{\sim} q_i s$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ for $i = 1, 2$.

These ‘wing cells’ do not involve the structure morphisms but must be compatible with structure 2-cells, as every 2-cell in $\mathbb{G}/G$. In expanded form, the morphism $s = (s, \sigma_1, \sigma_2)$ is a diagram in $\mathbb{G}$:

$$(2.46) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & P & & \\ & \swarrow p_1 & \downarrow s & \searrow p_2 & \\ & & Q & & \\ & \swarrow q_1 & \downarrow \S_P & \searrow q_2 & \\ & & H & & K \\ & \swarrow \S_H & \downarrow \S_G & \searrow \S_K & \\ & & G & & \end{array}$$

(Note: The diagram includes 2-cells σ_1, σ_2 between p_i and q_i , and $\S_s$ in the center.)

(spot $\S_s$ in the center) such that $\sigma_1 \otimes \S_{p_1} = \S_{q_1} \otimes \S_s$ as 2-cell $\S_P \Rightarrow \S_H q_1 s: P \rightarrow G$ and $\sigma_2 \otimes \S_{p_2} = \S_{q_2} \otimes \S_s$ as 2-cell $\S_P \Rightarrow \S_K q_2 s: P \rightarrow G$.

Finally, a 2-cell between two morphisms $s = (s, \sigma_1, \sigma_2)$ and $s' = (s', \sigma'_1, \sigma'_2)$ from P to Q in $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(H, K)$ is just a 2-cell $\alpha: s \xrightarrow{\sim} s'$ in $\mathbb{G}$ with compatibility conditions, first with the structure 2-cells: $\S_{s'} = \alpha \otimes \S_s: \S_P \Rightarrow \S_Q s'$ (to be a 2-cell in $\mathbb{G}/G$) and then with the wing cells $\sigma'_i = \alpha \otimes \sigma_i: p_i \Rightarrow q_i s'$ for $i = 1, 2$.

For clarity, the reader may first examine (2.45) and (2.46) while temporarily disregarding the grayed-out structure data. They could also mentally gray-out the σ_i .

All compositions in $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(H, K)$ are the obvious ones, as in $\mathbb{G}/G$.

2.47. *Definition.* Again, we have a variant $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K) = \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}^f/G}(H, K)$ where we only allow faithful morphisms everywhere (once the structure morphisms are faithful then all wing morphisms and all morphisms of spans must be faithful).

2.48. *Remark.* One could define $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{D}}(H, K)$ for any choice of objects H, K in a (2,1)-category $\mathbb{D}$, the above being the cases $\mathbb{D} = \mathbb{G}/G$ or $\mathbb{G}^f/G$. This construction is natural in $\mathbb{D}$ in the essentially straightforward way: a 2-functor $F: \mathbb{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{E}$ yields $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{D}}(H, K) \rightarrow \text{Span}_{\mathbb{E}}(F(H), F(K))$ by applying F to everything in sight. For us, given $j: G' \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$, the two 2-functors $j_!: \mathbb{G}/G' \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G$ and $j^*: \mathbb{G}/G \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G'$ of Construction 2.37 induce 2-functors still denoted

$$j_!: \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G'}(H', K') \rightarrow \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(j_! H', j_! K')$$

for every $H', K' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$, and similarly for every $H, K \in \mathbb{G}/G$

$$j^*: \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}(H, K) \rightarrow \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G'}(j^* H, j^* K).$$

3. MACKEY BUSINESS

Let us recall Mackey 2-functors from [BD20]. See Convention 2.25 for $\mathbb{G}$.

3.A. Mackey squares.

First, we close the notion of isocomma square (2.11) under equivalences.

3.1. *Definition* ([BD20, Definition 2.2.1]). Consider a 2-cell $\alpha: i \circ v \Rightarrow u \circ j$ in $\mathbb{G}$

$$(3.2) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & L & & \\ & \swarrow v & \downarrow \alpha & \searrow j & \\ H & & & & K \\ & \swarrow i & \downarrow & \searrow u & \\ & & G & & \end{array}$$

By slight abuse of language, we refer to it as ‘the square (α) ’ especially in larger diagrams. This square induces a morphism denoted $w = \langle v, j, \alpha \rangle: L \rightarrow (i/u)$ as in (2.14). If w is an equivalence, the square (α) is called a *Mackey square*.

3.3. *Example.* If i and j are equivalences then the square (3.2) is Mackey. See [BD20, Example 2.2.5]. In the same vein, if $i: H \rightarrow G$ is fully faithful then the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & H & \\ \swarrow & \Downarrow_{\text{id}} & \searrow \\ H & & H \\ \searrow & & \swarrow \\ & G & \end{array}$$

is Mackey. Indeed $\Delta_i = \langle \text{id}, \text{id}, \text{id}_i \rangle: H \rightarrow (i/i)$ is fully faithful because i is faithful ([BD20, Proposition 3.1.3]) and Δ_i is essentially surjective because i is full.

3.4. *Example.* Let G be a finite group and $i: H \hookrightarrow G$ and $u: K \hookrightarrow G$ be inclusions of subgroups (Example 2.8). We write a double coset in $K \backslash G / H$ as KgH to indicate that we *choose* a representative g in it. Then the following square is Mackey

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \coprod_{(KgH) \in K \backslash G / H} H \cap K^g & \\ \swarrow v & \Downarrow_{\alpha} & \searrow j \\ H & & K \\ \searrow i & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array}$$

where, on each component $H \cap K^g$, the morphism v is given by the inclusion, the morphism j is given by the conjugation-inclusion $c_g = {}^g(-): H \cap K^g \hookrightarrow K$ and the 2-cell α is given by the conjugation $\gamma_g = {}^g(-): i v \xrightarrow{\sim} u j$. (See Example 2.8.) Indeed, the comparison morphism $w = \langle v, j, \alpha \rangle: \coprod_{(KgH)} H \cap K^g \rightarrow (i/u)$ maps the single object $\bullet$ of $H \cap K^g$ to $(\bullet, \bullet, g)$ in (i/u) . It is an equivalence.

3.5. *Remark.* Elementary properties of isocommas and Mackey squares can be found in [BD20, Section 2.1] and [BD21, Section 3]. In particular, we shall use additivity of isocommas in each variable ([BD21, Lemma 3.8]) and the following:

3.6. **Lemma** ([BD21, Lemma 3.9]). *In a configuration of 2-cells in $\mathbb{G}$ as follows*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \Downarrow_{\alpha} & \\ \swarrow & & \searrow \\ & \Downarrow_{\beta} & \\ \swarrow & & \searrow \end{array}$$

suppose that the bottom square (β) is Mackey. Then the top square (α) is Mackey if and only if the obvious composite square $(\beta \circledast \alpha)$ is Mackey. $\square$

Here is an immediate application.

3.7. Lemma. *Let $j: G' \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$ and $f: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ (Definition 2.32). Then the following commutative square (Construction 2.37) is Mackey:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & j^*H & \\ j^*f \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 \\ j^*K & = & H \\ \text{pr}_2 \searrow & & \swarrow f \\ & K & \end{array}$$

*In particular, if f is a local equivalence then so is j^*f .*

Proof. By definition of $j^*(-) = G' \times_G - = (j/-)$, we have the following diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & j^*H & & \\ & \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ & j^*K & = & H & \\ & \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow f & \\ G' & \xrightarrow{\gamma_j/\S_K} & K & \xrightarrow{\S_f} & H \\ & j \searrow & \S_K \swarrow & & \searrow \S_H \\ & G & & & \end{array}$$

whose lower-left square is an isocomma by definition of j^*K . The composite square is isomorphic to the (outside) isocomma $(j/\S_H)$; indeed f is a morphism in $\mathbb{G}/G$ (with $\S_f: \S_H \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_K \circ f$) and $j^*f := \langle \text{pr}_1, f \text{pr}_2, \S_f \otimes \gamma_j/\S_H \rangle$ satisfies the two equalities under pr_i and whiskers $\gamma_j/\S_K$ into $\S_f \otimes \gamma_j/\S_H$. We conclude by Lemma 3.6.

The final statement about local equivalences follows by Lemma 2.21. $\square$

3.8. Definition. By a *commutative cube of 2-cells in $\mathbb{G}$* we mean a diagram

$$(3.9) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & P' & & & \\ & \text{p}' \swarrow & \xrightarrow[\delta]{\gamma'} & \xrightarrow{r} & P \\ H' & \xrightarrow{s} & K' & \xrightarrow[t]{\beta} & H \\ & \text{u}' \searrow & \xrightarrow[\alpha]{\gamma} & \xrightarrow{u} & G \\ & & & & \end{array}$$

whose six faces $\alpha: ju' \Rightarrow us$, $\beta: jv' \Rightarrow vt$, $\delta: sp' \Rightarrow pr$, $\kappa: tq' \Rightarrow qr$, $\gamma: up \Rightarrow vq$ and $\gamma': u'p' \Rightarrow v'q'$ satisfy $\kappa \otimes \beta \otimes \gamma' = \gamma \otimes \delta \otimes \alpha: ju'p' \Rightarrow vqr$ (in Notation 2.3).

We can construct such a cube by pulling back any square (γ) via Construction 2.37. To be precise, we view P as an object over G via the leftmost path $u \circ p$, as we did in Convention 2.35 for the isocomma. We immediately get:

3.10. Lemma. *Given a square (γ) in $\mathbb{G}$ as in the ‘front’ of (3.9) and given a morphism $j: G' \rightarrow G$, define a cube by applying $j^* = G' \times_G -$ to the square (γ) with r, s, t the second projections $\text{pr}_2: G' \times_G (-) \rightarrow (-)$, so that $H' = G' \times_G H = (j/u)$ and $K' = G' \times_G K = (j/v)$ and $P' = G' \times_G P = (j/up)$ and similarly p', q', u', v' are the images of p, q, u, v under j^* . The faces (α) and (β) are isocommas: $\alpha = \gamma_{j/u}$ and $\beta = \gamma_{j/v}$ and the 2-cells $\delta = \text{id}: sp' = pr$ and $\kappa = \text{id}: tq' = qr$ are identities. The back-cell γ' is $j^*\gamma$. This yields a commutative cube (3.9) such that all four ‘side’ squares (α) , (β) , (δ) and (κ) are Mackey squares.*

Proof. The squares (α) and (β) are isocomma squares, hence Mackey, while (δ) and (κ) are Mackey by Lemma 3.7. $\square$

3.11. Lemma. *Consider a commutative cube of 2-cells as in (3.9), with an opposite pair of ‘side’ squares being Mackey: say (α) and (κ) . If the front square (γ) is Mackey then so is the back square (γ') .*

Proof. Apply Lemma 3.6: $(\kappa^{-1} \otimes \gamma)$ is Mackey, hence so is the isomorphic $(\gamma' \otimes \alpha^{-1})$, hence so is (γ') . $\square$

3.12. Lemma. *Consider a commutative cube of 2-cells as in (3.9) and suppose that the front and back squares (γ) and (γ') are Mackey squares.*

- (a) *If s , t and j are local equivalences then so is r .*
- (b) *If (β) is a Mackey square then so is (δ) .*
- (c) *If t and j are equivalences then the square (δ) is Mackey.*

Proof. Part (a) is an explicit exercise, using Remark 2.16 in **gpd**. Part (b) follows from Lemma 3.6: $(\beta \otimes \gamma')$ is Mackey, hence the isomorphic $(\gamma \otimes \delta)$ is Mackey, hence so is (δ) . Part (c) follows from (b) and Example 3.3. $\square$

Let us combine Mackey squares with the $\approx$ -loci of Definition 2.22.

3.13. Lemma. *Consider a Mackey square (3.2) with u and v local equivalences*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & L & \\ v \swarrow & & \searrow j \\ H & \xrightarrow[\alpha]{\cong} & K \\ i \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array}$$

Then v maps the $\approx$ -locus $L^{j \approx}$ of j into the $\approx$ -locus $H^{i \approx}$ of i , it maps the complement $L^{j \not\approx}$ into the complement $H^{i \not\approx}$, and the resulting two squares are Mackey

$$(3.14) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & L^{j \approx} & \\ v|_{\approx} \swarrow & & \searrow j_{\approx} \\ H^{i \approx} & \xrightarrow[\alpha|_{\approx}]{\cong} & K \\ i|_{\approx} \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array} \quad \text{and} \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & L^{j \not\approx} & \\ v|_{\not\approx} \swarrow & & \searrow j_{\not\approx} \\ H^{i \not\approx} & \xrightarrow[\alpha|_{\not\approx}]{\cong} & K \\ i|_{\not\approx} \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array}$$

where $v|_{\approx} := v|_{L^{j \approx}}$ and $v|_{\not\approx} := v|_{L^{j \not\approx}}$, and where $\alpha|_{\approx} := \alpha|_{L^{j \approx}}$ and $\alpha|_{\not\approx} := \alpha|_{L^{j \not\approx}}$.

Proof. For every connected component M of L , let $I \rightarrow H$ be the connected component of $v(M)$ and $J \rightarrow K$ the connected component of $j(M)$. We get a square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & M & \\ v|_M \swarrow & & \searrow j|_M \\ I & \xrightarrow[\alpha|_M]{\cong} & J \\ i|_I \searrow & & \swarrow u|_J \\ & G & \end{array}$$

Since u and v are local equivalences, $u|_J: J \rightarrow G$ is fully faithful and $v|_M: M \rightarrow I$ is an equivalence. Hence $i|_I$ is fully faithful if and only if $j|_M$ is fully faithful. This gives the decomposition v as a coproduct (without crossed components $L^{j \approx} \rightarrow H^{i \approx}$ or $L^{j \not\approx} \rightarrow H^{i \not\approx}$) and the two resulting squares are Mackey by additivity of isocommas. $\square$

3.B. Mackey 2-functors.

We recall the fundamental notion of [BD20, Definition 2.3.5].

3.15. *Definition.* A *Mackey 2-functor* $\mathcal{M}$ on our 2-category $\mathbb{G}$ (Convention 2.25) is a contravariant 2-functor $\mathcal{M}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ that satisfies the following properties:

- (Mack1) The 2-functor $\mathcal{M}$ is additive (Definition 2.29).
- (Mack2) For every faithful $i: H \rightarrowtail G$ in $\mathbb{G}$, restriction $i^*: \mathcal{M}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(H)$ admits a (special Frobenius) two-sided adjoint $i_* \dashv i^* \dashv i_*$ called ‘induction’.
- (Mack3) For every Mackey square (3.2) with i and j faithful, the left mate $\alpha_! : v^* i^* \xrightarrow{\sim} j^* u^*$ and the right mate $(\alpha^{-1})_*$ of $\mathcal{M}(\alpha^{-1})$

$$\alpha_! : j_* v^* \Rightarrow u^* i_* \quad \text{and} \quad (\alpha^{-1})_* : u^* i_* \Rightarrow j_* v^*$$

are isomorphisms. These are called the *Mackey base-change formulas*.

3.16. *Recollection.* For $i_* \dashv i^*$ and $i^* \dashv i_*$ we need units and counits

$$(3.17) \quad \begin{aligned} \ell\eta : \text{Id} &\Rightarrow i^* i_* & r\eta : \text{Id} &\Rightarrow i_* i^* \\ \ell\varepsilon : i_* i^* &\Rightarrow \text{Id} & r\varepsilon : i^* i_* &\Rightarrow \text{Id}. \end{aligned}$$

satisfying (separate) unit-counit relations. We write $\ell\eta^{(i)}$, etc, if we need to emphasize i . The two-sided adjunction is called ‘special Frobenius’ when the composite of the left unit $\ell\eta : \text{Id} \Rightarrow i^* i_*$ with the right counit $r\varepsilon : i^* i_* \Rightarrow \text{Id}$ is the identity transformation. See [BD20, Appendix A.2] for the mates $\alpha_! = \ell\varepsilon^{(j)} \circledast \alpha^* \circledast \ell\eta^{(i)}$ and $(\alpha^{-1})_* = r\varepsilon^{(i)} \circledast (\alpha^{-1})^* \circledast r\eta^{(j)}$ in (Mack3), writing $\circledast$ as in Notation 2.3.

3.18. *Remark.* The above Definition 3.15 is a condensed version of [BD20, Definition 2.3.5], with Ambidexterity (Mack4) absorbed in (Mack2). By the Rectification Theorem [BD20, Theorem 3.4.3] one can choose the units and counits in (3.17) so that several additional properties become true, for instance $i_* \dashv i^* \dashv i_*$ being special Frobenius (Mack9) as indicated in (Mack2) above. We can also assume (Mack7) which says that $\alpha_!$ is the inverse of $(\alpha^{-1})_*$ in (Mack3). Furthermore, several ‘harmless’ simplifications can be arranged, for instance $(\text{id})_* = \text{id}$ and more generally when i^* is an equivalence, i_* is chosen to be its inverse. We tacitly assume that (co)units (3.17) have been chosen with those extended properties.

3.19. *Recollection* ([BD20, Definition 4.2.2]). A *morphism* $t: \mathcal{M} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}'$ of Mackey 2-functors on $\mathbb{G}$ is a pseudo-natural transformation compatible with restrictions (i.e. a morphism in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$) that preserves induction in the following sense. For every $i: G' \rightarrowtail G$ the right mate $(t_i)_*$ of the compatibility isomorphism $t_i: i^* \circ t_G \xrightarrow{\sim} t_{G'} \circ i^*$

$$(t_i)_* : t_G \circ i_* \Rightarrow i_* \circ t_{G'}$$

is an isomorphism of functors $\mathcal{M}(G') \rightarrow \mathcal{M}'(G)$. (Equivalently, the left mate $(t_i^{-1})_!$ is an isomorphism. In that case, by [BD20, Proposition 6.3.1 (ii)], this $(t_i^{-1})_!$ is the inverse of $(t_i)_*$.) We define the 2-category of Mackey 2-functors

$$\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$$

as the 2-full subcategory of the 2-category of restriction 2-functors $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ with those morphisms. In [BD20] it is denoted $\text{Mack}(\mathbb{G})$. The above notation is coherent with the other 2-categories that we considered:

$$\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}).$$

These forgetful 2-functors are faithful (meaning injective on 2-cells).

4. FOLDING INDUCTION AND TRACES

4.A. Induction along local equivalences.

Our goal in this paper is to approximate restriction 2-functors $\mathcal{A}$ and conjugation 2-functors $\mathcal{B}$ by Mackey 2-functors that will therefore admit induction as in (Mack 2). It is important to notice that even a mere restriction or even a conjugation 2-functor already has *some* induction, thanks to additivity. The local equivalences of Definition 2.15 are the right notion for this. We sometimes refer to this type of easy induction as ‘folding induction’ or ‘folding pushforward’ to distinguish it from the hard-won induction of Mackey 2-functors.

4.1. Proposition (‘Folding’ induction). *Let $\mathcal{B}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a conjugation 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}$ (e.g. a restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$ restricted to local equivalences). Let $s: H \rightarrow G$ be a local equivalence in $\mathbb{G}$. Then $s^*: \mathcal{B}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(H)$ admits a two-sided adjoint such that $s_* \dashv s^* \dashv s_*$ is special Frobenius.*

Proof. In view of Lemma 2.18, it really suffices to understand the adjoints to the diagonal functor $\Delta: \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^n$ for any additive category $\mathcal{C}$ and for $n \geq 0$. Its two-sided adjoint is the biproduct $\bigoplus: \mathcal{C}^n \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$, $(c_1, \dots, c_n) \mapsto c_1 \oplus \dots \oplus c_n$. Choosing the obvious units and counits, one verifies the special Frobenius property. $\square$

4.2. Proposition (Base-change for folding induction). *Consider a Mackey square in $\mathbb{G}$ (Definition 3.1) with s and t local equivalences*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & L & \\ v \swarrow & & \searrow t \\ H & \xrightarrow[\alpha]{\cong} & K \\ s \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array}$$

Let s_* and t_* be two-sided adjoints of s^* and t^* respectively, as in Proposition 4.1.

(a) *Let $\mathcal{A}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a restriction 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}$. Then the left and right mates of $\mathcal{A}(\alpha^{\pm 1})$ yield inverse isomorphisms of functors $\mathcal{A}(H) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(K)$:*

$$\alpha_!: t_* v^* \xrightarrow{\sim} u^* s_* \quad \text{and} \quad (\alpha^{-1})_*: u^* s_* \xrightarrow{\sim} t_* v^*.$$

(b) *Let $\mathcal{B}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a conjugation 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}$. Then the above formulas also hold in $\mathcal{B}$ when they make sense, i.e. if u and v are local equivalences.*

Proof. Using additivity of isocommas ([BD21, Lemma 3.8]) and Lemma 2.18 again, one reduces to the case of an isocomma in which $s = \nabla_H^{(n)}$ is a folding:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & (s/u) & \\ \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 \\ H^{\sqcup n} & \xrightarrow[\gamma]{\cong} & K \\ s = \nabla_H^{(n)} \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & H & \end{array}$$

In that case, one checks that $(s/u) \simeq K^{\sqcup n}$ in such a way that $\text{pr}_1 = u^{\sqcup n}$, that $\text{pr}_2 = \nabla_K^{(n)}$ is also a folding, for the same number n , and that γ is identity. The formulas are then easily verified. They amount to u^* commuting with biproduct $\bigoplus$, which is true in (a) as well as in (b) as soon as u^* exists in ADD. $\square$

4.3. *Remark.* An alternate formulation of Proposition 4.1 is to consider the 2-category $\mathbb{G}_\approx$ of Definition 2.27 as our input $\mathbb{G}$ in Convention 2.25. This is a (2,1)-category with isocommas (Lemma 2.21) on which every additive 2-functor is Mackey (on $\mathbb{G}_\approx$ itself, not on $\mathbb{G}$). In other words

$$(4.4) \quad \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}_\approx) = \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}_\approx) = \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}_\approx) = \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}).$$

Moreover, every transformation between additive 2-functors preserves folding induction, since its components are additive and therefore preserve finite biproducts. See Lemma 8.23. *À vaincre sans péril, on triomphe sans gloire...*

4.5. *Remark.* To be complete, when using the above folding induction, one could also arrange units and counits to satisfy the ‘harmless’ axioms (Mack 5)–(Mack 10) of [BD20, Rectification Theorem 3.4.3], as explained in Remark 3.18 for Mackey 2-functors. This is an easier version of the Rectification Theorem in *loc. cit.*, that we leave to the reader, for instance using Remark 4.3. We will tacitly assume from now on that (co)units are chosen in this ‘rectified’ way.

We can combine the folding induction with the $\approx$ -locus of Definition 2.22.

4.6. **Corollary.** *Consider a Mackey square (α) with u and v local equivalences*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & L & \\ v \swarrow & & \searrow j \\ H & \xrightarrow[\alpha]{\cong} & K \\ i \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array} \xrightarrow{\text{Lemma 3.13}} \begin{array}{ccc} & L^{j\approx} & \\ v|_{\approx} \swarrow & & \searrow j^{\approx} \\ H^{i\approx} & \xrightarrow[\alpha|_{\approx}]{\cong} & K \\ i^{\approx} \searrow & & \swarrow u \\ & G & \end{array}$$

and its restriction to the $\approx$ -loci of i and j , which remains Mackey by Lemma 3.13. For every conjugation 2-functor $\mathcal{B}$, we have a base-change isomorphism $(\alpha|_{\approx})_!$ between the functors $(j^{\approx})_*(v|_{\approx})^* \xrightarrow{\cong} u^*(i^{\approx})_*$ from $\mathcal{B}(H^{i\approx})$ to $\mathcal{B}(K)$, whose inverse is given by $(\alpha^{-1}|_{\approx})_*$.

Proof. This holds by base-change Proposition 4.2 (b) on the right-hand square. $\square$

4.B. Traces.

Let us review the notion of trace that we shall use later on.

4.7. *Definition.* Let $s_* \dashv s^* \dashv s_*$ be a special Frobenius two-sided adjunction between additive categories, say $s^*: \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ and $s_*: \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ (Recollection 3.16). Given two objects c_1, c_2 in $\mathcal{C}$ and a morphism $f: s^*(c_1) \rightarrow s^*(c_2)$ between their images in $\mathcal{D}$, the *trace of f along s_** is the morphism $\text{tr}_{s_*}(f): c_1 \rightarrow c_2$ defined by applying s_* and composing with the relevant unit and counit on the sides:

$$\text{tr}_{s_*}(f): \quad c_1 \xrightarrow[(s^* \dashv s_*)]{r_\eta} s_* s^*(c_1) \xrightarrow{s_*(f)} s_* s^*(c_2) \xrightarrow[(s_* \dashv s^*)]{\ell_\varepsilon} c_2.$$

4.8. *Example.* Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an additive category and $\mathcal{D} = \mathcal{C}^n$. Let $s^* = \Delta: \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be the diagonal functor and $s_* = \bigoplus: \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ be its (special Frobenius) two-sided adjoint given by the biproduct and obvious (co)units. Then for every $c_1, c_2 \in \mathcal{C}$ and every $f = (f_1, \dots, f_n): s^*c_1 = (c_1, \dots, c_1) \rightarrow s^*c_2 = (c_2, \dots, c_2)$ in $\mathcal{C}^n$, the morphism $s_*(f)$ is $\begin{pmatrix} f_1 & & 0 \\ & \ddots & \\ 0 & & f_n \end{pmatrix}: c_1^{\oplus n} \rightarrow c_2^{\oplus n}$ and $\text{tr}_{\bigoplus}(f) = f_1 + \dots + f_n$.

4.9. *Convention.* If s^* is the image of some s in $\mathbb{G}$ via a 2-functor $\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ we simply write tr_s instead of tr_{s_*} and call it the *trace along s* .

Example 4.8 shows that the trace is not functorial, as in linear algebra $\text{tr}(AB) \neq \text{tr}(A)\text{tr}(B)$. However for a constant λ , we have $\text{tr}(\lambda A) = \lambda \text{tr}(A)$. This becomes:

4.10. **Lemma** (Partial functoriality). *In the situation of Definition 4.7, we have*

$$\text{tr}_s((s^*g) \circ f \circ (s^*e)) = g \circ \text{tr}_s(f) \circ e$$

for every $e: c_0 \rightarrow c_1$ and $g: c_2 \rightarrow c_3$ in $\mathcal{C}$ and every $f: s^*(c_1) \rightarrow s^*(c_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}$.

Proof. This follows from naturality of r_η and ℓ_ε . $\square$

4.11. **Lemma.** *Consider a square in ADD (for instance the image of a square (3.2) of groupoids by a 2-functor $\mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$, hence the $(-)^*$ decorations)*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \tilde{\mathcal{D}} & \\ v^* \nearrow & \xrightarrow{\alpha^*} & \nwarrow t^* \\ \mathcal{D} & & \tilde{\mathcal{C}} \\ s^* \nwarrow & & \nearrow u^* \\ & \mathcal{C} & \end{array}$$

Suppose that s^* and t^* admit special Frobenius two-sided adjoints s_* and t_* respectively, and that the left and right mates of α^* yield inverse isomorphisms $\alpha_! : t_* v^* \xrightarrow{\sim} u^* s_*$ and $(\alpha^{-1})_* : u^* s_* \xrightarrow{\sim} t_* v^*$. Then we have

$$(4.12) \quad u^* \circ \text{tr}_s = \text{tr}_t \circ \alpha v^*.$$

More precisely, given two objects $c_1, c_2 \in \mathcal{C}$ and a morphism $f: s^*(c_1) \rightarrow s^*(c_2)$ in $\mathcal{D}$, consider the objects $\tilde{c}_1 = u^*(c_1)$ and $\tilde{c}_2 = u^*(c_2)$ in $\tilde{\mathcal{C}}$ and consider the morphism $\tilde{f}: t^*(\tilde{c}_1) \rightarrow t^*(\tilde{c}_2)$ obtained by ‘adjusting’ $v^*(f)$ with α^* as follows:

$$(4.13) \quad \tilde{f} := \alpha^* v^*(f) (\alpha^*)^{-1} : t^*(u^*(c_1)) \rightarrow t^*(u^*(c_2)).$$

Then (4.12) means $u^*(\text{tr}_s(f)) = \text{tr}_t(\tilde{f})$.

Proof. Applying u^* to the morphism $\text{tr}_s(f)$ of Definition 4.7 gives the top row below

$$(4.14) \quad \begin{array}{ccccccc} u^*(c_1) & \xrightarrow{u^*(r_\eta^{(s)})} & u^* s_* s^*(c_1) & \xrightarrow{u^* s_*(f)} & u^* s_* s^*(c_2) & \xrightarrow{u^*(\ell_\varepsilon^{(s)})} & u^*(c_2) \\ & & \downarrow (\alpha^{-1})_* s^* \simeq & & \uparrow \alpha_! s^* & & \\ & & t_* v^* s^*(c_1) & \xrightarrow{t_* v^*(f)} & t_* v^* s^*(c_2) & & \\ & & \downarrow \simeq t_*(\alpha^*) & & \downarrow \simeq t_*(\alpha^*) & & \\ u^*(c_1) & \xrightarrow{r_\eta^{(t)} u^*} & t_* t^* u^*(c_1) & \xrightarrow{t_*(\tilde{f})} & t_* t^* u^*(c_2) & \xrightarrow{\ell_\varepsilon^{(t)} u^*} & u^*(c_2) \end{array}$$

In the middle column, the top square commutes by naturality of $(\alpha^{-1})_* = (\alpha_!)^{-1}$, whereas the bottom square is obtained by applying t_* to the definition (4.13) of $\tilde{f}$. The two side regions commute by definition of mates, by naturality and by the

unit-counit relations for $s_* \dashv s^* \dashv s_*$; for instance for the right-hand region:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 t_* v^* s^* & \xrightarrow{\alpha! s^*} & u^* s_* s^* & & \\
 \downarrow \scriptstyle t_* v^* \ell_{\eta(s)} s^* & \searrow \scriptstyle \text{(def. of } \alpha!) & \downarrow \scriptstyle \ell_{\varepsilon(t)} u^* s_* s^* & & \\
 (unit-counit) & t_* v^* s^* s_* s^* & \xrightarrow{t_* \alpha^* s_* s^*} & t_* t^* u^* s_* s^* & \xrightarrow{\text{(nat.)}} & u^* \\
 \downarrow \scriptstyle t_* v^* s^* \ell_{\varepsilon(s)} & \searrow \scriptstyle \text{(nat.)} & \downarrow \scriptstyle t_* t^* u^* \ell_{\varepsilon(s)} & & \downarrow \scriptstyle \ell_{\varepsilon(t)} u^* \\
 t_* v^* s^* & \xrightarrow{t_* \alpha^*} & t_* t^* u^* & &
 \end{array}$$

The left-hand region is similar. The bottom row in the commutative diagram (4.14) is the trace of $\tilde{f}$ with respect to t and this gives the result. $\square$

5. CONSTRUCTION OF $(-)_\oplus$

Recall that $\mathbb{G}$ is our 2-category of groupoids of interest as in Convention 2.25. For most of this section we fix a restriction 2-functor, i.e. an additive 2-functor

$$\mathcal{A}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}.$$

We construct for every G in $\mathbb{G}$ an additive category $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ by adjoining induction data to $\mathcal{A}$ along all faithful maps into G . Roughly speaking, an object of $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is an object in $\mathcal{A}(H)$, living over a groupoid $H \rightarrow G$ faithfully embedded in G . A morphism in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ involves spans over G , modulo the trace relations that come from the few inductions already present in $\mathcal{A}$, as explained in Section 4.

The reader should recall the comma 2-categories and the span 2-categories of Section 2, specifically, the 2-category $\mathbb{G}^f/G$ of objects *faithfully* mapped into G (Definition 2.43) and the 2-category $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$ of spans in $\mathbb{G}^f/G$ (Definition 2.47).

5.1. *Construction.* Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. We construct a category $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ as follows.

Objects. An object of $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is a pair (H, x) where $H \in \mathbb{G}^f/G$ is a groupoid faithfully mapped into G and $x \in \mathcal{A}(H)$ is an object in the additive category provided by $\mathcal{A}$ on H . Explicitly, this amounts to a pair $(\S_H: H \rightarrow G, x)$, where $\S_H$ is a faithful functor in $\mathbb{G}$ (called the ‘structure morphism’ for H and usually omitted) and $x \in \mathcal{A}(H)$ is an object defined over H .

Morphism representatives. Given two objects (H, x) and (K, y) in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$, a *morphism representative* $(H, x) \rightarrow (K, y)$ consists of a pair (P, f) whose first entry $P = (P, p_1, p_2) \in \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$ is a span from H to K and whose second entry $f: p_1^*(x) \rightarrow p_2^*(y)$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{A}(P)$ between the pull-backs of x and y along the two ‘wings’ $p_1: P \rightarrow H$ and $p_2: P \rightarrow K$ of the span, see (2.45). In picture:

$$(5.2) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & P & \\ p_1 \swarrow & & \searrow p_2 \\ H & \xrightarrow{\S_P} & K \\ \S_H \swarrow & & \searrow \S_K \\ & G & \end{array} \quad \text{together with} \quad f: p_1^*(x) \rightarrow p_2^*(y) \text{ in } \mathcal{A}(P).$$

Following the artistic direction taken in Subsection 2.F, we gray-out the structure data, to emphasize in black the ‘essential’ part of the morphism, namely $(P, p_1, p_2; f)$.

Relations. The equivalence relation $\approx$ on morphism representatives is the one generated by the *one-step $\approx$ -equivalence* $(P, f) \approx (P', f')$ defined by the existence of a morphism $s: (P, p_1, p_2) \rightarrow (P', p'_1, p'_2)$ in $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$ such that, on the

middle objects, s is a *local equivalence* $P \xrightarrow{\sim} P'$ in $\mathbb{G}$ (Definition 2.15) and such that f' is the *trace* of f along s (Definition 4.7). Let us unpack this relation. The structure data for $s = (s, \sigma_1, \sigma_2)$ is displayed in full in (2.46). The essential part is

$$(5.3) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & P & & \\ & \nearrow p_1 & \downarrow \approx & \nwarrow p_2 & \\ & \xrightarrow{\sim} \sigma_1 & P' & \xleftarrow{\sim} \sigma_2 & \\ & \nwarrow p'_1 & & \nearrow p'_2 & \\ H & & & & K \end{array}$$

For the trace of f along s , one first ‘adjusts’ f using the wing cells σ_1 and σ_2 of s

$$(5.4) \quad f^\sigma := s^*(p'_1{}^*(x)) \xrightarrow[\simeq]{(\sigma_1^*)^{-1}} p_1^*(x) \xrightarrow{f} p_2^*(y) \xrightarrow[\simeq]{\sigma_2^*} s^*(p'_2{}^*(y))$$

to get a morphism in $\mathcal{A}(P)$ between two objects that come via $s^*: \mathcal{A}(P') \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(P)$ and this adjusted morphism f^σ admits a trace along s_* in the sense of Definition 4.7; that trace is a morphism $p'_1{}^*(x) \rightarrow p'_2{}^*(y)$ in $\mathcal{A}(P')$ and we require it to be equal to the given f' . The definition of the trace tr_s uses that $s^*: \mathcal{A}(P') \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(P)$ admits a special Frobenius two-sided adjoint s_* , even though $\mathcal{A}$ is only a 2-functor, and this is the ‘folding pushforward’ of Proposition 4.1 using that s is a local equivalence.

Note in particular the equivalence relations provided by $s: P \xrightarrow{\sim} P'$ an actual equivalence in $\mathbb{G}/G$, which even for $s = \text{id}$ can involve isomorphisms $\sigma_i: p_i \xrightarrow{\sim} p'_i$ that change the wings of P up to isomorphism. This yields a special case of our $\approx$ -equivalence on morphisms that we shall refer to as the *strong $\approx$ -equivalence*.

We write $[P, f]$ for the equivalence class of (P, f) with respect to $\approx$, and we write $[P, p_1, p_2; f]$ when we want to emphasize the wings of the span P .

Composition. Let $[P, f]: (H, x) \rightarrow (K, y)$ and $[Q, g]: (K, y) \rightarrow (L, z)$ be morphisms in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$, with chosen representatives. Choose (T, u, v, γ) any Mackey square in $\mathbb{G}/G$ for P and Q over K , for instance an isocomma (Convention 2.35):

$$(5.5) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & T & & \\ & \nearrow u & \downarrow \approx & \nwarrow v & \\ & P & \downarrow \gamma & Q & \\ p_1 \nearrow & & K & \nwarrow q_1 & \\ p_2 \searrow & & & & L \\ & & \downarrow \S_P & & \\ & & G & & \\ & \nwarrow \S_H & \nearrow \S_L & & \end{array}$$

We define the composite to be

$$[Q, g] \circ [P, f] := [T, g \odot_\gamma f]$$

where $T = (T, p_1 u, q_2 v) \in \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, L)$ has wing morphisms $p_1 u$ and $q_2 v$ obtained by composition in $\mathbb{G}/G$, *structurando structurandis*, and the morphism $g \odot_\gamma f$ in $\mathcal{A}(T)$ is the composition of the restrictions of f and g , suitably ‘matched’ via γ

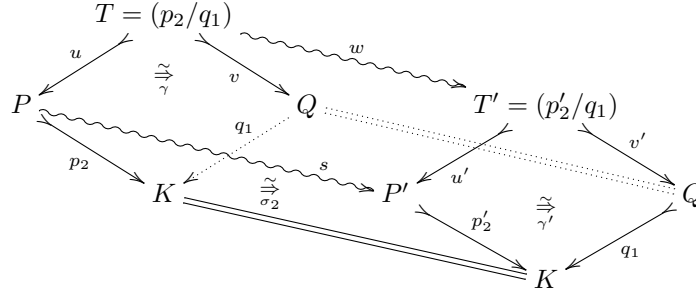
$$(5.6) \quad g \odot_\gamma f := (p_1 u)^*(x) \xrightarrow{u^*(f)} (p_2 u)^*(y) \xrightarrow[\simeq]{\gamma^*} (q_1 v)^*(y) \xrightarrow{v^*(g)} (q_2 v)^*(z).$$

The identity of (H, x) is represented by $(H, \text{id}_H, \text{id}_H; \text{id}_x)$.

5.7. Remark. It is convenient to call H the ‘ $\mathbb{G}$ -part’ of an object (H, x) in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ and to call x the ‘ $\mathcal{A}$ -part’ of (H, x) . Similarly, P is the $\mathbb{G}$ -part of a morphism representative (P, f) and f is its $\mathcal{A}$ -part.

5.8. Proposition. *For every object $G \in \mathbb{G}$, the above Construction 5.1 gives a well-defined additive category $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$.*

Proof. Using ‘strong $\approx$ -equivalences’, we see that composition does not depend on the choice of the Mackey square (5.5). To check that composition $[Q, g] \circ [P, f]$ does not depend on the representatives of the two morphisms $(H, x) \rightarrow (K, y) \rightarrow (L, z)$, it suffices to discuss what happens with the one-step $\approx$ -equivalence on one of the morphisms, one at a time, say for instance the first one. Consider a local equivalence $s: P \xrightarrow{\sim} P'$, where $P = (P, p_1, p_2)$ and $P' = (P', p'_1, p'_2)$, and let $\sigma_1: p_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} p'_1 s$ and $\sigma_2: p_2 \xrightarrow{\sim} p'_2 s$ be the wing cells of s as in (5.3). We form the isocommas $T = (p_2/q_1)$ and $T' = (p'_2/q_1)$ to compose each representative with $(Q, q_1, q_2; g)$ and we want to show that $(T, g \odot f)$ is one-step $\approx$ -equivalent to $(T', g \odot f')$. To see this, we construct the morphism $w = s \times_K \text{id}_Q = \langle su, v, \gamma \otimes \sigma_2^{-1} \rangle: (p_2/q_1) \rightarrow (p'_2/q_1)$:



We are in the situation of Lemma 3.12(c), which guarantees that the square $su = u'w$ is Mackey and consequently w is also a local equivalence by Lemma 2.21. Hence we can apply base-change Lemma 4.11 to f to get $\text{tr}_w(u^*(f)) = u'^*(\text{tr}_s(f))$; note that we do not need to ‘adjust’ $u^*(f)$ as in Lemma 4.11 because the 2-cell $su \xrightarrow{\sim} u'w$ is the identity. Let us switch to telegraphic style, mostly treating 2-cells as identities, to get the idea of the proof, and then restore the details afterwards. We have

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{tr}_w(g \odot_\gamma f) &= \text{tr}_w(v^*(g) \circ u^*(f)) && \text{by (5.6), suppressing } \gamma \\
 &= \text{tr}_w(w^*(v'^*(g)) \circ u^*(f)) && \text{since } v = v'w \\
 &= v'^*(g) \circ \text{tr}_w(u^*(f)) && \text{by partial functoriality Lemma 4.10} \\
 &= v'^*(g) \circ u'^*(\text{tr}_s(f)) && \text{by base-change Lemma 4.11} \\
 &= v'^*(g) \circ u'^*(f') && \text{since } \text{tr}_s(f) = f' \\
 &= g \odot_{\gamma'} f' && \text{by (5.6) again.}
 \end{aligned}$$

This indicates that $(T, g \odot_\gamma f)$ and $(T', g \odot_{\gamma'} f')$ are one-step $\approx$ -equivalent. Let us restore the 2-cells for accuracy. We do this once, as a ‘proof of concept’ but will leave such details to the reader in the sequel. First clarify that the wing cells of w are the following obvious 2-cells, using $u'w = su$ and $v'w = v$:

$$(5.9) \quad p_1 u \xrightarrow{\sigma_1 u} p'_1 s u = p'_1 u' w \quad \text{and} \quad q_2 v \xrightarrow{\text{id}} q_2 v' w.$$

The compatibility with the structure data over G is straightforward. Remembering the sources and targets of $f: p_1^*(x) \rightarrow p_2^*(y)$ and $g: q_1^*(y) \rightarrow q_2^*(z)$, the above ‘short’

proof that $\mathrm{tr}_w(g \odot_\gamma f) = g \odot_{\gamma'} f'$ expands into

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathrm{tr}_w(g \odot_\gamma f) &= \mathrm{tr}_w(\mathrm{id}(g \odot_\gamma f)((\sigma_1 u)^*)^{-1}) && \text{writing wings of } w \text{ (5.9) as in (5.4)} \\
&= \mathrm{tr}_w(v^*(g) \gamma^* u^*(f)((\sigma_1 u)^*)^{-1}) && \text{by (5.6) with explicit } \gamma \\
&= \mathrm{tr}_w(w^*(v'^*(g)) \gamma^* u^*(f) u^*((\sigma_1^*)^{-1})) && \text{since } v = v'w \text{ and } (\sigma_1 u)^* = u^*(\sigma_1^*) \\
&= \mathrm{tr}_w(w^*(v'^*(g) \gamma'^*) u^*(\sigma_2^* f (\sigma_1^*)^{-1})) && \text{since } \gamma \oplus \sigma_2^{-1} = \gamma'w \text{ by def. of } w \\
&= v'^*(g) \gamma'^* \mathrm{tr}_w(u^*(\sigma_2^* f (\sigma_1^*)^{-1})) && \text{by partial functoriality Lemma 4.10} \\
&= v'^*(g) \gamma'^* u'^*(\mathrm{tr}_s(\sigma_2^* f (\sigma_1^*)^{-1})) && \text{by base-change Lemma 4.11} \\
&= v'^*(g) \gamma'^* u'^*(f') && \text{by } \mathrm{tr}_s(f^\sigma) = f', \text{ expanded} \\
&= g \odot_{\gamma'} f' && \text{by (5.6) with explicit } \gamma'.
\end{aligned}$$

From now on, we shall write the short versions of such proofs, as in the first version above, trusting that the reader can restore the ‘adjusting’ 2-cells and the structure over G , as needed.

It is easier to check that composition is unital and associative. For the latter, one can use associativity of isocommas as in [BD20, Remark 2.1.8].

Finally, the category $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is additive. The biproduct is

$$(5.10) \quad (H, x) \oplus (K, y) = (H \sqcup K, (x, y))$$

with the obvious faithful morphism $\S_{H \sqcup K} := (\S_H \ \S_K): H \sqcup K \rightarrow G$ and where $(x, y) \in \mathcal{A}(H) \oplus \mathcal{A}(K)$ is identified with an object of $\mathcal{A}(H \sqcup K)$ by additivity of the 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$. The reader can verify that this produces biproducts in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$, using additivity properties of local equivalences and their traces.

The zero object of $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is $(\emptyset, 0)$ and the zero morphism is $0 = [\emptyset, 0]$. Using the local equivalence $\emptyset \rightarrow P$ whose trace map is zero, one gets that

$$(5.11) \quad [P, 0] = 0$$

for any span $P \in \mathrm{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$.

Once it admits biproducts, our category $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ becomes semi-additive, i.e. has an associative and commutative addition of morphisms, compatible with composition. In our case, say, between the objects (H, x) to (K, y) , it reads as follows:

$$(5.12) \quad [P, f] + [Q, g] = [P \sqcup Q, (f, g)]$$

where $P \sqcup Q$ has the obvious wings $p_i \sqcup q_i$ for $i = 1, 2$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ and where the morphism $(f, g): (p_1^* x, q_1^* x) \rightarrow (p_2^* y, q_2^* y)$ in the category $\mathcal{A}(P \sqcup Q) \cong \mathcal{A}(P) \oplus \mathcal{A}(Q)$ is defined component-wise. In the special case where both morphisms have the same span $P = Q$, $p_1 = q_1$, $p_2 = q_2$, we actually have

$$(5.13) \quad [P, f] + [P, g] = [P, f + g].$$

This uses the local equivalence $s = \nabla_P^{(2)} = (\mathrm{id}_P \ \mathrm{id}_P): P \sqcup P \rightarrow P$ (with trivial wing cells $\sigma_1 = \mathrm{id}_{(p_1 \ p_1)}$ and $\sigma_2 = \mathrm{id}_{(p_2 \ p_2)}$) for which $s^* = \Delta: \mathcal{A}(P) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(P) \oplus \mathcal{A}(P)$ is the diagonal, and whose trace satisfies $\mathrm{tr}_s(f, g) = f + g$ by Example 4.8.

By (5.13) and (5.11), addition of morphisms admits an opposite: $-[P, f] = [P, -f]$. Therefore $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is not only semi-additive but plain additive. $\square$

5.14. *Remark.* We record for future use the special addition of morphisms (5.13) in case they have the same $\mathbb{G}$ -part. One proves in similar fashion the special addition of objects with same $\mathbb{G}$ -part (instead of (5.10) in general):

$$(H, x_1) \oplus (H, x_2) \cong (H, x_1 \oplus x_2).$$

We now turn to the variance of $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ in G with respect to restriction.

5.15. *Construction.* Let $j: G' \rightarrow G$ be a morphism in $\mathbb{G}$. The restriction functor

$$j^*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$$

uses Construction 2.37 on the groupoid part. On an object (H, x) we set

$$j^*(H, x) := (j^*H, \text{pr}_2^*(x))$$

where $j^*H = G' \times_G H$ is the pullback, which lives over G' via pr_1 (Construction 2.37) and where the morphisms pr_1 and pr_2 come from the isocomma square

$$(5.16) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & j^*H & \\ \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & \xrightarrow{\gamma_j / \S_H} & \searrow \text{pr}_2 \\ G' & & H \\ & \searrow j & \swarrow \S_H \\ & G & \end{array}$$

so that $\text{pr}_2^*(x)$ belongs to $\mathcal{A}(j^*H)$ as required. To give $j^*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$ on morphisms, let $(P, p_1, p_2; f): (H, x) \rightarrow (K, y)$ be a morphism representative in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$. Applying $j^* = (j/-)$ as in Lemma 3.10 (or Remark 2.48) we obtain a commutative cube of 2-cells (Definition 3.8)

$$(5.17) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & P' & & & \\ & \swarrow p'_1 & \searrow p'_2 & \searrow p & \\ j^*H & & j^*K & & P \\ & \searrow \text{pr}_1 & \swarrow \text{pr}_1 & \swarrow \text{pr}_2 & \swarrow p_1 \\ & G' & & H & & P \\ & & & \searrow j & \searrow \S_H & \searrow \S_K \\ & & & G & & K \end{array}$$

all of whose four side faces are Mackey squares with moreover $\text{pr}_2 p'_1 = p_1 p: P' \rightarrow H$ and $\text{pr}_2 p'_2 = p_2 p: P' \rightarrow K$. Consequently $p^*(f)$ is a morphism from $(p'_1)^*(\text{pr}_2^* x)$ to $(p'_2)^*(\text{pr}_2^* y)$ in $\mathcal{A}(P')$ and we can define

$$j^*(P, p_1, p_2; f) = (P', p'_1, p'_2; p^*(f))$$

as a morphism representative from $j^*(H, x)$ to $j^*(K, y)$ in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$. This construction preserves $\approx$ -equivalence of morphisms:

5.18. **Proposition.** *For every $j: G' \rightarrow G$, Construction 5.15 gives a well-defined additive functor $j^*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$.*

Proof. Straightforward by applying $j^* = (j/-)$ to all groupoids (Lemma 3.10) and pulling-back the data in $\mathcal{A}(-)$ accordingly. For the $\approx$ -equivalence of morphisms, use that pull-backs of local equivalences remain local equivalences (Lemma 2.21) and the base-change for traces (Lemma 4.11). For j^* preserving composition, use that $j^*: \mathbb{G}/G \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G'$ preserves Mackey squares (Lemma 3.11). $\square$

5.19. *Construction.* Let $\alpha: j \Rightarrow k$ be a 2-cell in $\mathbb{G}$, for $j, k: G' \rightarrow G$. We define a natural transformation $\alpha^*: j^* \Rightarrow k^*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$ as follows. Let $(H, x) \in$

$\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ be an object. Recall that $j^*(H, x) = (j^*H, \text{pr}_2^*(x))$ where

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & j^*H & \\ \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 \\ G' & \xrightarrow[\gamma_{j/\S_H}]{\cong} & H \\ j \searrow & & \swarrow \S_H \\ & G & \end{array}$$

is the isocomma square $(j/\S_H)$, and similarly $k^*(H, x) = (k^*H, \text{pr}_2^*(x))$. The 2-cell α induces a morphism $(\alpha/\S_H): j^*H = (j/\S_H) \rightarrow (k/\S_H) = k^*H$ (Construction 2.42) defined by $(\alpha/\S_H) = \langle \text{pr}_1, \text{pr}_2, \gamma_{j/\S_H} \otimes \alpha^{-1} \rangle$. We define the morphism

$$\alpha_{(H,x)}^* := [j^*H, \text{id}_{j^*H}, (\alpha/\S_H); \text{id}_{\text{pr}_2^*(x)}]: j^*(H, x) \rightarrow k^*(H, x)$$

in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$, which makes sense because $\text{pr}_2 \circ (\alpha/\S_H) = \text{pr}_2$. This construction is natural in (H, x) and therefore defines a natural transformation

$$\alpha^*: j^* \Rightarrow k^*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G').$$

5.20. Proposition. *The above Constructions 5.1, 5.15 and 5.19 define a 2-functor $\mathcal{A}_\oplus: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$.*

Proof. The data has been made explicit and verifications are straightforward. $\square$

5.21. Remark. If the reader does not want to treat the canonical groupoid identification $G'' \times_{G'} G' \cong G'$ as an equality, as we decided to do in Remark 2.41, then the above $\mathcal{A}_\oplus$ is only a *pseudo*-functor. See strictification in Recollection 2.4.

We now turn to induction for $\mathcal{A}_\oplus$.

5.22. Construction. Let $j: G' \rightarrowtail G$ be faithful. We define induction

$$j_*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G') \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$$

on objects by

$$j_*(H', x') := (j_!H', x')$$

where $j_!: \mathbb{G}/G' \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G$ is as in Construction 2.37, namely simply $j_!H' = H'$ with structure morphism over G given by $\S_{j_!H'} = j \circ \S_{H'}$. Similarly on morphisms

$$j_*[P', f'] := [j_!P', f'].$$

5.23. Proposition. *For every $j: G' \rightarrowtail G$, the above defines an additive functor*

$$j_*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G') \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G).$$

Proof. The functor j_* leaves the spans and the morphisms in $\mathcal{A}$ unchanged and only composes the structural 2-cells with j . Hence it preserves identities, composition, and addition. Since the equivalence relation is generated by traces along local equivalences and j_* does not alter the data involved in the trace construction, it respects this relation. It follows that j_* is a well-defined additive functor. $\square$

5.24. Proposition. *For every faithful $j: G' \rightarrowtail G$, the functor $j_*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G') \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is a special Frobenius two-sided adjoint $j_* \dashv j^* \dashv j_*$ of $j^*: \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$.*

Proof. For $j_* \dashv j^*$ and $j^* \dashv j_*$ we need natural transformations as in (3.17)

$$(5.25) \quad \begin{array}{ll} \ell\eta: \text{Id} \Rightarrow j^*j_* & r\eta: \text{Id} \Rightarrow j_*j^* \\ \ell\varepsilon: j_*j^* \Rightarrow \text{Id} & r\varepsilon: j^*j_* \Rightarrow \text{Id}. \end{array}$$

We begin with ${}^\ell\eta: \text{Id}_{\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')} \Rightarrow j^*j_*$. Let $(H', x') \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$. We have

$$j^*j_*(H', x') = (j^*j_!H', \text{pr}_2^*(x'))$$

where $j^*j_!H' = (j/j\mathbb{S}_{H'}) = G' \times_G H'$ and $\text{pr}_2: j^*j_!H' \rightarrow H'$ is the second projection.

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & H' & & \\ & \searrow \mathbb{S}_{H'} & \downarrow \eta_{H'} & \searrow \text{id} & \\ & & j^*j_!H' & & \\ & \swarrow \text{pr}_1 & \xrightarrow[\gamma_j/j\mathbb{S}_{H'}]{\cong} & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ G' & & & & H' \\ & \searrow j & & \swarrow j\mathbb{S}_{H'} & \\ & & G & & \end{array}$$

We already saw in (2.38) the unit $\eta_{H'} = \langle \mathbb{S}_{H'}, \text{id}_{H'}, \text{id}_{j\mathbb{S}_{H'}} \rangle: H' \rightarrow j^*j_!H'$ for the $j_! \dashv j^*$ adjunction on comma categories. Define the morphism in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$

$$(5.26) \quad {}^\ell\eta_{(H', x')} := [H', \text{id}_{H'}, \eta_{H'}; \text{id}_{x'}]: (H', x') \rightarrow j^*j_*(H', x') = (j^*j_!H', \text{pr}_2^*(x'))$$

using that $\text{pr}_2 \circ \eta_{H'} = \text{id}_{H'}$. In our representation (5.2), this ${}^\ell\eta_{(H', x')}$ is given by

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H' & \xrightarrow{\eta_{H'}} & j^*j_!H' \\ \parallel & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\text{id}} & \\ H' & \xrightarrow[\mathbb{S}_{H'}]{} & G' \xleftarrow{\text{pr}_1} j^*j_!H' \end{array} \quad \text{with} \quad \text{id}: x' \rightarrow \eta_{H'}^*(\text{pr}_2^*(x')) = x' \text{ in } \mathcal{A}(H').$$

We must check that ${}^\ell\eta_{H'}$ is natural in H' . We are not going to expand every single one of those verifications as proof of concept but we do provide the details in this first occurrence. Let $[P', f']: (H', x') \rightarrow (K', y')$ be a morphism in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$, where $P' = (P', p'_1, p'_2) \in \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G'}^f(H', K')$ and where $f': p'_1(x') \rightarrow p'_2(y')$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{A}(P')$. We must prove that

$$(5.27) \quad j^*j_*([P', f']) \circ {}^\ell\eta_{(H', x')} = {}^\ell\eta_{(K', y')} \circ [P', f'].$$

For the right-hand side, the composition diagram in $\mathbb{G}^f/G'$ is

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & P' & & \\ & \searrow p'_1 & \parallel & \searrow p'_2 & \\ H' & & P' & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\text{id}_{p'_2}} & K' \\ & \searrow p'_2 & & \searrow \eta_{K'} & \\ & & K' & & j^*j_!K' \end{array}$$

whose square is Mackey by Example 3.3. Since $\text{id} \odot_{\text{id}} f' = f'$, the right-hand side of (5.27) is $[P', p'_1, \eta_{K'}p'_2; f']$. For the left-hand side, the composition diagram is

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & P' & & \\ & \searrow p'_1 & \searrow \eta_{P'} & & \\ H' & & j^*j_!P' & & \\ \parallel & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\text{id}} & & \searrow j^*j_*p'_2 & \\ H' & \xrightarrow[\eta_{H'}]{} & j^*j_!H' & \xrightarrow{j^*j_*p'_1} & j^*j_!K' \end{array}$$

where the 2-cell identity comes from the naturality of η in the adjunction $j_! \dashv j^*$, as in the left-hand square below:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} P' & \xrightarrow{\eta_{P'}} & j^* j_! P' & \xrightarrow{\text{pr}_2} & P' \\ p'_1 \downarrow & & j^* j_* p'_1 = G' \times_G P'_1 & & \downarrow p'_1 \\ H' & \xrightarrow{\eta_{H'}} & j^* j_! H' & \xrightarrow{\text{pr}_2} & H'. \end{array}$$

In this commutative diagram the composite square is Mackey (Example 3.3) for $\text{pr}_2 \eta = \text{id}$, and the right-hand square is Mackey by Lemma 3.7. Hence the left-hand square is Mackey by Lemma 3.6. Using similarly that $j^* j_* p'_2 \circ \eta_{P'} = \eta_{K'} \circ p'_2$ the left-hand side of (5.27) is $[P', p'_1, \eta_{K'} p'_2; f']$, matching the right-hand side.

We now define ${}^\ell \varepsilon: j_* j^* \Rightarrow \text{Id}_{\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)}$ in (5.25). Let $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$. We have

$$j_* j^*(H, x) = (j_! j^* H, \text{pr}_2^*(x))$$

where $j_! j^* H = G' \times_G H = (j/\S_H)$ and $\text{pr}_2: j^* H \rightarrow H$ is the projection. We already saw in (2.39) the counit $\varepsilon_H = \text{pr}_2: j_! j^* H \rightarrow H$ and we can define the morphism

$$(5.28) \quad {}^\ell \varepsilon_{(H, x)} := [j_! j^* H, \text{id}, \varepsilon_H; \text{id}_{\text{pr}_2^* x}]: j_* j^*(H, x) = (j_! j^* H, \text{pr}_2^*(x)) \longrightarrow (H, x)$$

or represented in the style of (5.2)

$$\begin{array}{c} \begin{array}{ccccc} & & j_! j^* H & & \\ & \swarrow & \downarrow & \searrow & \\ j_! j^* H & = & \S_{j_! j^* H} & \xrightarrow{\gamma_{j/\S_H}} & H \\ & \searrow & \downarrow & \swarrow & \\ & & G & & \end{array} \quad \text{with} \quad \text{id}_{\text{pr}_2^*(x)}: \text{pr}_2^*(x) \rightarrow \varepsilon_H^*(x) = \text{pr}_2^*(x). \end{array}$$

The proof of the naturality of ${}^\ell \varepsilon_{(H, x)}$ in $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is similar to the above one, using naturality of ε and Lemma 3.7 again. It is omitted. In particular, it does not use any trace relation.

We verify the triangle identities for $j_* \dashv j^*$. Let $(H', x') \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$. To see that ${}^\ell \varepsilon_{j_*(H', x')} \circ j_*({}^\ell \eta_{(H', x')}) = \text{id}_{j_*(H', x')}$, we compute

$$j_*({}^\ell \eta_{(H', x')}) = [H', \text{id}_{H'}, \eta_{H'}; \text{id}] \quad \text{and} \quad {}^\ell \varepsilon_{j_*(H', x')} = [j_! j^* j_! H', \text{id}, \varepsilon_{j_! H'}; \text{id}]$$

and compose the spans as in the following diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & H' & & \\ & \swarrow & \downarrow & \searrow & \\ H' & = & H' & \xrightarrow{\eta_{H'}} & j^* j_! H' \\ & \searrow & \downarrow & \swarrow & \\ & & j^* j_! H' & & H' \end{array}$$

whose square is Mackey by Example 3.3. The morphism part is the identity. Since $\text{pr}_2 \circ \eta_{H'} = \text{id}$, we get the result. For the other unit-counit relation, let $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ and let us check $j^*({}^\ell \varepsilon_{(H, x)}) \circ {}^\ell \eta_{j^*(H, x)} = \text{id}_{j^*(H, x)}$. Direct computation gives

$${}^\ell \eta_{j^*(H, x)} = [j^* H, \text{id}_{j^* H}, \eta_{j^* H}; \text{id}] \quad \text{and} \quad j^*({}^\ell \varepsilon_{(H, x)}) = [j^* j_! j^* H, \text{id}_{j^* j_! j^* H}, j^*(\varepsilon_H); \text{id}].$$

The composition diagram is

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 & & j^* H & & \\
 & \nearrow & \eta_{j^* H} & \searrow & \\
 j^* H & \xrightarrow{\eta_{j^* H}} & j^* j_! j^* H & \xrightarrow{j^*(\varepsilon_H)} & j^* H \\
 & \nwarrow & \text{id} & \swarrow & \\
 & & j^* H & &
 \end{array}$$

whereas the morphism part is again the identity. We conclude from the triangle identity for $j_! \dashv j^*$ on comma categories, namely $j^*(\varepsilon_H) \circ \eta_{j^* H} = \text{id}_{j^* H}$.

Thus $j_* \dashv j^*$.

Similarly, we can give the unit and counit r_η and r_ε in (5.25) for the right adjunction $j^* \dashv j_*$. In fact they can be described from the left ones (5.26) and (5.28) by applying an obvious transposition on the spans $\text{Span}(H, K) \rightarrow \text{Span}(K, H)$, swapping the legs, and by keeping the identities in the morphism-parts, giving:

$$(5.29) \quad r_{\eta_{(H,x)}} := [j_! j^* H, \varepsilon_H, \text{id}_{j_! j^* H}; \text{id}_{\text{pr}_2^* x}]: (H, x) \rightarrow j_* j^*(H, x)$$

for every $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ – compare (5.28) – and

$$(5.30) \quad r_{\varepsilon_{(H',x')}} := [H', \eta_{H'}, \text{id}_{H'}; \text{id}_{x'}]: j^* j_*(H', x') \rightarrow (H', x')$$

for every $(H', x') \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$ – compare (5.26). The reader will verify naturality of r_η and r_ε as well as the unit-counit relations for $j^* \dashv j_*$.

It remains to check the special Frobenius property. For $(H', x') \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$, the composite of ${}^\ell \eta_{(H',x')} = [H', \text{id}_{H'}, \eta_{H'}; \text{id}_{x'}]$ in (5.26) followed by $r_{\varepsilon_{(H',x')}} = [H', \eta_{H'}, \text{id}_{H'}; \text{id}_{x'}]$ in (5.30) is easily seen to be the identity $[H', \text{id}]$ once we observe that the commutative square

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 & H' & \\
 \text{id}_{H'} \swarrow & & \searrow \text{id}_{H'} \\
 H' & = & H' \\
 \eta_{H'} \searrow & & \swarrow \eta_{H'} \\
 & j^* j_! H' &
 \end{array}$$

is Mackey by Example 3.3, since $\eta_{H'}$ is fully faithful (Remark 2.40). $\square$

5.31. Proposition (Base-change for $\mathcal{A}_\oplus$). *Let*

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 & & L & & \\
 & \swarrow v & & \searrow j & \\
 H & & & & K \\
 & \searrow i & \cong_\alpha & \swarrow u & \\
 & & G & &
 \end{array}$$

be a Mackey square in $\mathbb{G}$, with i and j faithful. Then the left and right mates of α^*

$$(\alpha^{-1})_*: u^* i_* \xrightarrow{\sim} j_* v^* \quad \text{and} \quad \alpha_!: j_* v^* \xrightarrow{\sim} u^* i_*$$

are inverse isomorphisms between functors from $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(H)$ to $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(K)$.

Proof. We compute the two mates on $(X, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(H)$, with $\S_X: X \rightarrow H$. We have

$$(5.32) \quad u^* i_*(X, x) = (u^* i_! X, \text{pr}_2^* x) \quad \text{and} \quad j_* v^*(X, x) = (j_! v^* X, \text{pr}_2^* x)$$

where $u^*i_!X = (u/i^*\S_X) = K \times_G X$ and $j_!v^*X = (v/\S_X) = L \times_H X$. These two objects of $\mathbb{G}$ appear in the following diagram (at the top):

$$(5.33) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & K \times_G X & & \\ & \swarrow \text{pr}_1 & \cong \uparrow e_X & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ & L \times_H X & & & \\ & \swarrow \text{pr}_1 & \xrightarrow{\gamma_{v/\S_X}} & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ K & \xleftarrow{j} L & & & X \\ & \searrow \alpha^{-1} & \xrightarrow{v} & \searrow \S_X & \\ & G & \xleftarrow{i} & & \\ & \swarrow u & & \searrow i^*\S_X & \end{array}$$

The outer square is an isocomma and the juxtaposition of the two inner isocommas is a Mackey square. Hence we have an equivalence

$$e_X = \langle j \text{pr}_1, \text{pr}_2, \gamma_{v/\S_X} \otimes \alpha^{-1} \rangle : L \times_H X \xrightarrow{\sim} K \times_G X.$$

Note in particular that $e_X^*(\text{pr}_2^*x) = \text{pr}_2^*x$. We claim that the two base-change mates are given as follows:

$$((\alpha^{-1})_*)_{(X,x)} = [L \times_H X, e_X, \text{id}; \text{id}_{\text{pr}_2^*x}] : u^*i_*(X, x) \rightarrow j_*v^*(X, x)$$

where $u^*i_*(X, x)$ and $j_*v^*(X, x)$ are described in (5.32), while

$$(\alpha_!)_{(X,x)} = [L \times_H X, \text{id}, e_X; \text{id}_{\text{pr}_2^*x}] : j_*v^*(X, x) \rightarrow u^*i_*(X, x).$$

This is a direct verification using $\alpha_! = \ell_{\varepsilon(j)} \otimes \alpha^* \otimes \ell_{\eta(i)}$ and $(\alpha^{-1})_* = r_{\varepsilon(i)} \otimes (\alpha^{-1})^* \otimes r_{\eta(j)}$ and the formulas for those (co)units in (5.26), (5.28), (5.29) and (5.30). Even easier is the verification that the above two morphisms are inverse to each other, using the Mackey squares over equivalences provided by Example 3.3. $\square$

Finally, we allow the restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$, that was fixed so far, to vary.

5.34. *Construction.* Let $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'$ be a morphism in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ and let us define $t_{\oplus}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'_{\oplus}$. For every $G \in \mathbb{G}$ define the additive functor $(t_{\oplus})_G: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'_{\oplus}(G)$ on objects by $(H, x) \mapsto (H, t_H(x))$ and on morphisms by $(P, f) \mapsto (P, t_P(f))$, where $t_P(f)$ is ‘adjusted’ by the restriction-compatibility isomorphisms of t :

$$p_1^*t_H(x) \xrightarrow[\cong]{(t_{p_1})_x} t_P(p_1^*x) \xrightarrow{t_P(f)} t_P(p_2^*y) \xrightarrow[\cong]{(t_{p_2})_y^{-1}} p_2^*t_K(y)$$

For every $j: G' \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$, the compatibility isomorphism $(t_{\oplus})_j: \mathcal{A}'_{\oplus}(j) \circ (t_{\oplus})_G \xrightarrow{\sim} (t_{\oplus})_{G'} \circ \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(j)$ is given on $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G)$ and with the notation of (5.16) by

$$[j^*H, \text{id}, \text{id}; t_{\text{pr}_2}] : (j^*H, \text{pr}_2^*(t_H(x))) \xrightarrow{\sim} (j^*H, t_{j^*H}(\text{pr}_2^*(x)))$$

in $\mathcal{A}'_{\oplus}(G')$, which is trivial on the ‘ $\mathbb{G}$ -part’ and t from the $\mathcal{A}$ -part to the $\mathcal{A}'$ -part. Finally, let $m: t \Rightarrow t': \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'$ be a modification. We define a modification $m_{\oplus}: t_{\oplus} \Rightarrow t'_{\oplus}$ as follows. For every $G \in \mathbb{G}$, the component $(m_{\oplus})_G: (t_{\oplus})_G \Rightarrow (t'_{\oplus})_G$ is the natural transformation whose component at $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G)$ is

$$(m_{\oplus})_{G,(H,x)} := [H, \text{id}_H, \text{id}_H; m_{H,x}] : (H, t_H(x)) \rightarrow (H, t'_H(x))$$

in $\mathcal{A}'_{\oplus}(G)$. One verifies that $\mathcal{A} \mapsto \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}$ is a 2-functor $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$.

5.35. Theorem. *For every restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$, the 2-functor $\mathcal{A}_\oplus: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ is a Mackey 2-functor. Together with Construction 5.34 we obtain a 2-functor*

$$(-)_\oplus: \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \longrightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$$

meaning that for every transformation $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'$ in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$, the associated transformation $t_\oplus: \mathcal{A}_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'_\oplus$ is compatible with induction.

Proof. We already have all ingredients to prove that $\mathcal{A}_\oplus$ is a Mackey 2-functor. Additivity (Mack1) is a straightforward consequence of additivity of $\mathcal{A}$. The two-sided special Frobenius adjunction (Mack2) is Proposition 5.24. The base-change (Mack3) is Proposition 5.31. To see that $t_\oplus$ commutes with induction of Construction 5.22, we use here that nothing at all happens on the $\mathcal{A}$ -part, and hardly anything to the $\mathbb{G}/G$ -part as a matter of fact:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (H', x' \in \mathcal{A}(H')) & \xrightarrow{(t_\oplus)_{G'}} & (H', t_{H'}(x') \in \mathcal{A}'(H')) \\ j_* \downarrow \text{ in } \mathcal{A}_\oplus & & j_* \downarrow \text{ in } \mathcal{A}'_\oplus \\ (j_! H', x' \in \mathcal{A}(H')) & \xrightarrow{(t_\oplus)_G} & (j_! H', t_{H'}(x') \in \mathcal{A}'(H')). \end{array}$$

Similarly for morphisms, which gives the result. $\square$

6. BIADJUNCTION FOR $(-)_\oplus$

We write $U := \text{forget}: \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ for the forgetful 2-functor from Mackey 2-functors to restriction 2-functors. We prove the universal property of the 2-functor $(-)_\oplus$ constructed in Section 5, as announced in Theorem 1.1. In fact, we prove slightly more, namely we establish that $(-)_\oplus$ is a left biadjoint to U . To this end, we construct a morphism of restriction 2-functors ${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow U(\mathcal{A}_\oplus)$ for every $\mathcal{A} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ and a morphism of Mackey 2-functors ${}_\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}: (U\mathcal{M})_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ for every $\mathcal{M} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$.

6.1. Construction. Let $\mathcal{A} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ be a restriction 2-functor (Definition 2.29). We define a morphism of restriction 2-functors

$${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow U(\mathcal{A}_\oplus).$$

Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. On an object $x \in \mathcal{A}(G)$, set

$${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}(x) := (G, x) = (G \xrightarrow{\text{id}_G} G, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G).$$

On a morphism $f: x \rightarrow y$ in $\mathcal{A}(G)$, set

$${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}(f) := [G, \text{id}_G, \text{id}_G; f]: (G, x) \rightarrow (G, y).$$

6.2. Proposition. *Construction 6.1 yields a morphism of 2-functors*

$${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow U(\mathcal{A}_\oplus).$$

Proof. First, for every $G \in \mathbb{G}$, the functor ${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}: \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ is additive by Remark 5.14. For the compatibility with restriction, we need for every $j: G' \rightarrow G$ a natural isomorphism ${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},j}: j^* \circ {}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G} \xrightarrow{\sim} {}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G'} \circ j^*$ of functors $\mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G')$.

For every $x \in \mathcal{A}(G)$, we have $j^*(\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A},G}(x)) = (G' \times_G G, \text{pr}_2^* x)$ and $\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A},G'}(j^*(x)) = (G', j^* x)$. We define our isomorphism $(\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A},j})_x$ by

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & G' \times_G G & & \\ & \swarrow \text{id} & \downarrow \text{pr}_1 & \searrow \text{id} & \\ G' \times_G G & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\text{id}} & & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\text{id}} & G' \\ & \searrow \text{pr}_1 & \downarrow \text{id}_{G'} & \swarrow \text{id}_{G'} & \\ & & G' & & \end{array} \quad \text{with} \quad (\gamma_{G' \times_G G}^{-1})^*: \text{pr}_2^* x \rightarrow \text{pr}_1^* j^* x$$

where $\gamma_{G' \times_G G}: j \text{pr}_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{pr}_2$ is the 2-cell in the definition of $G' \times_G G = (j/\text{id}_G)$. We now have all the necessary data and the reader can verify that they assemble in a morphism of 2-functors $\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow U(\mathcal{A}_{\oplus})$, as claimed. $\square$

6.3. Construction. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a Mackey 2-functor (Definition 3.15). We define a morphism of Mackey 2-functors

$$\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}: (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}.$$

Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. On an object $(H, x) \in (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G)$ with $H \in \mathbb{G}^f/G$ and $x \in \mathcal{M}(H)$, set

$$\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M},G}(H, x) := (\S_H)_*(x) \in \mathcal{M}(G)$$

where $\S_H: H \rightarrow G$ is the (tacit) structure morphism of H over G and $(\S_H)_*$ is induction in $\mathcal{M}$. On a morphism $(P, f): (H, x) \rightarrow (K, y)$ in $(U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G)$, given by a span $P = (P, p_1, p_2) \in \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$ and $f: p_1^*(x) \rightarrow p_2^*(y)$ in $\mathcal{M}(P)$, define $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M},G}([P, f])$ to be the push-forward of f along $\S_P: P \rightarrow G$ in $\mathcal{M}$, suitably corrected by units and counits (as in the definition of the trace Definition 4.7):

$$(6.4) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} \S_{H*}(x) & \xrightarrow[\quad := \quad]{\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M},G}([P, f])} & \S_{K*}(y) \\ \downarrow r_{\eta} \mid (p_1^* \dashv p_{1*}) & & \uparrow \ell_{\varepsilon} \mid (p_{2*} \dashv p_2^*) \\ \S_{H*} p_{1*} p_1^*(x) & \xleftarrow[\cong]{(\S_{p_1})^*} \S_{P*} p_1^*(x) \xrightarrow{\S_{P*}(f)} \S_{P*} p_2^*(y) \xrightarrow[\cong]{(\S_{p_2})^*} \S_{K*} p_{2*} p_2^*(y) \end{array}$$

The vertical arrows use induction in the Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{M}$. The horizontal isomorphisms $(\S_{p_i})_*$ come from pseudofunctoriality of $(-)_*$ in $\mathcal{M}$ on the structure 2-cells $\S_{p_1}: \S_P \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_{H p_1}$ and $\S_{p_2}: \S_P \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_{K p_2}$ of the wings of P , see (2.45).

6.5. Proposition. *Construction 6.3 yields a morphism of Mackey 2-functors*

$$\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}: (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}.$$

Proof. Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. We first prove that $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M},G}: (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(G)$ is a well-defined functor. Let us check that the formula for $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M},G}(P, f)$ in (6.4) is independent of the chosen morphism representative $(P, f): (H, x) \rightarrow (K, y)$. This is not immediate, as it explains our equivalence relation on morphisms. Suppose that $(P, f) \approx (P', f')$ is a one-step $\approx$ -equivalence given by a local equivalence $s: P \rightarrow P'$ in $\text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$, with wing cells $\sigma_i: p_i \xrightarrow{\sim} p'_i s$ for $i = 1, 2$, such that $f' = \text{tr}_s(f^\sigma)$, where $f^\sigma: s^* p_1^*(x) \rightarrow s^* p_2^*(y)$ is the adjusted morphism of (5.4). With this notation, we can verify that the following diagram commutes in $\mathcal{M}(G)$:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
\mathbb{S}_{H*}(x) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{S}_{P_1*}^{-1} r_{\eta}(p_1)} & \mathbb{S}_{P*} p_1^*(x) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{S}_{P*}(f)} & \mathbb{S}_{P*} p_2^*(y) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{S}_{P_2*} \ell_{\varepsilon}(p_2)} & \mathbb{S}_{K*}(y) \\
\parallel & & \downarrow \cong \mathbb{S}_{s*} \sigma_1^* & & \downarrow \cong \mathbb{S}_{s*} \sigma_2^* & & \parallel \\
& & \mathbb{S}_{P'*} s_* s^* p_1'^*(x) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{S}_{P'*} s_*(f^\sigma)} & \mathbb{S}_{P'*} s_* s^* p_2'^*(y) & & \\
& & \uparrow r_{\eta}(s) & & \downarrow \ell_{\varepsilon}(s) & & \\
\mathbb{S}_{H*}(x) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{S}_{P_1*}^{-1} r_{\eta}(p_1')} & \mathbb{S}_{P'*} p_1'^*(x) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{S}_{P'*}(f')} & \mathbb{S}_{P'*} p_2'^*(y) & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{S}_{P_2'*} \ell_{\varepsilon}(p_2')} & \mathbb{S}_{K*}(y)
\end{array}$$

The crucial square is the bottom middle one, which commutes by applying the functor $(\mathbb{S}_{P'})_*: \mathcal{M}(P') \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(G)$ to the relation $\text{tr}_s(f^\sigma) = f'$. The top middle square is essentially the definition of f^σ , combined with the structure 2-cell $\mathbb{S}_s: \mathbb{S}_P \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{S}_{P'} s$. The sides of the diagram commute by general compatibility of (co)units and push-forward in the (rectified) Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{M}$, using that the wing 2-cells $\sigma_i: p_i \xrightarrow{\sim} p'_i s$ are compatible with the structure 2-cells $\mathbb{S}_{p_i}$, $\mathbb{S}_{p'_i}$ and $\mathbb{S}_s$, as in (2.46). The composite in the top row is $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G}(P, f)$ while the composite in the bottom row is $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G}(P', f')$.

The reader can verify that $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G}: (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(G)$ is functorial and additive. (This does not use traces.)

For compatibility with restriction, we need for every $j: G' \rightarrow G$ an isomorphism

$$\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, j}: j^* \circ \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G} \xrightarrow{\sim} \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G'} \circ j^*$$

of functors $(U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(G')$. For $(H, x) \in (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G)$ form the isocomma

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
& j^* H & \\
\text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 \\
G' & \xrightarrow[\gamma]{\sim} & H \\
& j \searrow & \swarrow \mathbb{S}_H \\
& G &
\end{array}$$

and note that $j^* \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G}(H, x) = j^* \mathbb{S}_{H*}(x)$, whereas $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G'} j^*(H, x) = \text{pr}_{1*} \text{pr}_2^*(x)$. We can relate these two objects by the isomorphism

$$(6.6) \quad (\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, j})_{(H, x)} := (\gamma_*)_x : j^* \mathbb{S}_{H*}(x) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{pr}_{1*} \text{pr}_2^*(x)$$

given by the Mackey base-change isomorphism of Axiom (Mack 3) for $\mathcal{M}$. We omit the proof that this data defines a pseudo-natural transformation $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}: (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ of restriction 2-functors. (Again, it holds without using the trace.)

It remains to see compatibility with induction. Let $j: G' \rightarrow G$ be faithful. For an object $(H', x') \in (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G')$, we have $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G} \circ j_*(H', x') = (j \mathbb{S}_{H'})_*(x')$, whereas $j_* \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, G'}(H', x') = j_* \mathbb{S}_{H'*}(x')$. They are related by the canonical pseudofunctoriality isomorphism for induction in the (rectified) Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{M}$

$$(j \mathbb{S}_{H'})_* \xrightarrow{\sim} j_* \mathbb{S}_{H'*}: \mathcal{M}(H') \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(G)$$

evaluated at $x' \in \mathcal{M}(H')$. The reader will verify that this isomorphism is natural in $(H', x') \in (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}(G')$ and that it is indeed the mate of the restriction-comparison isomorphism $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}, j}$ of (6.6). Thus $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}$ is compatible with induction, i.e. it is a morphism of Mackey 2-functors. $\square$

6.7. Proposition. *For every Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{M} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$ and for every restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ we have equalities of pseudo-natural transformations*

$$U(\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}) \circ \oplus \eta_{U(\mathcal{M})} = \text{Id}_{U(\mathcal{M})} \quad \text{and} \quad \oplus \varepsilon_{(\mathcal{A}_{\oplus})} \circ (\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A}})_{\oplus} = \text{Id}_{\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}}.$$

Proof. For the first one, let $G \in \mathbb{G}$ and $x \in \mathcal{M}(G)$. Using Constructions 6.1 and 6.3, the composite $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M},G} \circ \oplus \eta_{U(\mathcal{M}),G}: \mathcal{M}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(G)$ maps x to $(\text{id}_G)_*(x) = x$ by our tacit choice of ‘rectified’ induction in $\mathcal{M}$ (see Remark 3.18). Same holds on morphisms.

For the second one, let $G \in \mathbb{G}$ and $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G)$, for $H \in \mathbb{G}^f/G$ and $x \in \mathcal{A}(H)$. Using Constructions 5.34, 6.1 and 6.3, the composite $\oplus \varepsilon_{(\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}),G} \circ (\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A}})_{\oplus,G}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G)$ maps (H, x) to $(H, (\text{id}_H)_*(x))$, using that id_H is a local equivalence. Again, we chose $\text{id}_* = \text{id}$ (Remark 4.5) so we get the result.

The same holds on morphisms. Indeed, let $[P, f]: (H, x) \rightarrow (K, y)$ be represented by $P = (P, p_1, p_2) \in \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$ and $f: p_1^*(x) \rightarrow p_2^*(y)$ in $\mathcal{A}(P)$. Applying $(\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A}})_{\oplus}$ replaces the $\mathcal{A}$ -part f by $\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A},P}(f) = [P, \text{id}_P, \text{id}_P; f]$ as a morphism in $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(P)$. Then applying $\oplus \varepsilon_{(\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}),G}$ pushes this morphism forward along the structure morphism $\S_P: P \rightarrow G$. By the definition of induction in $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}$, and using again the rectified choice $\text{id}_* = \text{id}$, this gives precisely the original representative $[P, f]$. Hence the composite is the identity also on morphisms.

We leave the agreement of compatibility isomorphisms to the reader. $\square$

6.8. Remark. Proposition 6.7 tells us that the unit-counit relations hold strictly. The reader might then ask why $U \dashv (-)_{\oplus}$ is not a strict 2-adjunction. The reason is that although $\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ is strictly 2-natural in $\mathcal{A}$, the counit $\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}$ is only pseudo-natural in $\mathcal{M}$. Indeed, for a morphism $t: \mathcal{M} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}'$ of Mackey 2-functors, we have an invertible modification

$$\oplus \varepsilon_t: t \circ \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}'} \circ t_{\oplus}: (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}'$$

(writing $t_{\oplus}$ for $U(t)_{\oplus}$), given for every $G \in \mathbb{G}$ by the natural transformation

$$\oplus \varepsilon_{t,G}: t_G \circ \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M},G} \xrightarrow{\sim} \oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}',G} \circ (t_{\oplus})_G: (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}'$$

which on an object $(H, x) \in (U\mathcal{M})_{\oplus}$ is the induction-compatibility isomorphism of t with respect to $\S_H: H \rightarrow G$, evaluated at $x \in \mathcal{M}(H)$:

$$(\oplus \varepsilon_{t,G})_{(H,x)}: t_G(\S_H^*(x)) \xrightarrow{((t_{\S_H})_*)^x} \S_{H*}(t_H(x)).$$

Further verifications are left to the reader.

6.9. Theorem. *We have a biadjunction between the 2-category of (rectified) Mackey 2-functors and that of restriction 2-functors on $\mathbb{G}$*

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \\ (-)_{\oplus} \left(\begin{array}{c} \uparrow \dashv \\ \downarrow \end{array} \right) U = \text{forget} \\ \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \end{array}$$

with unit $\oplus \eta$ and counit $\oplus \varepsilon$ as in Constructions 6.1 and 6.3.

Proof. By Theorem 5.35, the construction $(-)_\oplus: \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$ is a 2-functor, while $U: \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ is the forgetful 2-functor. By Proposition 6.2, for every restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$ we have a morphism ${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow U(\mathcal{A}_\oplus)$. These morphisms are strictly 2-natural in $\mathcal{A}$. By Proposition 6.5, for every Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{M}$ we have a morphism of Mackey 2-functors ${}_\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}}: (U\mathcal{M})_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$. These morphisms are pseudo-natural in $\mathcal{M}$ as explained in Remark 6.8. Triangle equalities hold strictly by Proposition 6.7, i.e. the corresponding invertible modifications of Recollection 2.5 may be chosen to be identity modifications. With this choice, the coherence conditions for the triangle modifications are automatic. $\square$

We can now clarify Theorem 1.1 of the Introduction:

6.10. Theorem. *Let $\mathcal{A}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a restriction 2-functor and $\mathcal{M}$ be a Mackey 2-functor. We have an equivalence of categories between the category of morphisms of restriction 2-functors $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ (and modifications) and the category of morphisms of Mackey 2-functors $s: \mathcal{A}_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ (and modifications), given by*

$$t \mapsto \hat{t} = {}_\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{M}} \circ t_\oplus$$

with inverse equivalence given by

$$s \mapsto U(s) \circ {}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}.$$

Proof. This is a direct consequence of Theorem 6.9. See Recollection 2.5. $\square$

6.11. Remark. Let $\mathcal{A}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a restriction 2-functor. The unit morphism ${}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_\oplus$ of Construction 6.1 is ‘split injective’ in the following sense. We can define an additive $\sigma_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A}_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ characterized by the property that for every G indecomposable (connected) and for every object $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ with H indecomposable as well, we have in $\mathcal{A}(G)$

$$\sigma_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x) = \begin{cases} (\S_H^*)^{-1}(x) & \text{if } \S_H: H \xrightarrow{\sim} G \text{ is an equivalence} \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

More precisely, for every G and every $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$, with structure morphism $\S_H: H \rightarrow G$ and $x \in \mathcal{A}(H)$, we consider $H^\approx := H^{\S_H^\approx}$ the union of the components of H on which $\S_H$ is full, as in Definition 2.22 for $p = \S_H$. Then we define

$$(6.12) \quad \sigma_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x) = (\S_H^\approx)_*(x|_{H^\approx})$$

in $\mathcal{A}(G)$, where $x|_{H^\approx} = \text{incl}_{H^\approx}^*(x) \in \mathcal{A}(H^\approx)$ for the inclusion $H^\approx \hookrightarrow H$, and where $(\S_H^\approx)_*: \mathcal{A}(H^\approx) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(G)$ is the folding induction in $\mathcal{A}$ of Proposition 4.1 for the local equivalence $s = \S_H^\approx$.

We define $\sigma_{\mathcal{A}, G}$ on morphisms similarly. Let $[P, f]: (H, x) \rightarrow (K, y)$ be represented by a span $P \in \text{Span}_{\mathbb{G}/G}^f(H, K)$ and a morphism $f: p_1^*(x) \rightarrow p_2^*(y)$ in $\mathcal{A}(P)$. Set $P^\approx := P^{\S_P^\approx}$, where $\S_P: P \rightarrow G$ is the structure morphism of P over G and $f^\approx := f|_{P^\approx}$. We can then define $\sigma_{\mathcal{A}, G}([P, f])$ as $(\S_P^\approx)_*(f^\approx)$ suitably ‘adjusted’. We leave the details to the reader. (Note that checking that this construction is well-defined with respect to $\approx$ -equivalence requires the compatibility of traces with base-change established in Lemma 4.11.)

For instance, $\sigma_{\mathcal{A}, G}(G, x) = x$ for every $x \in \mathcal{A}(G)$ from which it follows that

$$\sigma_{\mathcal{A}} \circ {}_\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}} = \text{id}_{\mathcal{A}}.$$

The reader can verify that $\sigma_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A}_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ is a morphism of conjugation 2-functors (only). It need not to be compatible with restrictions.

7. CONSTRUCTION AND BIADJUNCTION FOR $(-)^{\oplus}$

Recall our 2-category $\mathbb{G}$ of groupoids of interest (Convention 2.25) and the 2-subcategory $\mathbb{G}_{\approx}$ with only local equivalences as morphisms (Definition 2.27).

In this section, we construct $(-)^{\oplus}: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ and show that it is a right biadjoint to the forgetful functor. This will be substantially simpler than what we did for $(-)_{\oplus}$ in Sections 5 and 6 because we do not need to discuss induction. The latter will appear in Section 8, when we establish that $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ is actually always a Mackey 2-functor.

Let us temporarily *fix a conjugation 2-functor*, i.e. an additive 2-functor

$$\mathcal{B}: \mathbb{G}_{\approx}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}.$$

Thus $\mathcal{B}$ has only restriction along local equivalences. Associated to $\mathcal{B}$, we construct for every G in $\mathbb{G}$ an additive category $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}(G)$ by adjoining restriction data essentially via a Grothendieck construction. For comma categories $\mathbb{G}/G$ see Definition 2.32.

7.1. Construction. Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. We construct a category $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}(G)$ as follows.

Objects. An object $x = x_{\bullet}$ in $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}(G)$ is the data of an object x_H in the category $\mathcal{B}(H)$ for every groupoid $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ over G together with an isomorphism

$$x_s: x_H \xrightarrow{\sim} s^*(x_K)$$

in $\mathcal{B}(H)$ for every morphism $s: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ for which the underlying morphism $s: H \rightarrow K$ is a *local equivalence* in $\mathbb{G}$ (Definition 2.15), hence $s \in \mathbb{G}_{\approx}$ and the functor $s^* = \mathcal{B}(s): \mathcal{B}(K) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(H)$ makes sense. We refer to x_H as the value of $x_{\bullet}$ at *level* H . We refer to x_s as the ‘coherence isomorphisms’ of $x_{\bullet}$. These coherence isomorphisms are subject to three conditions:

- (1) For all H_1, H_2 , under the additivity equivalence $(\text{incl}_{H_1}^*, \text{incl}_{H_2}^*): \mathcal{B}(H_1 \sqcup H_2) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{B}(H_1) \oplus \mathcal{B}(H_2)$, the object $x_{H_1 \sqcup H_2}$ is identified with (x_{H_1}, x_{H_2}) via the pair of coherence isomorphisms

$$(x_{\text{incl}_{H_1}}, x_{\text{incl}_{H_2}}): (x_{H_1}, x_{H_2}) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\text{incl}_{H_1}^*(x_{H_1 \sqcup H_2}), \text{incl}_{H_2}^*(x_{H_1 \sqcup H_2})).$$

For the identity morphism, we require $x_{\text{id}_H} = \text{id}_{x_H}$ for every H .

- (2) For every two composable morphisms $s: H \rightarrow K$ and $t: K \rightarrow L$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$, with s and t local equivalences in $\mathbb{G}$, the following triangle commutes in $\mathcal{B}(H)$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} x_H & \xrightarrow[\simeq]{x_{t \circ s}} & s^* t^*(x_L) \\ & \searrow x_s \quad \nearrow s^*(x_t) & \\ & s^*(x_K) & \end{array}$$

- (3) For every 2-cell $\alpha: s \xrightarrow{\sim} t: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ for which $s, t: H \rightarrow K$ are local equivalences, the two isomorphisms $x_s: x_H \xrightarrow{\sim} s^*(x_K)$ and $x_t: x_H \xrightarrow{\sim} t^*(x_K)$ are compatible with the natural isomorphism $\alpha^* = \mathcal{B}(\alpha): s^* \xrightarrow{\sim} t^*: \mathcal{B}(K) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(H)$ provided by $\mathcal{B}$, namely we require $\alpha_{x_K}^* \circ x_s = x_t$ in $\mathcal{B}(H)$.

Morphisms. A morphism $f = f_{\bullet}$ from $x = x_{\bullet}$ to $y = y_{\bullet}$ is a collection of morphisms $f_H: x_H \rightarrow y_H$ in $\mathcal{B}(H)$ for every $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$, compatible with the isomorphisms x_s and y_s , in the sense that for every $s: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ whose underlying

morphism is a local equivalence, the following square commutes in $\mathcal{B}(H)$:

$$(7.2) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} x_H & \xrightarrow[\simeq]{x_s} & s^*(x_K) \\ f_H \downarrow & & \downarrow s^*(f_K) \\ y_H & \xrightarrow[\simeq]{y_s} & s^*(y_K). \end{array}$$

Composition is levelwise $(g_\bullet) \circ (f_\bullet) = (g_\bullet \circ f_\bullet)$ with obvious identity $(\text{id}_\bullet)$.

7.3. Remark. When we write x_H the index H really refers to the structure morphism $\S_H: H \rightarrow G$ since H is short for $(H \xrightarrow{\S_H} G) \in \mathbb{G}/G$. Note also that, unlike what we did in Section 5, we are now allowing arbitrary morphisms $H \rightarrow G$ not only faithful ones (in case $\mathbb{G}$ has any non-faithful morphism, of course).

The following is much simpler than the counterpart Proposition 5.8:

7.4. Proposition. *For every groupoid $G \in \mathbb{G}$, the above Construction 7.1 defines an additive category $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$.*

Proof. Addition of morphisms and objects is performed levelwise: $(x_\bullet \oplus y_\bullet)_H = x_H \oplus y_H$ and $(x_\bullet \oplus y_\bullet)_s = \begin{pmatrix} x_s & 0 \\ 0 & y_s \end{pmatrix}$. $\square$

We now turn to the variance of $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ in G with respect to restriction.

7.5. Construction. Let $j: G' \rightarrow G$ be a morphism in $\mathbb{G}$. *Restriction* along j

$$j^*: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$$

is given by levelwise restriction along $j_!: \mathbb{G}/G' \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G$, that is, the objects are $(j^*x)_{H'} = x_{j_!H'}$ (essentially $(j^*x)_{H'}$ is just $x_{H'}$ remembering that the structure morphism changes $\S_{j_!H'} = j \circ \S_{H'}$) and the isomorphisms are $(j^*x)_{s'} = x_{j_!s'}$. Similarly, j^* is defined on morphisms by applying $j_!$ levelwise, that is, $(j^*f)_{H'} = f_{j_!H'}$. This defines an additive functor $j^*: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$.

The 2-functoriality is also defined by applying $\alpha_!$ levelwise. In detail:

7.6. Construction. Let $j, k: G' \rightarrow G$ be morphisms in $\mathbb{G}$ and $\alpha: j \xrightarrow{\sim} k$ be a 2-cell. We define the natural transformation $\alpha^*: j^* \xrightarrow{\sim} k^*: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$ by

$$((\alpha^*)_{x_\bullet})_{H'} = x_{((\alpha_!)_{H'})}$$

for every $x_\bullet \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ and every $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$, where $\alpha_!: j_! \xrightarrow{\sim} k_!: \mathbb{G}/G' \rightarrow \mathbb{G}/G$ is as in Construction 2.42. The isomorphism $(\alpha_!)_{H'}: j_!H' = (H', j\S_{H'}) \xrightarrow{\sim} k_!H' = (H', k\S'_{H'})$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ is given by $\text{id}_{H'}$ on the object and by $\alpha\S_{H'}$ as structure 2-cell. As part of the data of $x_\bullet$ we have an isomorphism x_s in $\mathcal{B}(H')$ for $s = (\alpha_!)_{H'}$

$$x_{((\alpha_!)_{H'})}: x_{j_!H'} \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{id}_{H'}^*(x_{k_!H'}) = x_{k_!H'}.$$

The left-hand $x_{j_!H'}$ is $j^*(x_\bullet)$ at H' and the right-hand $x_{k_!H'}$ is $k^*(x_\bullet)$ at H' .

7.7. Proposition. *The above Constructions 7.1, 7.5 and 7.6 define a 2-functor $\mathcal{B}^\oplus: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$, which is additive. In other words, $\mathcal{B}^\oplus$ is a restriction 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}$ (Definition 2.29).*

Proof. Verifications are left to the reader. Additivity follows from $\mathbb{G}/(G_1 \sqcup G_2) \cong (\mathbb{G}/G_1) \times (\mathbb{G}/G_2)$ and Condition (1) in Construction 7.1. $\square$

We now allow $\mathcal{B}$ to vary in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$.

7.8. Construction. Let $t: \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'$ be a morphism of conjugation 2-functors. We define a strict morphism of restriction 2-functors $t^\oplus: \mathcal{B}^\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'^\oplus$ by applying t levelwise. More precisely, for every $G \in \mathbb{G}$ we define $t_G^\oplus: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'^\oplus(G)$ on objects $x_\bullet \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ by

$$(t_G^\oplus(x))_H = t_H(x_H)$$

at level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ and on local equivalences $s: H \xrightarrow{\sim} K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ by

$$(t_G^\oplus(x))_s := (t_s)_{x_K}^{-1} \circ t_H(x_s): t_H(x_H) \xrightarrow{\sim} s^* t_K(x_K),$$

essentially just $t_H(x_s)$, but adjusted by the restriction-compatibility isomorphism $t_s: s^* \circ t_K \xrightarrow{\sim} t_H \circ s^*$ provided with t . For every morphism $f: x_\bullet \rightarrow y_\bullet$ define $(t_G^\oplus(f))_H = t_H(f_H)$. These functors are strictly compatible with restriction: For every $j: G' \rightarrow G$ both functors $j^* \circ t_G^\oplus$ and $t_{G'}^\oplus \circ j^*$ from $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ to $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$ send every object $x_\bullet \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ to $t_{H'}(x_{j\mathbb{S}_{H'}})$ at every level $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$. For modifications $m: t \Rightarrow t': \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'$, we also apply the levelwise formula, namely $m^\oplus: t^\oplus \Rightarrow t'^\oplus: \mathcal{B}^\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'^\oplus$ is given for every $G \in \mathbb{G}$ by the natural transformation $m_G^\oplus: t_G^\oplus \Rightarrow t'_G: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'^\oplus(G)$ which at every $x_\bullet \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ is the morphism $m_{G,x_\bullet}^\oplus: t_G^\oplus(x_\bullet) \Rightarrow t'_G(x_\bullet)$ in $\mathcal{B}'^\oplus(G)$ which at level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ is

$$(m_{G,x_\bullet}^\oplus)_H = m_{H,x_H}: t_H(x_H) \rightarrow t'_H(x_H).$$

This assembles into a well-defined 2-functor

$$(-)^\oplus: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}).$$

We shall strengthen this statement in Theorem 8.24 where we show that $(-)^\oplus$ defines a functor from $\mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$ to $\mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$.

Let us now turn to the 2-adjunction with the forgetful functor.

7.9. Notation. Let $V = \text{forget}: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$ be the 2-functor induced by the inclusion $\mathbb{G}_\approx \hookrightarrow \mathbb{G}$. It is faithful (on 2-cells) since $\mathbb{G}_\approx$ and $\mathbb{G}$ have the same objects.

7.10. Construction. Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ be a restriction 2-functor. We define a (strict) morphism of 2-functors

$${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow (V\mathcal{A})^\oplus$$

as follows. Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. For an object $x \in \mathcal{A}(G)$, define ${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}(x)_\bullet$ in $(V\mathcal{A})^\oplus(G)$ at every level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ by

$$({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}(x))_H = \mathbb{S}_H^*(x)$$

where $\mathbb{S}_H: H \rightarrow G$ is the structure morphism of H , and for every local equivalence $s: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$, define ${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}(x)_s$ to be $\mathbb{S}_s^*: \mathbb{S}_H^* \xrightarrow{\sim} s^* \mathbb{S}_K^*$ evaluated at x , for $\mathbb{S}_s: \mathbb{S}_H \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{S}_K$ the structure 2-cell of the morphism s . In colloquial terms, we create out of an object in $\mathcal{A}(G)$ all the levelwise objects x_H by using the restrictions that exist since $\mathcal{A}$ is an actual restriction 2-functor. The functor ${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}$ is defined similarly on morphisms: $({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}(f))_H = \mathbb{S}_H^*(f)$.

7.11. Proposition. *The above Construction 7.10 yields a strictly 2-natural transformation of restriction 2-functors*

$${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow (V\mathcal{A})^\oplus.$$

Proof. For every $j: G' \rightarrow G$ in $\mathbb{G}$, the image in $(V\mathcal{A})^\oplus(G')$ of an object $x \in \mathcal{A}(G)$ by both functors $j^* \circ {}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G}$ and ${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A},G'} \circ j^*$ is equal at level $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$ to the object $(\S_{j!H'})^*(x) = (j\S_{H'})^*(x) = \S_{H'}^*(j^*(x))$ in $\mathcal{A}(H')$. The result follows easily. $\square$

7.12. Construction. Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a conjugation 2-functor. We define a morphism of conjugation 2-functors ${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}: V(\mathcal{B}^\oplus) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ as follows. Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. For an object $x_\bullet \in V(\mathcal{B}^\oplus)(G)$, define in $\mathcal{B}(G)$

$${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},G}(x_\bullet) := x_G.$$

On a morphism $f_\bullet: x_\bullet \rightarrow y_\bullet$ in $V(\mathcal{B}^\oplus)(G)$, we define similarly

$${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},G}(f) = f_G.$$

In telegraphic style, ${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},G}$ is evaluation at the object G of $\mathbb{G}/G$ (with $\S_G = \text{id}_G$).

7.13. Proposition. *The above Construction 7.12 defines a morphism of conjugation 2-functors*

$${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}: V(\mathcal{B}^\oplus) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$$

where for every $s: G' \xrightarrow{\sim} G$ in $\mathbb{G}_\approx$ the isomorphism ${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},s}: s^* \circ {}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},G} \xrightarrow{\sim} {}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},G'} \circ s^*$ of functors $V(\mathcal{B}^\oplus)(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(G')$ is provided on every object $x_\bullet$ by the inverse of the coherence isomorphism x_s .

Proof. With the above notation, $x_s: x_{G'} \xrightarrow{\sim} s^*(x_G)$ is an isomorphism in $\mathcal{B}(G')$ and its inverse indeed goes from $s^* \circ {}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},G}(x_\bullet) = s^*(x_G)$ to ${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B},G'} \circ s^*(x_\bullet) = (s^*x_\bullet)_{G'} = x_{s!G'} = x_{G'}$. Further compatibilities are left to the reader. $\square$

7.14. Proposition. *For every conjugation 2-functor $\mathcal{B} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$ and every restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$, we have equalities of pseudo-natural transformations*

$$({}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}})^\oplus \circ {}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{B}^\oplus} = \text{Id}_{\mathcal{B}^\oplus} \quad \text{and} \quad {}^\oplus\varepsilon_{V\mathcal{A}} \circ V({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}) = \text{Id}_{V\mathcal{A}}.$$

Proof. Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. The functor ${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{B}^\oplus,G}: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow (V\mathcal{B}^\oplus)^\oplus(G)$ maps an object $x_\bullet$ to $(\S_H^{*,\mathcal{B}^\oplus}(x_\bullet))_{H \in \mathbb{G}/G}$ where $\S_H^{*,\mathcal{B}^\oplus}: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(H)$ is restriction in $\mathcal{B}^\oplus$ with respect to $\S_H: H \rightarrow G$ as in Construction 7.5. The functor $({}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}})^\oplus_G: (V\mathcal{B}^\oplus)^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ applies ${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}$ in each level H , that is, evaluation at $\text{id}_H \in \mathbb{G}/H$; hence it sends our $(\S_H^{*,\mathcal{B}^\oplus}(x_\bullet))_{H \in \mathbb{G}/G}$ to

$$\left((\S_H^{*,\mathcal{B}^\oplus}(x_\bullet))_H \right)_{H \in \mathbb{G}/G} = ((x_\bullet)_{\S_H!H})_{H \in \mathbb{G}/G} = (x_H)_{H \in \mathbb{G}/G} = x_\bullet.$$

since $\S_{H!}H = (H \xrightarrow{\S_H \circ \text{id}_H} G)$ is just $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$. We leave the x_s to the reader. This gives the first equality.

For the second one, the functor $V({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}})_G: \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^\oplus(G)$ sends an object $x \in \mathcal{A}(G)$ to $(\S_H^*x)_H$. The functor ${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{V\mathcal{A},G}: \mathcal{A}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(G)$ evaluates at G which maps $(\S_H^*x)_H$ to $\text{id}_G^*x = x$. This yields the second equality.

We leave the agreement of compatibility isomorphisms to the reader. $\square$

7.15. Remark. We have a situation dual to that of Remark 6.8: The counit ${}^\oplus\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}$ of Construction 7.12 is strictly 2-natural in $\mathcal{B}$ but the unit ${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow (V\mathcal{A})^\oplus$ of Construction 7.10 is only pseudo-natural in $\mathcal{A}$. Indeed, let $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}'$ be a morphism of restriction 2-functors. There is an invertible modification

$${}^\oplus\eta_t: V(t)^\oplus \circ {}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}} \xrightarrow{\sim} {}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}'} \circ t.$$

As usual, we leave further details to the reader.

7.16. Theorem. *We have a biadjunction between the 2-category of restriction 2-functors and that of conjugation 2-functors on $\mathbb{G}$*

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \\ \downarrow V=\text{forget} \quad \uparrow (-)^{\oplus} \\ \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) \end{array}$$

with unit ${}^{\oplus}\eta$ and counit ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon$ as in Constructions 7.10 and 7.12.

Proof. By Construction 7.8, our $(-)^{\oplus}: \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ is a 2-functor, while $V: \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$ is the forgetful 2-functor. By Proposition 7.11, for every restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$ we have a morphism ${}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow (V\mathcal{A})^{\oplus}$. These morphisms are pseudo-natural in $\mathcal{A}$ as explained in Remark 7.15. By Proposition 7.13, for every conjugation 2-functor $\mathcal{B}$ we have a morphism ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}: V(\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$. These morphisms are strictly 2-natural in $\mathcal{B}$. The triangle equalities hold by Proposition 7.14. The corresponding invertible triangle modifications may be chosen to be identity modifications. With this choice, their coherence conditions are automatic. $\square$

We can now clarify Theorem 1.2 of the Introduction:

7.17. Theorem. *Let $\mathcal{B}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a conjugation 2-functor and let $\mathcal{A}$ be a restriction 2-functor. We have an equivalence of categories between the category of morphisms of conjugation 2-functors $t: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ (and modifications) and the category of morphisms of restriction 2-functors $s: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ (and modifications), given by*

$$t \mapsto \tilde{t} := t^{\oplus} \circ {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$$

with inverse equivalence given by

$$s \mapsto {}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}} \circ V(s).$$

Proof. This is a direct consequence of Theorem 7.16. See Recollection 2.5. $\square$

7.18. Remark. In Theorem 7.17, even if $\mathcal{B}$ is a restriction 2-functor, the transformation ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{B}}: \mathcal{B}^{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ need not commute with restrictions and, even if $\mathcal{A}$ is Mackey, the transformation $\tilde{t}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ need not preserve inductions.

8. THE 2-FUNCTOR $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ IS MACKEY

In this section, $\mathcal{B}$ is a conjugation 2-functor on $\mathbb{G}$, that is, an additive 2-functor

$$\mathcal{B}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}.$$

We want to explain Theorem 1.3, i.e. why the restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ of Section 7 is a Mackey 2-functor. We recall from Proposition 4.1 that any conjugation 2-functor already has induction along local equivalences. The induction construction for $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ will involve morphisms $p: X \rightarrow Y$ which are not local equivalences, so ordinary induction p_* is not available on all connected components of X . We shall induce only from the components of X on which p is a local equivalence, that is the $\approx$ -locus $X^{p \approx}$ of Definition 2.22. Let us do a preparation in this direction.

8.1. *Construction.* Let $j: G' \rightarrowtail G$ in $\mathbb{G}$ be a *faithful* morphism in $\mathbb{G}$. (See Remark 2.24.) For every $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ over G , we define $j^\sim H := (j^*H)^{(\text{pr}_2)^\sim}$ as the part of the pullback $j^*H = G' \times_G H$ on which $\text{pr}_2: G' \times_G H \rightarrow H$ is a local equivalence (Definition 2.22). By construction, it comes with a local equivalence that we denote ∇_H^j (in reference to Example 2.17)

$$\nabla_H^j := (\text{pr}_2)^\sim: j^\sim H \rightarrow H.$$

Since $j^\sim H$ is a subgroupoid of $j^*H \in \mathbb{G}/G'$, it is also an object over G' with the restricted structure morphism, that is, $\S_{j^\sim H} = (\text{pr}_1)|_{j^\sim H}: j^\sim H \rightarrow G'$.

Let now $s: H \xrightarrow{\sim} K$ be a morphism in $\mathbb{G}/G$ with s a local equivalence in $\mathbb{G}$. By Lemma 3.7, the pull-back $j^*s: j^*H \rightarrow j^*K$ is a local equivalence such that $\text{pr}_2 j^*s = s \text{pr}_2$. Thus, by Lemma 3.13, the morphism j^*s restricts to a local equivalence $(j^*H)^{\text{pr}_2^\sim} \rightarrow (j^*K)^{\text{pr}_2^\sim}$, that we denote $j^\sim s: j^\sim H \rightarrow j^\sim K$. We also record from the same Lemma 3.13 that the following commutative square is Mackey:

$$(8.2) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & j^\sim H & \\ j^\sim s \swarrow & & \searrow \nabla_H^j \\ j^\sim K & = & H \\ \nabla_K^j \searrow & & \swarrow s \\ & K & \end{array}$$

8.3. *Example.* For H connected, $j^\sim H$ is essentially a coproduct of copies of H and ∇_H^j is a folding. See Lemma 2.18. Conceptually, $j^\sim H$ picks up those components of the pullback j^*H which are equivalent to H . If we think of $G' \rightarrowtail G$ as an inclusion of a subgroup, we are picking the G -conjugates of H inside G' .

8.4. *Remark.* Summarizing Construction 8.1, we have the following diagram in $\mathbb{G}$:

$$(8.5) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} & & j^\sim H & & \\ & \S_{j^\sim H} = \text{pr}_1|_{j^\sim H} \swarrow & \downarrow \text{incl} & \searrow \nabla_H^j = \text{pr}_2|_{j^\sim H} & \\ & & j^*H = G' \times_G H & \approx & \\ & \S_{j^*H} = \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & \\ G' & & & & H \\ & \searrow j & \gamma_{j/\S_H} & \swarrow \S_H & \\ & & G & & \end{array}$$

In particular, ∇_H^j can be viewed as a morphism over G , that is a morphism in $\mathbb{G}/G$ between $j_! j^\sim H$ (with structure morphism $j \text{pr}_1|_{j^\sim H}$) and H . The structure 2-cell of ∇_H^j is the restriction of the 2-cell of the isocomma: $\S_{\nabla_H^j} = (\gamma_{j/\S_H})|_{j^\sim H}$.

8.6. *Construction.* Let $j: G' \rightarrowtail G$ be a faithful morphism in $\mathbb{G}$. We define a functor

$$j_*: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G') \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G).$$

Let $x'_\bullet$ be an object in $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$. For every $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ we define in $\mathcal{B}(H)$ the object

$$(j_* x'_\bullet)_H := (\nabla_H^j)_*(x'_{j^\sim H})$$

using Construction 8.1, where $x'_{j^\sim H} \in \mathcal{B}(j^\sim H)$ is provided by $x'_\bullet$ since $j^\sim H$ lives over G' and where $(\nabla_H^j)_*$ is induction (Proposition 4.1) along the local equivalence ∇_H^j . Similarly for every $s: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ such that s is a local equivalence

in $\mathbb{G}$, we define the coherence isomorphism $(j_*x'_\bullet)_s$ associated to s to be the push-forward $(\nabla_H^j)_*(x'_{j \approx s})$ of the one for x' , suitably corrected by base change, namely

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (j_*x'_\bullet)_H & \xrightarrow{(j_*x'_\bullet)_s} & s^*((j_*x'_\bullet)_K) \\ \parallel & \text{:=} & \parallel \\ (\nabla_H^j)_*(x'_{j \approx H}) & \xrightarrow{(\nabla_H^j)_*(x'_{j \approx s})} & (\nabla_H^j)_*(j \approx s)^*(x'_{j \approx K}) \cong s^*(\nabla_K^j)_*(x'_{j \approx K}) \end{array}$$

where the base-change isomorphism $(\nabla_H^j)_*(j \approx s)^* \cong s^*(\nabla_K^j)_*$ in the second row comes from Proposition 4.2 (b) on the Mackey square (8.2).

We define j_* on morphisms $f'_\bullet: x'_\bullet \rightarrow y'_\bullet$ in $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$ via the similar

$$(j_*f'_\bullet)_H := (\nabla_H^j)_*(f'_{j \approx H}).$$

All coherence conditions follow from functoriality of the isocomma construction and the compatibility of the base-change isomorphisms. They are left to the reader.

8.7. Proposition. *For every faithful $j: G' \rightarrow G$, the above Construction 8.6 defines an additive functor $j_*: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G') \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$.*

Proof. Additivity follows from the additivity of $(\nabla_H^j)_*$. $\square$

8.8. Proposition. *For every faithful $j: G' \rightarrow G$, the functor $j_*: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G') \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ is a special Frobenius two-sided adjoint of the restriction $j^*: \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$.*

Proof. We need the four (co)units of (5.25) and for that we need to compose the functors j^* and j_* of Constructions 7.5 and 8.6. Let $x = x_\bullet \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ then $j_*j^*(x) \in \mathcal{B}(H)$ at level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ is equal to the following object of $\mathcal{B}(H)$

$$(8.9) \quad (j_*j^*x)_H = (\nabla_H^j)_*((j^*x)_{j \approx H}) = (\nabla_H^j)_*(x_{j_! j \approx H}) \cong (\nabla_H^j)_*(\nabla_H^j)^*(x_H)$$

where the final isomorphism is the coherence isomorphism for $x_\bullet$ at the local equivalence $\nabla_H^j: j_! j \approx H \xrightarrow{\sim} H$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$, as explained in Remark 8.4.

The term $\nabla_* \nabla^*$ appearing in (8.9) suggests using the special Frobenius two-sided adjunction for the local equivalence $\nabla = \nabla_H^j$ (Proposition 4.1), which is available even though the 2-functor $\mathcal{B}$ is only a conjugation 2-functor. We can make a similar $\nabla^* \nabla_*$ appear for the other composite j^*j_* but it is more hidden.

Let $x' = x'_\bullet \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$ then $j^*j_*(x') \in \mathcal{B}(H')$ at level $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$ is equal to the following object of $\mathcal{B}(H')$

$$(8.10) \quad (j^*j_*x')_{H'} = (j_*x')_{j_! H'} = (\nabla_{j_! H'}^j)_*(x'_{j \approx j_! H'}).$$

(It is tempting, but *false*, to invoke the local equivalence $\nabla_{j_! H'}^j: j \approx j_! H' \xrightarrow{\sim} j_! H'$ to replace the final object as we did after (8.9). Unfortunately, this $\nabla_{j_! H'}^j$ need not be a morphism over G' , hence $x'_\bullet$ does not carry a corresponding coherence isomorphism.) We still modify (8.10) to make a $(\nabla_{j_! H'}^j)_*(\nabla_{j_! H'}^j)^*$ appear, as suggested after (8.9). For this, we recall $\eta_{H'} = \langle \S_{H'}, \text{id}_{H'}, \text{id} \rangle: H' \rightarrow j^*j_! H'$ as in (2.38). We know that $\eta_{H'}$ is fully faithful (Remark 2.40) and satisfies $\text{pr}_2 \eta_{H'} = \text{id}_{H'}$. Hence it lands in $j \approx j_! H'$ and defines a section $\eta_{H'}: H' \rightarrow j \approx j_! H'$ of $\nabla_{j_! H'}^j$ in $\mathbb{G}_\approx$. Consequently $(\eta_{H'})^*(\nabla_{j_! H'}^j)^* = \text{id}_{\mathcal{B}(H')}$ and we can make the ∇^* appear in (8.10) as follows

$$(8.11) \quad (j^*j_*x')_{H'} = \text{id}(j^*j_*x')_{H'} = (\eta_{H'})^*(\nabla_{j_! H'}^j)^*(\nabla_{j_! H'}^j)_*(x'_{j \approx j_! H'}).$$

In view of (8.9) and (8.11), we can now invoke the (co)units of $\nabla_* \dashv \nabla^* \dashv \nabla_*$ (in $\mathcal{B}!$) for $\nabla \in \{\nabla_H^j, \nabla_{j_1 H'}^j\}$ to define $(^\ell \eta_{x'})_{H'}, (^\ell \varepsilon_x)_H, ({}^r \eta_x)_H, ({}^r \varepsilon_{x'})_{H'}$ in $\mathcal{B}^\oplus$. The left unit ${}^\ell \eta = {}^\ell \eta^{(j)} : \text{Id}_{\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')} \Rightarrow j^* j_*$ is given on $x' \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$ at level $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$ by

$$(8.12) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} x'_{H'} & \xrightarrow[\quad := \quad]{(^\ell \eta_{x'})_{H'}} & (j^* j_* x')_{H'} \\ x'_{\eta_{H'}} \downarrow \simeq & & \parallel (8.11) \\ \eta_{H'}^*(x'_{j \approx j_1 H'}) & \xrightarrow{\ell_\eta(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j \text{ in } \mathcal{B})} & \eta_{H'}^*(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)^*(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)_*(x'_{j \approx j_1 H'}) \end{array}$$

where we use that $\eta_{H'} : H' \rightarrow j \approx j_1 H'$ is a local equivalence to invoke the corresponding coherence isomorphism for $x'_\bullet$ on the left-hand vertical side. In full detail, the morphism in the second row reads $\eta_{H'}^*((^\ell \eta^{(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)})_{x'_{j \approx j_1 H'}})$. The left counit ${}^\ell \varepsilon = {}^\ell \varepsilon^{(j)} : j_* j^* \Rightarrow \text{Id}_{\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)}$ is given on $x \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ at level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ by

$$(8.13) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} (j_* j^* x)_H & \xrightarrow[\quad := \quad]{(^\ell \varepsilon_x)_H} & x_H \\ \cong \downarrow (8.9) & & \parallel \\ (\nabla_H^j)_*(\nabla_H^j)^*(x_H) & \xrightarrow{\ell_\varepsilon(\nabla_H^j \text{ in } \mathcal{B})} & x_H. \end{array}$$

The right unit ${}^r \eta = {}^r \eta^{(j)} : \text{Id}_{\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)} \Rightarrow j_* j^*$ is given on $x \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ at level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$ by

$$(8.14) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} x_H & \xrightarrow[\quad := \quad]{({}^r \eta_x)_H} & (j_* j^* x)_H \\ \parallel & & \cong \downarrow (8.9) \\ x_H & \xrightarrow{{}^r \eta(\nabla_H^j \text{ in } \mathcal{B})} & (\nabla_H^j)_*(\nabla_H^j)^*(x_H). \end{array}$$

And finally the right counit ${}^r \varepsilon = {}^r \varepsilon^{(j)} : j^* j_* \Rightarrow \text{Id}_{\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')}$ is given on $x' \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$ at level $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$ by

$$(8.15) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} (j^* j_* x')_{H'} & \xrightarrow[\quad := \quad]{({}^r \varepsilon_{x'})_{H'}} & x'_{H'} \\ \parallel (8.11) & & \simeq \downarrow x'_{\eta_{H'}} \\ \eta_{H'}^*(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)^*(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)_*(x'_{j \approx j_1 H'}) & \xrightarrow{{}^r \varepsilon(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j \text{ in } \mathcal{B})} & \eta_{H'}^*(x'_{j \approx j_1 H'}) \end{array}$$

where the right-hand vertical isomorphism is the same as in (8.12). Again, the morphism in the second row can be expanded to $\eta_{H'}^*(({}^r \varepsilon^{(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)})_{x'_{j \approx j_1 H'}})$.

Note right away that juxtaposing (8.12) and (8.15) gives the special Frobenius property ${}^r \varepsilon \circ {}^\ell \eta = \text{id}$, since $(\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)_* \dashv (\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)^* \dashv (\nabla_{j_1 H'}^j)_*$ is special Frobenius.

It remains to verify the unit-counit relations. We spell out one of them:

$$(j^* ({}^\ell \varepsilon_x)) \circ {}^\ell \eta_{j^* x} = \text{id}_{j^* x}$$

in $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G')$, for every $x \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$. At level $H' \in \mathbb{G}/G'$ we need to prove

$$(8.16) \quad ({}^\ell \varepsilon_x)_{j_1 H'} \circ ({}^\ell \eta_{j^* x})_{H'} = \text{id}_{x_{j_1 H'}}.$$

Unpacking (8.12) on $x' = j^* x$ and (8.13) at level $H = j_1 H'$ we get respectively the top row and the right column of the following diagram in $\mathcal{B}(H')$ where we

abbreviate ∇ for $\nabla_{j_!H'}^j$

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
x_{j_!H'} & \xrightarrow{x_{j_!}\eta_{H'}} & \eta_{H'}^*(x_{j_!j \approx j_!H'}) & \xrightarrow{\ell_{\eta}(\nabla)} & \nabla_*(x_{j_!j \approx j_!H'}) & = & (j_*j^*x)_{j_!H'} \\
& \searrow \cong & \downarrow \cong x_{\nabla} & & \downarrow \cong x_{\nabla} & & \downarrow \cong x_{\nabla} \\
& & \eta_{H'}^*\nabla^*(x_{j_!H'}) & \xrightarrow{\eta_{H'}^*\ell_{\eta}(\nabla)\nabla^*} & \eta_{H'}^*\nabla^*\nabla_*\nabla^*(x_{j_!H'}) & = & \nabla_*\nabla^*(x_{j_!H'}) \\
& & & \searrow (-) & \downarrow \eta_{H'}^*\nabla^*(\ell_{\varepsilon}(\nabla)) & & \downarrow \ell_{\varepsilon}(\nabla) \\
& & & & \eta_{H'}^*\nabla^*(x_{j_!H'}) & = & x_{j_!H'}
\end{array}$$

The isomorphisms between first and second row are given by the coherence isomorphism x_s for $s = \nabla_{j_!H'}^j$ as in (8.9). The reader will verify that this diagram commutes. The critical triangle is the one marked $(-)$ which is the image of the unit-counit relation for the $\nabla_* \dashv \nabla^*$ adjunction at the object $x_{j_!H'} \in \mathcal{B}(j_!H')$ under the functor $\eta_{H'}^*: \mathcal{B}(j_!H') \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(H')$, all of which only depend on $\mathcal{B}$ being a conjugation 2-functor. The outer commutativity of the above diagram in $\mathcal{B}(H')$ gives (8.16). This proves the first unit-counit relation.

The reader will verify that the other three unit-counit relations also reduce to unit-counit relations for $\nabla_* \dashv \nabla^* \dashv \nabla_*$ where $\nabla = \nabla_{j_!H'}^j$ as above (in the proof of $({}^r\varepsilon j^*) \circ (j^*r\eta) = \text{id}_{j^*}$) or with $\nabla = \nabla_H^j$ (for the other two relations). $\square$

8.17. Proposition (Base-change for $\mathcal{B}^\oplus$). *Let*

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
& & L & & \\
& \swarrow v & & \searrow j & \\
H & & \overset{\cong}{\underset{\alpha}{\rightleftarrows}} & & K \\
& \searrow i & & \swarrow u & \\
& & G & &
\end{array}$$

be a Mackey square in $\mathbb{G}$, with i and j faithful. Then the left mate of α^* and the right mate of $(\alpha^{-1})^*$

$$\alpha_!: j_*v^* \xrightarrow{\sim} u^*i_* \quad \text{and} \quad (\alpha^{-1})_*: u^*i_* \xrightarrow{\sim} j_*v^*$$

are inverse isomorphisms between functors from $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(H)$ to $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(K)$.

Proof. For $x \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(H)$, we compute the two composites $j_*v^*(x)$ and $u^*i_*(x)$ in $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(K)$. At level $Y \in \mathbb{G}/K$ we have in $\mathcal{B}(Y)$

$$(8.18) \quad (j_*v^*x)_Y \stackrel{8.6}{=} (\nabla_Y^j)_*((v^*x)_{j \approx Y}) \stackrel{7.5}{=} (\nabla_Y^j)_*(x_{v_!j \approx Y})$$

where $j \approx Y$ is the part of $j^*Y = L \times_K Y$ on which $\text{pr}_2: L \times_K Y \rightarrow Y$ is a local equivalence, the latter being called $\nabla_Y^j = (\text{pr}_2)|_{j \approx Y}: j \approx Y \xrightarrow{\sim} Y$ (see Construction 8.1). On the other hand, still in $\mathcal{B}(Y)$, we have

$$(8.19) \quad (u^*i_*x)_Y \stackrel{7.5}{=} (i_*x)_{u_!Y} \stackrel{8.6}{=} (\nabla_{u_!Y}^i)_*(x_{i \approx u_!Y})$$

where $i \approx (u_!Y)$ is the part of $i^*(u_!Y) = H \times_G Y$ on which $\text{pr}_2: H \times_G Y \rightarrow Y$ is a local equivalence, called $\nabla_{u_!Y}^i = (\text{pr}_2)|_{i \approx u_!Y}: i \approx u_!Y \xrightarrow{\sim} Y$. To compare (8.18) and (8.19), we need to compare the objects $j \approx Y$ and $i \approx u_!Y$ in $\mathbb{G}$. They appear in

the following commutative diagram:

(8.20)

The diagram (8.20) is a complex commutative diagram. At the top, $H \times_G Y$ and $L \times_K Y$ are connected by a vertical arrow $e_Y \uparrow \cong$. $H \times_G Y$ has a curved arrow pr_1 to H and a curved arrow pr_2 to Y . $L \times_K Y$ has a curved arrow pr_1 to L and a curved arrow pr_2 to Y . L has a curved arrow v to H and a curved arrow j to K . K has a curved arrow u to G . H has a curved arrow i to G . Y has a curved arrow pr_2 to $L \times_K Y$ and a curved arrow pr_1 to $H \times_G Y$. $L \times_K Y$ has a curved arrow $\gamma_{j/\text{§}_Y} \cong$ to K . K has a curved arrow §_Y to Y . Y has a curved arrow $\text{§}_{u_! Y} = u \text{§}_Y$ to G . $j^{\sim} Y$ is a curved arrow from $L \times_K Y$ to Y . $i^{\sim} u_! Y$ is a curved arrow from Y to $H \times_G Y$. $e_Y^{\sim} \uparrow \cong$ is a curved arrow from $j^{\sim} Y$ to $i^{\sim} u_! Y$. ∇_Y^j is a curved arrow from $j^{\sim} Y$ to Y . $\nabla_{u_! Y}^i$ is a curved arrow from $i^{\sim} u_! Y$ to Y . incl is a curved arrow from $H \times_G Y$ to $j^{\sim} Y$.

Ignoring the green part ($j^{\sim} Y$ and $i^{\sim} u_! Y$) for a moment, the above (black part of the) diagram is essentially the same as (5.33); its outer square is the isocomma $H \times_G Y = (i/u \text{§}_Y)$ and its central part consists of the given Mackey square and the isocomma square for $L \times_K Y = (j/\text{§}_Y)$. Hence we have an equivalence

$$e_Y = \langle v \text{pr}_1, \text{pr}_2, \gamma_{j/\text{§}_Y} \otimes \alpha \rangle : L \times_K Y \xrightarrow{\sim} H \times_G Y$$

as shown in (8.20). Since this equivalence is compatible with the projections to Y , namely $\text{pr}_2 \circ e_Y = \text{pr}_2$, it restricts to a local equivalence on the $\approx$ -loci of pr_2 , i.e. it induces the (green) equivalence $e_Y^{\sim} := e_Y|_{j^{\sim} Y}$ at the top right of (8.20). We have

(8.21)

$$\nabla_{u_! Y}^i \circ e_Y^{\sim} = \nabla_Y^j : j^{\sim} Y \rightarrow Y$$

by construction. Furthermore, we also see in (8.20) that $e_Y^{\sim} : j^{\sim} Y \rightarrow i^{\sim} u_! Y$ is compatible with the structure morphisms of those two objects when seen above H . Since technically $j^{\sim} Y$ lives over L and since we use $v : L \rightarrow H$ to see it over H , we are more precisely getting an equivalence in $\mathbb{G}/H$ as follows:

$$e_Y^{\sim} : v_! j^{\sim} Y \xrightarrow{\sim} i^{\sim} u_! Y.$$

But then the object $x = x_{\bullet} \in \mathcal{B}^{\oplus}(H)$ has an associated coherence isomorphism

(8.22)

$$x_{e_Y^{\sim}} : x_{v_! j^{\sim} Y} \xrightarrow{\sim} (e_Y^{\sim})^* x_{i^{\sim} u_! Y}$$

in $\mathcal{B}(v_! j^{\sim} Y)$. We can now compare $(j_* v^* x)_Y$ and $(u^* i_* x)_Y$:

$$\begin{aligned} (j_* v^* x)_Y &\stackrel{(8.18)}{=} (\nabla_Y^j)_* (x_{v_! j^{\sim} Y}) \stackrel{(8.22)}{\cong} (\nabla_Y^j)_* (e_Y^{\sim})^* (x_{i^{\sim} u_! Y}) \\ &\stackrel{(8.21)}{\cong} (\nabla_{u_! Y}^i)_* (e_Y^{\sim})_* (e_Y^{\sim})^* (x_{i^{\sim} u_! Y}) \cong (\nabla_{u_! Y}^i)_* (x_{i^{\sim} u_! Y}) \stackrel{(8.19)}{=} (u^* i_* x)_Y \end{aligned}$$

where the middle isomorphism in the second row holds since $e_Y^{\sim}$ is an equivalence and therefore $(e_Y^{\sim})^*$ is an equivalence whose inverse is also its adjoint $(e_Y^{\sim})_*$. The reader will verify that the above isomorphism $(j_* v^* x)_Y \xrightarrow{\sim} (u^* i_* x)_Y$ is indeed the mate of $\alpha_!$ on x , at level Y . Since this is an isomorphism for all Y , and for all x , we get the wanted isomorphism $\alpha_! : j_* v^* \xrightarrow{\sim} u^* i_*$. One further verifies that the inverse is $(\alpha^{-1})_*$. We leave this verification to the reader. $\square$

We now allow the conjugation 2-functor $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$, which was fixed so far in this section, to vary. The following spells out the equality (4.4).

8.23. Lemma. *Let $t: \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'$ be a morphism of conjugation 2-functors, and let $s: K \rightarrow H$ be a local equivalence in $\mathbb{G}$. Then we have natural isomorphisms*

$$(t_s)_*: t_H s_*^{\mathcal{B}} \xrightarrow{\sim} s_*^{\mathcal{B}'} t_K, \quad \text{and} \quad (t_s^{-1})_!: s_*^{\mathcal{B}'} t_K \xrightarrow{\sim} t_H s_*^{\mathcal{B}}$$

of functors $\mathcal{B}(K) \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'(H)$, obtained as the mates of the restriction-compatibility isomorphisms $t_s: s^ t_H \xrightarrow{\sim} t_K s^*$ (and its inverse) with respect to the folding 2-sided adjoints $s_* \dashv s^* \dashv s_*$ in the conjugation 2-functors $\mathcal{B}$ and $\mathcal{B}'$ (Proposition 4.1).*

Proof. Using Lemma 2.18, we reduce to the case where $s = \nabla^{(n)}: H^{\sqcup n} \rightarrow H$ is a folding as in Example 2.17. In that case, the result follows from additivity of t_H . Details are left to the reader. $\square$

8.24. Theorem. *Let $\mathcal{B}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a conjugation 2-functor. Then the restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ of Section 7 is a Mackey 2-functor.*

Together with Construction 7.8 we obtain a well-defined 2-functor

$$(-)^{\oplus}: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G}) \longrightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$$

meaning that for every morphism $t: \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'$ of conjugation 2-functors, the associated morphism of restriction 2-functors $t^{\oplus}: \mathcal{B}^{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'^{\oplus}$ is compatible with induction.

Proof. Let us verify the Mackey axioms for the restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$. Additivity (Mack 1) is already part of $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ being a restriction 2-functor (Proposition 7.7). The two-sided special Frobenius adjunction (Mack 2) is Proposition 8.8. Base-change (Mack 3) is exactly Proposition 8.17. Therefore $\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}$ is Mackey.

We now explain the functoriality in $\mathcal{B}$. Let $t: \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'$ be a transformation of conjugation 2-functors. It yields a strict morphism of restriction 2-functors $t^{\oplus}: \mathcal{B}^{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'^{\oplus}$ by Construction 7.8.

We claim that this is a morphism of Mackey 2-functors, i.e. that it is compatible with induction as in Recollection 3.19. For every faithful $j: G' \rightarrow G$, the restriction-comparison isomorphism of the induced transformation $t^{\oplus}: \mathcal{B}^{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}'^{\oplus}$ is

$$(t^{\oplus})_j = \text{id}: j^* t_G^{\oplus} \xrightarrow{\sim} t_{G'}^{\oplus} j^*.$$

Its right mate is obtained by composing with the unit and counit of $j^* \dashv j_*$:

$$t_G^{\oplus} j_* \xrightarrow{r_{\eta^{(j)}}} j_* j^* t_G^{\oplus} j_* \xrightarrow{j_*(t^{\oplus})_j j_*} j_* t_{G'}^{\oplus} j^* j_* \xrightarrow{j_* t_{G'}^{\oplus} r_{\varepsilon^{(j)}}} j_* t_{G'}^{\oplus}.$$

At every level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$, this mate identifies with

$$(t_{\nabla_H^j})_*: t_H(\nabla_H^j)_*^{\mathcal{B}} \xrightarrow{\sim} (\nabla_H^j)_*^{\mathcal{B}'} t_{j \approx H},$$

where $\nabla_H^j: j \approx H \xrightarrow{\sim} H$ is the local equivalence of Construction 8.1. This is an isomorphism by Lemma 8.23. Hence the mate of $(t^{\oplus})_j$ is an isomorphism, so $t^{\oplus}$ is compatible with induction. $\square$

9. THE MARK TRANSFORMATION

In this section we compare the left and right mackeyfications of a restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$. From Theorems 6.10 and 7.17 we have

$$(9.1) \quad \mathcal{A}^{\oplus} \xrightarrow{\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}}} \mathcal{A} \xrightarrow{\oplus \eta_{\mathcal{A}}} \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}.$$

Writing the forgetful functors $U: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ and $V: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$, the right-hand $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}$ in (9.1) is the restriction 2-functor $U(\mathcal{A}_{\oplus})$ and the left-hand $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ is the left mackeyfication of $\mathcal{A}$ viewed as a conjugation 2-functor, that is, $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus} := (V\mathcal{A})^{\oplus}$. In the same vein, ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}}$ is truly ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{V\mathcal{A}}$.

Let us also recall the morphism of restriction 2-functors ${}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow (V\mathcal{A})^{\oplus} = \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ of Construction 7.10, namely the unit of the $(V \dashv (-)^{\oplus})$ -adjunction. Applying Theorem 6.10 to $t = {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ gives a morphism of Mackey 2-functors $\widehat{{}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ such that the following equality of morphisms of restriction 2-functors holds

$$(9.2) \quad U(\widehat{{}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}}) \circ {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}} = {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$$

where $U: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G}) \hookrightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$ is the other forgetful functor. We trust the reader can restore U and V as needed, and we suppress them from now on, unless their mention helps cognition.

9.3. Definition. Let $\mathcal{A}: \mathbb{G}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{ADD}$ be a restriction 2-functor. The *mark transformation* of $\mathcal{A}$ is the above morphism of Mackey 2-functors

$$\mu_{\mathcal{A}} := \widehat{{}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$$

given by the explicit formula in Theorem 6.10:

$$\mu_{\mathcal{A}} = {}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{(\mathcal{A}^{\oplus})} \circ ({}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}})_{\oplus}$$

where ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{(\mathcal{A}^{\oplus})}: (\mathcal{A}^{\oplus})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$ is the counit of the $((-)^{\oplus} \dashv U)$ -adjunction at the Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus}$, as described in Construction 6.3 and $({}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}})_{\oplus}$ is the image of ${}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ under $(-)^{\oplus}: \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbb{G})$ as in Construction 5.34. It is characterized by the equality (9.2) in $\mathbf{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{res}}(\mathbb{G})$, that is, forgetting U and V ,

$$(9.4) \quad \mu_{\mathcal{A}} \circ {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}} = {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}.$$

9.5. Remark. Completing (9.1) with $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}$ and ${}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$, we get a diagram of pseudo-natural transformations with varying degrees of naturality (‘mack’, ‘res’, and ‘conj’ indicate morphisms of Mackey, restriction, and conjugation 2-functors respectively):

$$(9.6) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & \mathcal{A} & \\ {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}} \swarrow \text{(res)} & & \searrow {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}} \text{(res)} \\ \mathcal{A}^{\oplus} & \xleftarrow[{}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}} \text{(conj)}]{} & \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \\ & \xleftarrow[\mu_{\mathcal{A}} \text{(mack)}]{} & \end{array}$$

By (9.4), the outer triangle in (9.6) commutes. The left-hand composite in (9.6) ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}} \circ {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ is truly ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{V\mathcal{A}} \circ V({}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}): V\mathcal{A} \rightarrow V((V\mathcal{A})^{\oplus}) \rightarrow V\mathcal{A}$, hence equals the identity, by the unit-counit relation of Proposition 7.14. Therefore

$$(9.7) \quad {}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}} \circ \mu_{\mathcal{A}} \circ {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}} \stackrel{(9.4)}{=} {}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}} \circ {}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}} = \text{id}_{\mathcal{A}}$$

as morphisms of conjugation 2-functors, i.e. ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{V\mathcal{A}} \circ VU(\mu_{\mathcal{A}}) \circ V({}^{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}) = \text{id}_{V\mathcal{A}}$. We return to the composite ${}^{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}} \circ \mu_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ in Remark 9.12.

We want to give an explicit formula for $\mu_{\mathcal{A},G}: \mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}^{\oplus}(G)$ for every $G \in \mathbb{G}$. Recall Construction 5.1 for $\mathcal{A}_{\oplus}(G)$ and Construction 7.1 for $\mathcal{A}^{\oplus}(G)$.

9.8. Theorem. *Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. Let $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$ be an object. Then $\mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x)$ in $\mathcal{A}^\oplus(G)$ is given at level $K \in \mathbb{G}/G$ by the following object of $\mathcal{A}(K)$*

$$(\mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x))_K = (p_2)_*(p_1)^*(x)$$

where $p_1 = \text{pr}_1|_{\S_H^\approx K}$ and $p_2 = \text{pr}_2|_{\S_H^\approx K}$ are the restrictions of the two projections pr_1 and pr_2 of the isocomma square defining $H \times_G K = (\S_H/\S_K)$

$$(9.9) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & H \times_G K & \\ \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & \cong_{\gamma} & \searrow \text{pr}_2 \\ H & & K \\ \S_H \searrow & & \swarrow \S_K \\ & G & \end{array}$$

on $\S_H^\approx K$, the part of $H \times_G K$ where pr_2 is fully faithful (Construction 8.1). The functor $(p_2)_*$ in (9.9) is ‘folding induction’ as in Proposition 4.1.

Proof. In the formula $\mu_{\mathcal{A}} = {}_{\oplus}\varepsilon_{(\mathcal{A}^\oplus)} \circ ({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}})_{\oplus}$ of Definition 9.3, we can unpack ${}_{\oplus}\varepsilon_{(\mathcal{A}^\oplus)}$ from Construction 6.3 and $(-)_\oplus$ from Construction 5.34. This gives

$$(9.10) \quad \mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x) = (\S_H)_*({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}, H}(x))$$

as an object of $\mathcal{A}^\oplus(G)$, where $(\S_H)_*$ is induction in the Mackey 2-functor $\mathcal{A}^\oplus$. Unpacking j_* of Construction 8.6 for $j = \S_H$, we have at level $K \in \mathbb{G}/G$

$$(9.11) \quad (\mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x))_K \stackrel{(9.10)}{=} \left((\S_H)_*({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}, H}(x)) \right)_K = (\nabla_K^{\S_H})_*({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}, H}(x))_{\S_H^\approx K}.$$

Unpacking ∇_H^j of Construction 8.1 for $j = \S_H$, we see that the local equivalence $\nabla_K^{\S_H}$ is exactly the morphism p_2 of the statement. The $\approx$ -locus $\S_H^\approx K$, which is a subobject of $H \times_G K$, is viewed over H by restricting $\text{pr}_1: H \times_G K \rightarrow H$. In other words, as an object of $\mathbb{G}/H$, our $\S_H^\approx K$ has structure morphism $\S_{\S_H^\approx K} = \text{pr}_1 \circ \text{incl}_{\S_H^\approx K} = p_1$ the morphism p_1 of the statement. Finally, unpacking ${}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ from Construction 7.10 we have by the above discussion

$$({}^\oplus\eta_{\mathcal{A}, H}(x))_{\S_H^\approx K} = \S_{\S_H^\approx K}^*(x) = p_1^*(x).$$

Plugging this in (9.11) and replacing $\nabla_K^{\S_H}$ by p_2 we get

$$(\mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x))_K = (p_2)_*(p_1^*(x))$$

as announced. $\square$

9.12. Remark. We have introduced and computed the mark transformation $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}$ from the perspective of right mackeyfication. We can also approach it from the other side. Recall that in Remark 9.5 we left one composite of the diagram (9.6) in the air, namely ${}_{\oplus}\varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}} \circ \mu_{\mathcal{A}}: \mathcal{A}_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$. We proved in (9.7) that it is a retraction of ${}_{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$, as morphisms of conjugation 2-functors. Actually, it is equal to the other retraction of ${}_{\oplus}\eta_{\mathcal{A}}$ that we have in store, namely the $\sigma_{\mathcal{A}}$ of Remark 6.11. Indeed, for every (H, x) in $\mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$, let us unpack the explicit formula in Theorem 9.8 for $K = G$, using the identification $H \times_G G \cong H$ under which $\text{pr}_2 = \S_H: H \rightarrow G$ and therefore $\S_H^\approx K = (H \times_G K)^{\text{pr}_2 \approx} = H^{\S_H \approx} = H^\approx$ in the notation of Remark 6.11; the two morphisms p_1 and p_2 of Theorem 9.8 become $p_1 = (\text{pr}_1)|_{H^\approx} = \text{incl}_{H^\approx}: H^\approx \hookrightarrow H$ and $p_2 = (\text{pr}_2)|_{H^\approx} = \S_H^\approx$. Therefore we obtain in $\mathcal{A}(G)$

$${}_{\oplus}\varepsilon_{V\mathcal{A}, G} \circ \mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x) \stackrel{7.12}{=} (\mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x))_G \stackrel{9.8}{=} (\S_H^\approx)_*(\text{incl}_{H^\approx}^*(x)) \stackrel{6.12}{=} \sigma_{\mathcal{A}}(H, x).$$

Thus we have a natural identification of morphisms of conjugation 2-functors

$$(9.13) \quad {}^\oplus \varepsilon_{\mathcal{A}} \circ \mu_{\mathcal{A}} = \sigma_{\mathcal{A}}.$$

This equation gives the alternative description of the mark transformation $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}$, by applying Theorem 7.17 to $t = \sigma_{\mathcal{A}}$. We must have $U(\mu_{\mathcal{A}}) \cong \widetilde{\sigma_{\mathcal{A}}}$, which characterizes $\mu_{\mathcal{A}}$ as a morphism of restriction 2-functors, hence as a morphism of Mackey 2-functors since the latter are morphisms of restriction 2-functors with additional properties. Again, uniqueness is up to unique modification. Unpacking the explicit description of $\tilde{t}$ in Theorem 7.17 applied to $t = \sigma_{\mathcal{A}}$, we have

$$(9.14) \quad \mu_{\mathcal{A}} \cong (\sigma_{\mathcal{A}})^\oplus \circ {}^\oplus \eta_{(\mathcal{A}_\oplus)}.$$

where $(-)^{\oplus}$ is as in Construction 7.8 and ${}^\oplus \eta$ is the unit of Construction 7.10.

9.15. Corollary. *Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$ and let $(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(G)$. For every object $\S_K: K \rightarrow G$ of $\mathbb{G}/G$, consider the restriction $\S_K^*(H, x) \in \mathcal{A}_\oplus(K)$. Then, with $\sigma_{\mathcal{A}}$ as in Remark 6.11, we have a canonical isomorphism in $\mathcal{A}(K)$*

$$(\mu_{\mathcal{A}, G}(H, x))_K \cong \sigma_{\mathcal{A}, K}(\S_K^*(H, x)).$$

Proof. Unpack (9.14) and Construction 7.10 for G , on (H, x) , at level K . $\square$

10. EXAMPLES

In this final section, we want to describe $\mathcal{A}_\oplus$ and $\mathcal{A}^\oplus$ in the case of a constant restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}$. Let us set up the notation.

10.A. The constant restriction functor.

10.1. Notation. Let $\mathcal{A}_0 \in \text{ADD}$ be a fixed additive category. Define a 2-functor from groups (as a full 2-subcategory of gpd) by setting for every finite group G

$$\mathcal{A}(G) = \mathcal{A}_0$$

independently of G , with all restrictions $u^* = \mathcal{A}(u)$ and all conjugation transformations $\alpha^* = \mathcal{A}(\alpha)$ equal to identity. By Remark 2.31, we can equivalently think of $\mathcal{A}$ as a restriction 2-functor on the 2-category gpd of finite groupoids by setting

$$\mathcal{A}(G) = \mathcal{A}_0^{\pi_0(G)} = \bigoplus_{\pi_0(G)} \mathcal{A}_0$$

the coproduct of as many copies of our constant category $\mathcal{A}_0$ as there are connected components in the groupoid G . For every $u: H \rightarrow G$, the restriction functor $u^*: \mathcal{A}(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(H)$ is restriction along the map $\pi_0(u): \pi_0(H) \rightarrow \pi_0(G)$. All 2-cells in gpd yield the identity transformation on $\mathcal{A}(-)$. Of course we can restrict $\mathcal{A}$ to gpd^f if we care only about faithful morphisms. We shall do this in the case of $\mathcal{A}^\oplus$.

For instance, let $\mathbb{k}$ be a ring (e.g. a field) and $\mathcal{A}_0 = \mathbb{k}\text{-free}$ the category of finitely generated free $\mathbb{k}$ -modules. Applying the above construction gives a restriction 2-functor that we shall denote $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}$, namely

$$\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(G) = (\mathbb{k}\text{-free})^{\pi_0(G)} = \bigoplus_{\pi_0(G)} (\mathbb{k}\text{-free}).$$

for every groupoid G .

10.2. *Remark.* The reader could be excused for thinking that constant 2-functors as above are Mackey 2-functors but they are not. Indeed, all restrictions do admit 2-sided adjoints very much as in the proof of Proposition 4.1: After all, every u^* is made of zeros and identities and u_* is just a ‘folding’. However, these adjoints do not satisfy the Mackey formulas of (Mack 3). For instance, for the Mackey square of Example 3.4 associated to subgroups $i: H \hookrightarrow G$ and $u: K \hookrightarrow G$, the composite $u^*i_*: \mathcal{A}(H) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}(K)$ via $\mathcal{A}(G)$ is the identity but the composite j_*v^* via $\mathcal{A}(H \times_G K)$ is the direct sum of $|K \backslash G/H|$ copies of the identity. So it is legitimate to submit $\mathcal{A}$ to left and right mackeyfication.

10.B. The $\mathbb{k}$ -linear Burnside category.

We recall a classical construction going back to early days of Mackey functors.

10.3. *Recollection.* Let G be a finite group. The *Burnside category* $\Omega_{\mathbb{Z}}(G)$ has objects the finite G -sets X and morphisms defined as follows. For every pair of finite G -sets X and Y , consider all possible spans $X \leftarrow W \rightarrow Y$ of finite G -sets. Keeping X and Y fixed, there are obvious notions of isomorphism of spans and of sum (II) of spans from X to Y , performed on the middle part. The set of isomorphism classes of spans from X to Y is an abelian monoid under II. Its group-completion (Grothendieck group) is

$$K_0(\{X \leftarrow W \rightarrow Y\}, \text{II}) =: \text{Hom}_{\Omega_{\mathbb{Z}}(G)}(X, Y)$$

used as the Hom-group from X to Y in $\Omega_{\mathbb{Z}}(G)$. Composition is done via the cartesian product of G -sets: $[X \leftarrow W \rightarrow Y]_{\simeq}$ followed by $[Y \leftarrow V \rightarrow Z]_{\simeq}$ compose to $[X \leftarrow W \times_Y V \rightarrow Z]_{\simeq}$ with the usual legs. This passes to K_0 .

For our ring $\mathbb{k}$, the $\mathbb{k}$ -linear Burnside category $\Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G)$ has the same objects as above (finite G -sets) and $\mathbb{k}$ -linearly extended Hom-groups

$$\text{Hom}_{\Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G)}(X, Y) := \mathbb{k} \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \text{Hom}_{\Omega_{\mathbb{Z}}(G)}(X, Y),$$

with $\mathbb{k}$ -linearly extended composition. This construction $G \mapsto \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G)$ is actually part of a Mackey 2-functor on $\mathbf{gpd}$, as explained in [BD20, Section 7.2].

10.4. *Recollection.* Let G be a group. The connection between G -sets, as in the Burnside category construction, and groupoids over G in $\mathbf{gpd}$, as in the right mackeyfication Construction 5.1, is given by the *transporter groupoid*. For every finite G -set X the transporter groupoid $G \ltimes X$ has objects the set X and morphisms $x \rightarrow y$ given by $\{g \in G \mid gx = y\} \subseteq G$. Composition is multiplication in G . See [BD20, Definition B.0.6]. We can view $G \ltimes X$ as an object in $\mathbf{gpd}^f/G$ for it comes with a faithful morphism $\S_{G \ltimes X}: G \ltimes X \rightarrow G$ mapping $x \in X$ to the unique object of G and every g to g . This turns G -maps $f: X \rightarrow Y$ into morphism $G \ltimes f: G \ltimes X \rightarrow G \ltimes Y$ given by f on objects and the identity on morphisms; this defines a morphism in $\mathbb{G}/G$ with structure 2-cell $\S_{G \ltimes f} = \text{id}$. As explained in [BD20, Proposition B.0.9] this construction yields a biequivalence

$$G \ltimes -: G\text{-set} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbf{gpd}^f/G$$

where the source 1-category is viewed as a 2-category with only identity 2-cells. In particular, it induces an equivalence of ordinary categories on the 1-truncations

$$G \ltimes -: G\text{-set} \xrightarrow{\sim} \tau_1(\mathbf{gpd}^f/G)$$

where the 1-category $\tau_1(\mathbf{gpd}^f/G)$ has the same objects as $\mathbf{gpd}^f/G$ and morphisms the *isomorphism classes* of morphisms in $\mathbf{gpd}^f/G$ (i.e. modulo invertible 2-cells).

This transporter-groupoid construction can be extended to spans of finite G -sets, sending $(X \xleftarrow{w_1} W \xrightarrow{w_2} Y)$ to the object $(G \ltimes W, G \ltimes w_1, G \ltimes w_2)$ in the 2-category $\mathbf{Span}_{G/G}^f(G \ltimes X, G \ltimes Y)$.

10.5. Theorem. *Let G be a finite group, viewed in $\mathbf{gpd}$ (Example 2.8) and consider the right Mackeyfication $(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}$ of the constant restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}$ of Notation 10.1. The transporter groupoid $G \ltimes -$ yields a well-defined equivalence*

$$\theta_G: \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}(G)$$

mapping a G -set X to $(G \ltimes X, \underline{\mathbb{k}})$ where $\underline{\mathbb{k}}$ is $(\mathbb{k}, \dots, \mathbb{k}) \in \bigoplus_{\pi_0(G \ltimes X)} \mathbb{k}\text{-free} = \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(G \ltimes X)$.

Proof. Let us abbreviate $\mathcal{A}_0 = \mathbb{k}\text{-free}$. For every $H \in \mathbf{gpd}$, the object $\underline{\mathbb{k}} = \underline{\mathbb{k}}(H)$ in $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(H) = \mathcal{A}_0^{\pi_0(H)}$ which is $\mathbb{k}$ in every spot (as in the statement for $H = G \ltimes X$) has the amusing property that for all $u: H \rightarrow K$ we have $u^*(\underline{\mathbb{k}}) = \underline{\mathbb{k}}$, or in expanded notation $u^*(\underline{\mathbb{k}}(K)) = \underline{\mathbb{k}}(H)$.

Therefore the functor θ_G can simply be defined on spans $S = (X \xleftarrow{w_1} W \xrightarrow{w_2} Y)$ as $[P, p_1, p_2; \text{id}_{\underline{\mathbb{k}}}]$, where the span $P \in \mathbf{Span}_{G/G}^f(G \ltimes X, G \ltimes Y)$ is $G \ltimes W$, with the wings $p_i = G \ltimes w_i$ for $i = 1, 2$, as in Recollection 10.4, and where $\text{id}_{\underline{\mathbb{k}}}$ means the identity of $\underline{\mathbb{k}} = p_1^*(\underline{\mathbb{k}}) = p_2^*(\underline{\mathbb{k}})$ in $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(P)$. One verifies that this is a well-defined functor, using that $G \ltimes -$ turns the cartesian squares of G -sets to Mackey squares ([BD20, Remark B.0.5]). We leave to the reader to verify that θ_G is $\mathbb{k}$ -linear, and in particular additive.

To see that $\theta_G: \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G) \rightarrow (\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}(G)$ is essentially surjective, it suffices to observe (Remark 5.14) that for every (H, x) with $x \in \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(H)$, if $H = H_1 \sqcup \dots \sqcup H_r$ and $x = (x_1, \dots, x_r)$ in $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(H) = \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(H_1) \oplus \dots \oplus \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(H_r)$ then $(H, x) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^r (H_i, x_i)$ in $(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}(G)$. So we can assume that H is connected. Then if $x \cong \mathbb{k}^n$ we have $(H, x) \cong (H, \mathbb{k})^{\oplus n}$ so we can assume that $x = \mathbb{k}$. But then $(H, \mathbb{k}) = \theta_G(X)$ for any G -set X such that $G \ltimes X \simeq H$, for instance $X = G / \text{Aut}_H(a)$ for any object $a \in H$.

Therefore it suffices to show that θ_G is fully faithful, i.e. that for every pair of G -sets X and Y , with transporter groupoids $H := G \ltimes X$ and $K := G \ltimes Y$, the functor θ_G induces a bijection

$$(10.6) \quad \text{Hom}_{\Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G)}(X, Y) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_{(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}(G)}((H, \underline{\mathbb{k}}), (K, \underline{\mathbb{k}})).$$

By additivity again, we can assume that X and Y are orbits, so H and K are connected, and we can write $\mathbb{k}$ instead of $\underline{\mathbb{k}}$ as $\pi_0(H) = \pi_0(K) = *$.

The inverse of (10.6) is relatively easy to construct. A morphism representative as in Construction 5.1 from $(H, \mathbb{k})$ to $(K, \mathbb{k})$ is given by a span $P \in \mathbf{Span}_{G/G}^f(H, K)$ and a morphism $f: p_1^*\mathbb{k} \rightarrow p_2^*\mathbb{k}$. As the latter is $\underline{\mathbb{k}} \in \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(P)$, the morphism f is a collection of scalars $(f_C)_{C \in \pi_0(P)}$ indexed by the connected components of P . By additivity, we can assume P to be connected, so $f = f_P \in \mathbb{k}$ is a scalar $\lambda(f)$. Using Recollection 10.4, we can assume up to replacing P by equivalence, that $P = G \ltimes W$ and $p_i = G \ltimes w_i$ for a span $X \xleftarrow{w_1} W \xrightarrow{w_2} Y$ of G -sets. We then send (P, f) to $\lambda(f) \cdot [X \leftarrow W \rightarrow Y]$. Changing P up to strong equivalence, or changing the choice of W, w_1, w_2 gives the same isomorphism class of span. Let us check that this construction is well-defined up to $\approx$ -equivalence of Construction 5.1. Using additivity again, we reduce to the case where $s: P \rightarrow P'$ is an equivalence, in which case $s^* = \text{id}$ and $s_* = \text{id}$ as well. The critical place where one uses that $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}$ is constant is when we ‘adjust’ $f: p_1^*\mathbb{k} \rightarrow p_2^*\mathbb{k}$ before computing its trace with respect to s , as explained in (5.4). Since (in the notation of (5.4)) we have $\sigma_i^* = \text{id}$,

where σ_i are the wing 2-cells of $s = (s, \sigma_1, \sigma_2)$, we get indeed that $\text{tr}_s(f) = \lambda(f)$. So the relation $\text{tr}_s(f) = f'$ forces the scalars $\lambda(f)$ and $\lambda(f')$ to be the same. This discussion yields a well-defined map backwards from (10.6)

$$\text{Hom}_{(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}(G)}((H, \underline{\mathbb{k}}), (K, \underline{\mathbb{k}})) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G)}(X, Y).$$

It is now easy to verify, using additivity, that the latter is an inverse of (10.6). $\square$

10.7. *Remark.* The reader can verify that the equivalence of Theorem 10.5 upgrades to an equivalence of Mackey 2-functors $\theta: \Omega_{\mathbb{k}} \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}$. One can actually exploit the fact that $\Omega_{\mathbb{k}}$ is a Mackey 2-functor to construct the inverse of θ more abstractly than in the above proof. Indeed, there is a ($\mathbb{k}$ -linear) morphism of restriction 2-functors on $\mathbf{gpd}$

$$\beta: \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}} \rightarrow \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}$$

characterized by the fact that for G a finite group $\beta_G(\mathbb{k}) = G/G$. (In this argument it might be better to only use finite groups, as in [BD20, Section 4.3].) By our Theorem 6.10, the morphism $\beta: \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}} \rightarrow \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}$ induces a morphism of Mackey 2-functors $\hat{\beta}: (\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}$. It is essentially characterized by the fact that for every subgroup $H \leq G$ the functor $\hat{\beta}_G: (\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus}(G) \rightarrow \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}(G)$ maps the object $(H, \mathbb{k})$ to G/H . This uses that $(\text{incl}_H)_*(H/H) = G/H$ in the Mackey 2-functor $\Omega_{\mathbb{k}}$.

The reader will verify that this morphism $\hat{\beta}: (\mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}})_{\oplus} \rightarrow \Omega_{\mathbb{k}}$ is an inverse of the above morphism θ in $\text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{mack}}(\mathbf{gpd}^f)$.

10.8. *Remark.* Theorem 10.5 gives Theorem 1.6 (a) in the Introduction.

10.C. Left Mackeyfication of constant 2-functors.

10.9. *Notation.* Recall the 2-comma category $\mathbb{G}/G$ of Definition 2.32. We denote by $\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G$ the 2-subcategory with objects $(H \rightarrow G)$ that are indecomposable, meaning that H is non-empty indecomposable in $\mathbb{G}$ (that is, *connected* in the underlying $\mathbf{gpd}$) and whose 1-morphisms $s: H \xrightarrow{\sim} K$ are equivalences in $\mathbb{G}/G$, which is the same as asking the underlying $s: H \rightarrow K$ to be an equivalence in $\mathbb{G}$, or a local equivalence (Definition 2.15) for that matter. The 2-cells stay as in $\mathbb{G}/G$. As for any 2-category, this $\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G$ admits a 1-truncated (ordinary) category

$$\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$$

as discussed in Recollection 10.4; see [BD20, Notation A.1.14].

10.10. *Example.* Continuing on Example 2.34, for $\mathbb{G} = \mathbf{gpd}^f$, let G be a group and H a subgroup. The object $H = (H \xrightarrow{\text{incl}} G)$ is connected, so it is an object of $\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G$. Its automorphism group in $\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$ is the Weyl group of H :

$$N_G(H)/H \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{End}_{\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)}(H)$$

where the isomorphism sends a class $[g] \in N_G(H)/H$ to $c_g: H \xrightarrow{\sim} H$ with structure 2-cell $\S_{c_g} = \gamma_g$. This is immediate from Example 2.34.

10.11. **Theorem.** Let $\mathcal{B}_0 \in \text{ADD}$ be a fixed additive category and $\mathcal{B} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\mathbb{G})$ be the associated constant conjugation 2-functor $\mathcal{B}(G) = \mathcal{B}_0^{\pi_0(G)}$ as in Notation 10.1. Let $G \in \mathbb{G}$. Then with Notation 10.9 we have an equivalence

$$\mathcal{B}^{\oplus}(G) \cong \text{Fun}(\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G), \mathcal{B}_0)$$

between $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ and the category of $\mathcal{B}_0$ -valued functors on the category $\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$. It is given by sending $x_\bullet \in \mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ to the functor that maps $H \in \mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G$ to $x_H \in \mathcal{B}_0$ and every morphism $[s]_{\simeq}: H \rightarrow K$ in $\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$ to x_s .

Proof. This equivalence is almost an equality, or perhaps more intuitively a ‘trimming of redundancies’. Consider the very definition of $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ in Construction 7.1. The additivity Condition (1) tells us that an object $x_\bullet$ of $\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G)$ is characterized by the data of x_H with H indecomposable and of x_s for $s: H \xrightarrow{\sim} K$ in $\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G$, that is, between indecomposable objects. But a local equivalence s between indecomposable objects gives the identity on π_0 and therefore the induced functor $s^*: \mathcal{B}(K) = \mathcal{B}_0 \rightarrow \mathcal{B}(H) = \mathcal{B}_0$ is the identity of $\mathcal{B}_0$. It follows that Condition (2) becomes simply $x_{t \circ s} = x_t \circ x_s$. Similarly, for every 2-cell $\alpha: s \xrightarrow{\sim} t: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G$, the transformation $\mathcal{B}(\alpha) = \alpha^*: \text{Id}_{\mathcal{B}_0} \Rightarrow \text{Id}_{\mathcal{B}_0}$ is the identity since $\mathcal{B}$ is constant. It follows from Condition (3) that isomorphic 1-cells $s, t: H \rightarrow K$ in $\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G$ induce the same isomorphism $x_s = x_t$. In short, $x_\bullet$ is just a functor from the category $\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$ to $\mathcal{B}_0$. It is clear that morphisms $f_\bullet$ correspond simply to natural transformations, since again s^* disappears from (7.2). $\square$

10.12. Corollary. *Let $\mathcal{B} \in \text{Fun}_{\text{ADD}}^{\text{conj}}(\text{gpd}^f)$ be the constant conjugation 2-functor associated to a fixed additive category $\mathcal{B}_0 \in \text{ADD}$ as in Notation 10.1, on the (2,1)-category $\mathbb{G} = \text{gpd}^f$ of finite groupoids with faithful morphisms. Let G be a finite group. Choose representatives $H_1, \dots, H_r$ of conjugacy classes of subgroups of G and let $W_i = N_G(H_i)/H_i$ be the corresponding Weyl group in G , for $i = 1, \dots, r$. Then we have an equivalence*

$$\mathcal{B}^\oplus(G) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^r \text{Fun}(W_i, \mathcal{B}_0)$$

where $\text{Fun}(W_i, \mathcal{B}_0)$ is the category of representations of W_i in $\mathcal{B}_0$ (Example 2.8).

Proof. View each W_i as a one-object groupoid and let $\mathcal{W} := W_1 \sqcup \dots \sqcup W_r$, that is, the category with $\{1, \dots, r\}$ as objects and $\text{End}_{\mathcal{W}}(i) = W_i$ and $\text{Mor}_{\mathcal{W}}(i, j) = \emptyset$ for $i \neq j$. Define a functor

$$(10.13) \quad \omega: \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$$

by sending i to $(H_i \xrightarrow{\text{incl}} G)$ and, $[g] \in W_i = N_G(H_i)/H_i$, to $[(c_g, \gamma_g)]$, using

$$W_i \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{End}_{\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)}(H_i)$$

as in Example 10.10. Moreover, every indecomposable object over G is equivalent to one of the chosen subgroups H_i , since $\mathbb{G} = \text{gpd}^f$ has only faithful morphisms. There are no morphisms between distinct representatives H_i and H_j in $\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$ as we saw in Example 2.34. Hence ω is an equivalence.

This equivalence ω in (10.13) induces by restriction an equivalence on (ordinary) functor categories $\text{Fun}(\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G), \mathcal{B}_0) \cong \text{Fun}(\mathcal{W}, \mathcal{B}_0)$ and the result now follows from Theorem 10.11 and the explicit description

$$\text{Fun}(\mathcal{W}, \mathcal{B}_0) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^r \text{Fun}(W_i, \mathcal{B}_0).$$

This gives the result. $\square$

10.14. Remark. Theorem 1.6(b) in the Introduction is Corollary 10.12 applied to $\mathcal{B}_0 = \mathbb{k}\text{-mod}$.

10.D. The mark transformation for constant input.

We finally identify the mark transformation of Section 9

$$\mu_{\mathcal{A}_k} : (\mathcal{A}_k)_\oplus \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_k^\oplus$$

for the restriction 2-functor $\mathcal{A}_k$ of Notation 10.1, that is, $\mathcal{A}_k(G) = (\mathbb{k}\text{-free})^{\pi_0(G)}$. We set $\mathbb{G} = \mathbf{gpdf}$ for the end of this section.

10.15. Theorem. *Let $\mathbb{k}$ be a field. Let G be a finite group and $H_1, \dots, H_r$ a complete set of representatives of conjugacy classes of subgroups of G . Under the equivalences of Theorem 10.5 and Corollary 10.12 the mark transformation*

$$\mu_{\mathcal{A}_k, G} : (\mathcal{A}_k)_\oplus(G) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_k^\oplus(G)$$

sends a finite G -set X in $\Omega_k(G)$ to the tuple in $\oplus_{i=1}^r \mathbb{k}(N_G(H_i)/H_i)\text{-mod}$ given by

$$(\mathbb{k}(X^{H_i}))_{i=1, \dots, r}$$

where $\mathbb{k}(X^H)$ is regarded as a permutation $\mathbb{k}(N_G(H)/H)$ -module for every $H \leq G$.

Proof. Let $H \leq G$ be a subgroup and $W = N_G(H)/H$ be its Weyl group in G . Consider the functor

$$\omega : W \rightarrow \tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G)$$

sending the only object $\bullet$ of W to $H = (H \xrightarrow{\text{incl}} G) \in \mathbb{G}/G$ and every morphism $[g] \in W$ to the isomorphism class of the equivalence $c_g : H \xrightarrow{\sim} H$ as in Example 10.10, that is, with structure 2-cell $\S_{c_g} = \gamma_g$. We are claiming that the following diagram commutes

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \Omega_k(G) & \xrightarrow[\simeq]{\text{Thm. 10.5}} & (\mathcal{A}_k)_\oplus(G) & \xrightarrow{\mu_{\mathcal{A}_k}} & \mathcal{A}_k^\oplus(G) & \xrightarrow[\simeq]{\text{Thm. 10.11}} & \text{Fun}(\tau_1(\mathbb{G}_{\simeq}^{\text{conn}}/G), \mathbb{k}\text{-free}) \\ & \searrow^{X \mapsto \mathbb{k}(X^H)} & & & & & \downarrow \omega^* \\ & & & & & & \mathbb{k}(W)\text{-mod} \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Fun}(W, \mathbb{k}\text{-free}). \end{array}$$

(Indeed, we claim this for each $H = H_i$ in the statement.)

Under the equivalence θ_G of Theorem 10.5, a finite G -set X is sent to the object

$$(G \ltimes X, \underline{\mathbb{k}}) \in (\mathcal{A}_k)_\oplus(G),$$

where $\underline{\mathbb{k}} \in \mathcal{A}_k(G \ltimes X)$ denotes the constant object with value $\mathbb{k}$ on every connected component of $G \ltimes X$. We want to compute its image in $\mathcal{A}_k^\oplus(G)$ under $\mu_{\mathcal{A}_k}$.

At level $H \in \mathbb{G}/G$, Theorem 9.8 tells us that $\mu_{\mathcal{A}_k, G}(G \ltimes X, \underline{\mathbb{k}})$ is

$$(\mu_{\mathcal{A}_k, G}(G \ltimes X, \underline{\mathbb{k}}))_H = (p_2)_* p_1^*(\underline{\mathbb{k}}),$$

where p_1 and p_2 are the restrictions of pr_1 and pr_2 in the isocomma

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & (G \ltimes X) \times_G H & & & \\ \text{pr}_1 \swarrow & & \searrow \text{pr}_2 & & \\ G \ltimes X & \xrightarrow[\S_{G \ltimes X}]{\gamma} & G & \xleftarrow{\text{incl}} & H \end{array}$$

on the part where pr_2 is fully faithful, denoted $\S_{G \ltimes X}^{\approx} H$ in Construction 8.1. Note that all morphisms above are faithful. One easily gets an equivalence

$$H \ltimes X \xrightarrow{\sim} (G \ltimes X) \times_G H$$

(where the left-hand X is of course X with action restricted to H) and the above isocomma is equivalent to the following commutative Mackey square

$$(10.16) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & H \ltimes X & \\ \text{incl} \ltimes \text{id}_X \swarrow & & \searrow \S_{H \ltimes X} \\ G \ltimes X & = & H \\ \S_{G \ltimes X} \searrow & & \swarrow \text{incl} \\ & G & \end{array}$$

By Recollection 10.4 the transporter groupoid $H \ltimes X$ has structure morphism over H sending every object of X to $\bullet$. Therefore, this morphism is fully faithful exactly on the subgroupoid of $H \ltimes X$ spanned by the objects $X^H \subseteq X$. Every object $a \in X^H$ has automorphism group H in $H \ltimes X$ and therefore we can identify $\S_{G \ltimes X}^{\sim} H$ with $\sqcup_{X^H} H$ and describe

$$p_1^*(\underline{\mathbb{k}}) = \underline{\mathbb{k}} \in \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(\sqcup_{X^H} H) = \bigoplus_{X^H} \mathbb{k}\text{-free}.$$

Since H has a single connected component, the local equivalence $p_2: \S_{G \ltimes X}^{\sim} = \sqcup_{X^H} H \longrightarrow H$ induces a folding push-forward $(p_2)_*$ that sends the constant $\underline{\mathbb{k}}$ to

$$(p_2)_*(\underline{\mathbb{k}}) = \oplus_{X^H} \mathbb{k}.$$

This is indeed the correct vector space $\mathbb{k}(X^H)$, namely the free vector space on the set X^H , and we still need to trace the action of $W = N_G(H)/H$.

Now let $g \in N_G(H)$. It defines an automorphism $c_g: H \xrightarrow{\sim} H$ in $\mathbb{G}/G$ that we should follow in the above construction, and in particular in the key Mackey square (10.16). The automorphism c_g induces an automorphism $c_g \ltimes (g \cdot -): H \ltimes X \xrightarrow{\sim} H \ltimes X$ which sends an object $a \in X$ to ga and a morphism $h: a \rightarrow ha$ to $ghg^{-1}: ga \rightarrow g(ha)$. Since $g \in N_G(H)$, this restricts to an automorphism $\S_{G \ltimes X}^{\sim} H \xrightarrow{\sim} \S_{G \ltimes X}^{\sim} H = \sqcup_{X^H} H$ that is given on objects $X^H \rightarrow X^H$ by multiplication by g . This yields an automorphism of

$$p_2: \sqcup_{X^H} H \xrightarrow{\nabla} H$$

that shuffles the connected components of $\sqcup_{X^H} H$ via the action of g on X^H . On $(p_2)_*: \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(\sqcup_{X^H} H) = \oplus_{X^H} \mathbb{k}\text{-free} \xrightarrow{\oplus} \mathbb{k}\text{-free} = \mathcal{A}_{\mathbb{k}}(H)$ this gives the automorphism $(g \cdot)_*$ on $(p_2)_*((x_a)_{a \in X^H}) = \oplus_a x_a$ that shuffles the indices. In particular on $x = \underline{\mathbb{k}} = (\mathbb{k}, \mathbb{k}, \dots, \mathbb{k})$ this gives the action of g on the free $\mathbb{k}$ -module $\mathbb{k}(X^H)$ that shuffles the basis X^H . That is exactly the action as permutation module. $\square$

10.17. Remark. In view of Theorem 10.15, the mark transformation is not an equivalence in general. It is not essentially surjective, even up to direct summands. Indeed, it suffices to take $\mathbb{k}$ a field of positive characteristic $p > 0$, for which most $\mathbb{k}G$ -modules are not p -permutation (trivial source) modules; this applies to any group of order divisible by p except the cyclic group of order 2 when $p = 2$.

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